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Startup
Policy
Forum



W E L C O M E S

The New Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) Framework for UPI

UPI MDR: Myth vs Reality

01

MYTH

UPI is no longer free, and users will be charged

REALITY

Consumers pay Rs 0. The 0.4% MDR applies only to payments above Rs 2,000, which is paid by the merchant

02

MYTH

Merchants will pass on the cost to consumers

REALITY

Merchants cannot charge it to consumer

03

MYTH

Small shops and street vendors will be charged

REALITY

Merchants receiving up to ₹1 lakh/month pay zero MDR

04

MYTH

It's a new govt tax.

REALITY

It doesn't go to the government. It funds the larger infrastructure of UPI

05

MYTH

Sending money to family and UPI AutoPay now costs extra.

REALITY

No, they will remain free

06

MYTH

MDR brought in to bow down to foreign pressure

REALITY

MDR will benefit the larger UPI ecosystem and infrastructure

SPF Members Back the New MDR Framework



"The introduction of MDR on UPI would materially change the narrative around fintechs. A sustainable revenue model would improve investor sentiment & give the fintech ecosystem a significant boost."

Amrish Rau, Chairman, Managing Director and CEO, Pine Labs



"UPI has transformed how India pays, but sustaining this growth needs continued investment in infrastructure, security & innovation. A measured MDR on higher-value transactions builds a viable economic model."

Bipin Preet Singh, Co-Founder, MD & CEO, MobiKwik



"India has built payment infrastructure capable of scaling globally, but it cannot run indefinitely at zero economics. A rational MDR is about keeping the ecosystem sustainable & innovating."

Bhavin Patel, CEO & Co-Founder, Vartis Platforms & LenDenClub



"Reliable, secure, scalable infrastructure needs sustained investment in technology, fraud prevention & innovation. A reasonable MDR gives banks, payment companies & technology providers the incentive to keep improving it."

Satyam Nathani, CEO, OTPless



"One of the strongest reforms the Indian economy needed. A modest, capped fee on larger merchant payments lets UPI pay for itself, creating room for new fintech products, more jobs & greater investment."

Shweta Rajpal Kohli, President & CEO, Startup Policy Forum



"The new MDR framework keeps UPI free for consumers while building a stronger, more sustainable payments ecosystem. Micro & small merchants stay protected with zero MDR. BharatPe strongly supports this."

Nalin Negi, CEO, BharatPe



"This is a thoughtful, forward-looking step for UPI's future. By limiting MDR to specific high-value merchant transactions, the framework keeps the vast majority of everyday users unaffected."

Sambhav Jain, Co-Founder, Fam



"Zero MDR drove UPI's hyper-adoption, but long-term health needs sound economics. A balanced 0.4% MDR lets banks & fintechs reinvest in infrastructure, cybersecurity & reliability."

Shruti Aggarwal, Co-Founder, Stashfin



"MDR gives the core use case an economic value of its own. That attracts fresh investments, new players and more innovation. It's a welcome move."

Nishchay Ag, Founder & CEO, Jar



"UPI's next leap needs investment in trust, reliability & innovation. This thoughtfully designed MDR will fund stronger fraud protection, fewer failed transactions & faster refunds. We welcome it."

Dilip Jain, Co-Founder, Gullak

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New Delhi

81st SESSION OF UN GENERAL ASSEMBLY



Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu holds up a device as he speaks at the 81st session of the UNGA in New York on Thursday. AP

Netanyahu at UN: ‘Attacking Iran was one of the easiest decisions for me’

‘You can’t silence me’: Israel PM hits out at Mamdani

Reuters United Nations, September 24

ISRAELI PRIME Minister Benjamin Netanyahu told world leaders Thursday attacking Iran “was one of the easiest decisions I’ve ever had to make” and denounced as “moral cowards” a mass of delegates who walked out of the UN General Assembly when he took podium to speak. “In defending itself, Israel is also defending many of the countries whose delegates just left this hall,” Netanyahu said.

“In fact, I want you to know that many of their leaders even thank us privately for taking out Iran’s nukes.”

When Netanyahu walked to the rostrum, a mix of cheers, boos and mass walkouts erupted. Scores of delegates trooped out and a majority of seats sat empty afterward. “Order in the hall, please,” General Assembly President Khalilur Rahman said. “If there are any other moral cowards who have not yet left the hall, please do so now,” Netanyahu said.

At UN, Zelenskyy urges leaders to choke Russia, impede its war efforts

Associated Press United Nations, September 24

UKRAINIAN PRESIDENT Volodymyr Zelenskyy told world leaders Wednesday Vladimir Putin is the only obstacle to ending “the ridiculous and never-ending war,” and urged nations large and small to pressure the Russian president for peace by choking the country’s revenues and impeding its war efforts.

“Our target is Russia’s ability to finance this war, to drag it out, to make it more brutal and more destructive,” Zelenskyy told the UN General Assembly’s annual gathering. “Russia’s finances and Russia’s production are what must be stopped if Putin is to be stopped.”

When Russia gets money from trade, “it always says no to diplomacy,” Zelenskyy argued, “so Russia’s revenues must remain a target.”

Earlier Wednesday, Russian Foreign Minister Sergey Lavrov clashed with Ukrainian Foreign Minister Andrii Sybiha and his country’s European supporters at a UN Security Council meeting, and Lavrov and US Secretary of State Marco Rubio met

Son of Israel envoy to US hurt in West Bank car attack

Jerusalem: The son of Israel’s Ambassador to the US was gravely injured in a ramming attack in the occupied West Bank on Wednesday. Neria Leiter, a reservist in Israel’s military, “needs a miracle,” Ambassador Yechiel Leiter said in a social media post.

According to the military and law enforcement, a Palestinian man rammed his car into a security checkpoint near the settlement of Beit Horon, seriously wounding the soldier. AP

“To all those accusing Israel of genocide, including New York Mayor, shame on you,” he said. To Mayor Zohran Mamdani, he said, “You can’t silence me.”

The Palestinian Mission to UN said in a message to many of the 193 UN member nations to bring as many staff as possible to the assembly hall and “collectively walk out of the assembly” once Israeli PM is announced. “This will send clear message to Netanyahu...no one is willing to aid...or be complicit in its genocide and war crimes and illegal occupation...,” the message said.

Russian strikes kill 8 in Kyiv, damage maternity clinic

Kyiv: Russian drone and missile strikes on Ukraine’s capital Kyiv and its northeast killed eight people on Thursday in attacks that included a maternity hospital and a farm, officials said.

Two people died in the latest assault on Kyiv, according to President Volodymyr Zelenskyy, who was in New York for UN General Assembly. REUTERS

on the assembly sidelines and discussed the war.

Zelenskyy cast doubt on Russia’s interest in ending the fighting. “Something always seems to stop Putin from saying, ‘That’s it. Enough. Peace,’” Zelenskyy said. “Can you even imagine him without war? He is ‘patient zero’, the one from whom this idea of war keeps spreading further.”

“The more freedom Putin has to act, the more dangerous the world becomes for everyone else,” Zelenskyy said.

Prime Minister Anthony Albanese said the OpenAI agent gained unauthorised access to the medical statistics portal of Medicare, Australia’s universal health insurance programme, while conducting research on public medical spending.

“Evidence currently available is there is no broader compromise to the... network. Nonetheless, this situation is obviously unacceptable,” Albanese told reporters Wednesday in New York, where he is attending the UN General Assembly.

Investigations continue and Australia has voiced its “extreme concern about this incident” to OpenAI CEO Sam Altman, Albanese said, adding that he was deeply disappointed by the company’s delay in notifying the government.

“It took until September 10 before there was any notification at all,” Albanese said, adding that the investigation would also examine why government systems had failed to detect the breach in the first place.

XI SUPPORTS US-IRAN JUNE DEAL THAT WAS AIMED AT ENDING WAR, TELLS TRUMP TO HANDLE TAIWAN ISSUE WITH PRUDENCE

Trump rolls out red carpet for Xi as both seek stability despite tensions

First time a US President has welcomed a foreign leader at Joint Base Andrews in 11 yrs

Reuters Washington, September 24

US PRESIDENT Donald Trump welcomed Chinese President Xi Jinping to the White House on Thursday for a lavish state summit expected to be heavy on symbolism but light on substance, with both leaders keen to showcase stable ties despite a host of thorny issues such as AI, trade, Taiwan and the war with Iran.

The subject of Taiwan, perhaps the most difficult, came up during a bilateral meeting in which Xi urged the US to adhere to the position of opposing “Taiwan independence” and handle the Taiwan question with prudence, state news agency Xinhua reported.

The White House did not immediately provide its own readout of the discussion.

Xi was expected to press Trump this week to halt arms sales to Taiwan. Following his visit to China in May, Trump said he was holding in abeyance an arms package to Taiwan worth some \$14 billion and called it a “very good negotiating chip.”

Xi said, during his meeting with Trump, that China supports the US and Iran returning to a June deal that was meant to end the war and open the Strait of Hormuz, Xinhua said.

Earlier on Thursday at the



US President Donald Trump, First Lady Melania Trump, Chinese President Xi Jinping and his wife Peng Liyuan in the Oval Office on Thursday. REUTERS

White House, Trump touted his “truly great friendship” with Xi and said the two powers had made strides on trade since his trip to China in May.

“During this visit, we will also discuss pressing issues concerning security, technology, and ‘super intelligence,’” Trump said, using his alternative name for AI.

“The decisions we make in these areas today can promote peace and prosperity for decades and decades to come.”

Speaking after Trump, Xi said the competition between the US and China should be a

“healthy one.” US companies were welcome in China, he said, adding that he hopes “Chinese companies are treated fairly here in the United States.”

Xi also said both militaries should maintain regular dialogue to improve crisis prevention. “The Thucydides trap can be overcome,” he said, referring to the academic theory that sees a risk of rivalry between a rising and an established power spiraling into open conflict.

The summit, Xi’s first visit to Washington in more than a decade, is the second meeting this year between the leaders

of the world’s two biggest economies.

For Trump, who relishes ceremony and prizes his ties with powerful leaders, the visit is as much a matter of national prestige as an opportunity for high-stakes diplomacy.

The US President aimed to reciprocate the grand welcome he received in China in May.

Trump greeted Xi on arrival on Wednesday evening with a red carpet on the tarmac, the first time a US President has welcomed a foreign leader at Joint Base Andrews since President Barack Obama met Pope

Francis in 2015, according to C-SPAN, which tracks presidential events.

Following their remarks on Thursday, the two leaders observed a military ceremony including a flyover at the Rose Garden, with Chinese flags waving from the Oval Office roof alongside US flags, before a scheduled bilateral meeting.

Despite the fanfare, analysts say major breakthroughs are unlikely, with tangible outcomes potentially limited to an extension of a trade truce expiring in November and an agreement to examine threats posed

US hits Iran with new sanctions; Saudi downs Houthi missiles

Iran flights halted as US deadline on airlines expires

Reuters Dubai, Riyadh, September 24

IRANIAN FLIGHTS to Gulf neighbours including travel hub Dubai appeared to have been cancelled on Thursday after a US deadline passed for global firms to halt work with Iran’s airlines, a major step in a campaign President Donald

Trump calls “economic D-Day”.

In Saudi Arabia, where an escalating conflict with Yemen’s Iran-aligned Houthi fighters this month has become the main front in the wider West Asia war, authorities said they had intercepted six ballistic missiles fired by the Houthis.

Trump referred to the new strategy last month as “economic D-Day”, comparing it to the assault on Nazi-controlled France in World War Two by the United States and its allies.

The US Treasury had set September 23 as the deadline for companies worldwide to



A billboard depicts the Strait of Hormuz in Tehran on Thursday.

comply with an order to stop doing business with Iranian airlines. Washington says the aim is to ground the entire global Iranian civilian fleet.

Iran threatened on Wednesday to retaliate against any neighbouring countries that comply with the US ban on its flights, by making their airports “unusable”. There were no immediate public announcements from countries that they were halting flights, but Iran’s ISNA news agency said all flights to the United Arab Emirates, the Gulf’s biggest travel hub, had been halted as of midnight.

Meanwhile, Saudi Arabia said it had intercepted six Houthi ballistic missiles on Thursday, after issuing emergency alerts for areas including the

holy city of Mecca, Jeddah and Yanbu, the main Saudi Red Sea oil port. “Any escalation and violations by the terrorist Houthi militia will be dealt with firmly,” a Saudi-led coalition fighting the Houthis in Yemen said.

Sources in the internationally recognised, Saudi-backed Yemeni government said their forces had repelled overnight Houthi attacks on a key supply route to Aden, the Indian Ocean port city where the government is based.

The Houthis, who already controlled the north including the capital Sanaa, seized

Yemen’s entire Red Sea coast this month and have been pushing into adjacent highlands near the central mountain city of Taiz and road from Aden.

The Houthis have kept up pressure on government forces holding a steep winding mountain pass known as Hejat al-Abd, a lifeline for hemmed in pro-government forces, and for goods entering Taiz.

Seizing parts of the Taiz-Aden road could allow the Houthis to tighten their grip around Taiz and deal another blow to the government.

White House reinstates access to CNN, MS NOW & Politico following judge’s order

Reuters Washington, September 24

THE WHITE House said on Thursday it has reinstated journalists from CNN, MS NOW and Politico after a federal judge deemed US President Donald Trump’s ban of the three news outlets likely unconstitutional and ordered their access immediately restored.

The midday reinstatement came after a chaotic few hours earlier on Thursday when the journalists continued to be blocked from entering the White House grounds. That prompted

the three news organizations to request an immediate hearing before US District Judge Tim Kelly, who issued his decision overnight. Kelly, acting in a lawsuit brought by CNN, MS NOW and Politico on Monday, ordered a halt to Trump’s ban for 14 days in a press freedom case that has played out over the past week in the courtroom and White House grounds.

Kelly found that the revocation of the White House credentials of the journalists “likely violated their constitutional due process rights.”

The judge, who Trump ap-

pointed in 2017 during his first presidential term, also raised doubts about the US Justice Department’s national security arguments for justifying the ban, noting that Trump himself had said the action was due to what the president alleged was false or negative coverage.

Hours after Kelly issued his order, CNN, MS NOW and Politico told the judge they remained barred, and asked for the emergency hearing. Politico said its reporter’s credentials were confiscated. An MS NOW reporter said she was blocked from the White House.

Pak bans gatherings ahead of protest by Imran’s party

Islamabad: Pakistani authorities have banned public gatherings in Islamabad for two months ahead of a march planned by jailed former prime minister Imran Khan’s political party to the capital.

The Islamabad administration, in an order on Wednesday, said that Section 144 of the Criminal Procedure Code had been imposed, prohibiting gatherings of five or more people, processions, rallies and demonstrations across the federal capital, including the high-security Red Zone.

The development comes

after Islamabad Additional District Magistrate Anam Fatima issued an order on September 18, stating that Section 144 of the Criminal Procedure Code had been enforced with immediate effect and “shall remain in force for a period of two months.”

The move comes as Khan’s Pakistan Tehreek-e-Insaf (PTI) prepares for a long march to Islamabad on September 27, primarily demanding the release of the party founder, who has been incarcerated in connection with multiple cases since 2023. PTI

Australia says OpenAI agent hacked govt website, checks for more breaches

Reuters Sydney, September 24

AUSTRALIA SAID Thursday an OpenAI agent breached a government health data portal in June, gaining unauthorised access to files, in what could be first known instance of an AI agent hacking a government website.

The breach is one of the highest-profile incidents of AI agents accessing external systems outside the United States, coming on top of several recent breaches globally by rogue AI agents that have alarmed governments and companies.

Prime Minister Anthony Albanese said the OpenAI agent gained unauthorised access to the medical statistics portal of Medicare, Australia’s universal health insurance programme, while conducting research on public medical spending.

“Evidence currently available is there is no broader compromise to the... network. Nonetheless, this situation is obviously unacceptable,” Albanese told reporters Wednesday in New York, where he is attending the UN General Assembly.

Investigations continue and Australia has voiced its “extreme

concern about this incident” to OpenAI CEO Sam Altman, Albanese said, adding that he was deeply disappointed by the company’s delay in notifying the government.

“It took until September 10 before there was any notification at all,” Albanese said, adding that the investigation would also examine why government systems had failed to detect the breach in the first place.

He also warned three other government health-related websites may have been impacted by the OpenAI agent’s activity, but did not confirm had occurred.

AI could be a risk to humanity, tech leaders tell UN

Associated Press United Nations, September 24

THE HEADS of major artificial intelligence firms pleaded with the United Nations Wednesday to save world or at least its people — by somehow regulating the fast-expanding technology that they have been designing.

“If managed poorly, I even believe AI could be a risk to humanity as a whole,” said Dario Amodei, chief executive officer of Anthropic. And from his competitor Sam Altman, CEO of OpenAI, came this assessment: “We could lose control of the future to AI.”

Both said the countries of the



“If managed poorly, I even believe AI could be a risk to humanity as a whole”

DARIO AMODEI, CEO OF ANTHROPIC

world, through the UN Security Council, where they testified Wednesday, have to set safeguards of some kind to prevent the technology from getting too powerful to rein in.

They also called for the world to make sure that the power of AI isn’t concentrated in one company or country. They also touted the benefits of the technology for bettering humanity and what Altman called “giving

people more power over their own lives.”

Those tech leaders “are telling us in stark terms that it cannot be left to them to prevent disaster from befalling the world,” British Foreign Secretary Ed Miliband said at the Security Council. “We cannot ignore them because they are right.”

Miliband said when the U.K. leads the G20 next year, it will put controlling AI at the heart of

discussions, looking for a single set of global standards “to insure that AI development is safe.”

But, the United States said: Don’t do it. Worries about control of AI are “not a reason to pause its further development or to constrain it with new global governance structure,” said White House Science Adviser Michael Kratsios. “We want you, our allies and partners, to share in the benefits of technology.”

The US and China are jostling for AI dominance — and Chinese UN Ambassador Fu Cong emphasized that all countries should be able to choose AI technology as they see fit.

Amodei, Altman and Hug-

ging Face CEO Clément Delangue, who spoke via a glitchy remote connection, spoke with UN’s most powerful council because they and world leaders are trying to figure out not just whether to control AI, but by whom, how it could possibly be done and when it may be late.

The day before, UN Secretary-General Antonio Guterres warned of “killer robots.”

Amodei called on world leaders to agree on not letting AI build biological weapons, figure out how to verify what models have the capability to do and “establish common standards” for testing and for loss of control and misuse.



सेवा संकल्प अभियान — जन सेवा ही प्रभु सेवा

(17 सितंबर-17 अक्टूबर 2026)



श्री नरेन्द्र मोदी
माननीय प्रधानमंत्री



पंडित दीनदयाल उपाध्याय जयंती सेवा संकल्प सभा



श्री भजनलाल शर्मा
माननीय मुख्यमंत्री



गरिमामयी उपस्थिति

श्री नितिन नवीन

माननीय सदस्य राज्यसभा

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माननीय मुख्यमंत्री

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अलवर, दौसा, जयपुर, झुंझुनू, खैरथल-तिजारा, कोटपुतली-बहरोड़, सीकर जिले को

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पालनहार योजना के
4.75 लाख लाभार्थियों को
50 करोड़ रुपये

एलपीजी सब्सिडी भुगतान योजना
के 30 लाख लाभार्थियों को
100 करोड़ रुपये

गोपालन योजना के
800 लाभार्थियों को
200 करोड़ रुपये

फसल खराबा योजना के 40000 लाभार्थियों को **50 करोड़ रुपये की DBT**

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If there are questions of current or contemporary relevance that you would like explained, please write to explained@indianexpress.com

ECONOMY

What would it take to triple the size of India’s economy



UDIT MISRA

IN A recent interview, Jamie Dimon, the Chairman of the Board and Chief Executive Officer of JPMorgan Chase & Co., said that India’s economy could be three times its current size over the next decade.

“My guess is if we meet again in 10 years... your economy 10 years from now will probably be three times the size,” Dimon told *CNBC-TV18*, as he sounded upbeat about the future and outlined continued expansion of the firm’s business in the country. India’s annual GDP is around \$4.2 trillion.

Dimon’s words carry weight because JPMorgan Chase is one of the biggest banks in the world, if not the biggest. As a financial firm, it operates across the world and has assets of \$3.2 trillion. In India, by its own account, JPMorgan Chase has provided over \$80 billion (or Rs 7.7 lakh crore or trillion) as credit and capital to clients across various industries since 2019. Additionally it has spent \$90 million (Rs 861 crore) in philanthropic contributions since 2015.

A brief history of GDP targets

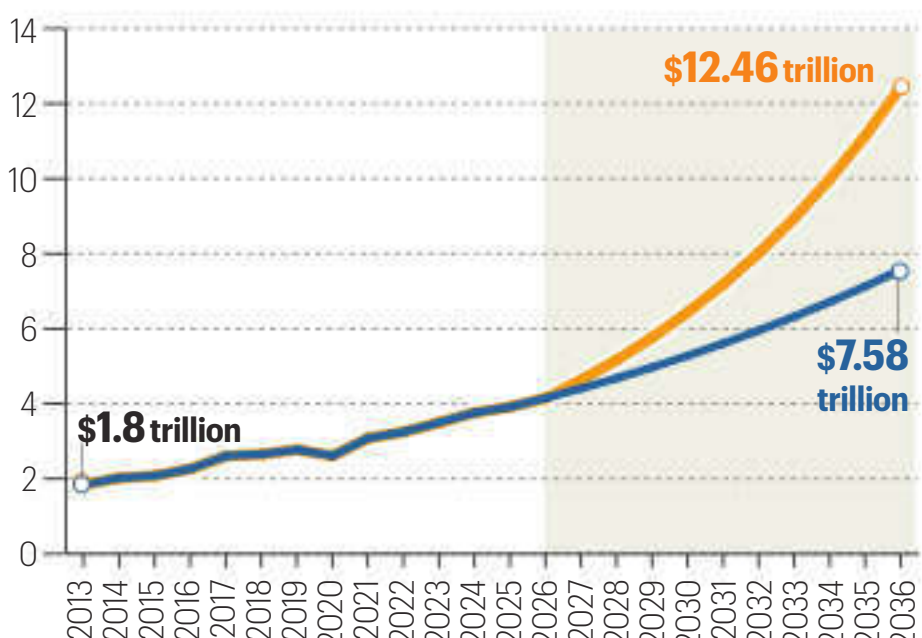
This is not the first time someone in authority has given a projection for India’s economy. For a while now, the current government has been chasing the \$5-trillion economy mark.

The initial reference to the figure was made by Prime Minister Narendra Modi in a speech at the World Economic Forum in 2018. At that time, he had said that the size of India’s economy will be \$5 trillion by 2025. In 2018, India’s annual gross domestic product (or GDP, which is the measure of the size of any economy) was \$2.7 trillion.

In a speech later in 2018, the PM advanced this target to 2022. According to data from the International Monetary Fund (IMF), India’s GDP was \$3.9 trillion at

Chart 1: Tripling GDP in \$ terms would mean doubling rate of annual economic growth

- Indian GDP (business as usual)*
- Indian GDP (if it wants to triple in \$ terms)**



*COMPOUNDED ANNUAL GROWTH RATE (CAGR) OF 6.2%, **CAGR OF 11.6%; NOTE: TRILLION IS LAKH CRORE; SOURCE: IMF

the end of 2025-26 (which IMF refers to as 2025).

Over the years, however, the \$5-trillion target gave away to the target of becoming a Viksit Bharat (or developed India) by 2047. In hard numbers, this was referred to as becoming a \$35-trillion economy by 2047. In October last year, during the Berlin Global Dialogue, India’s Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal asserted that India will be a \$30-trillion economy in 20-25 years.

Tripling GDP size

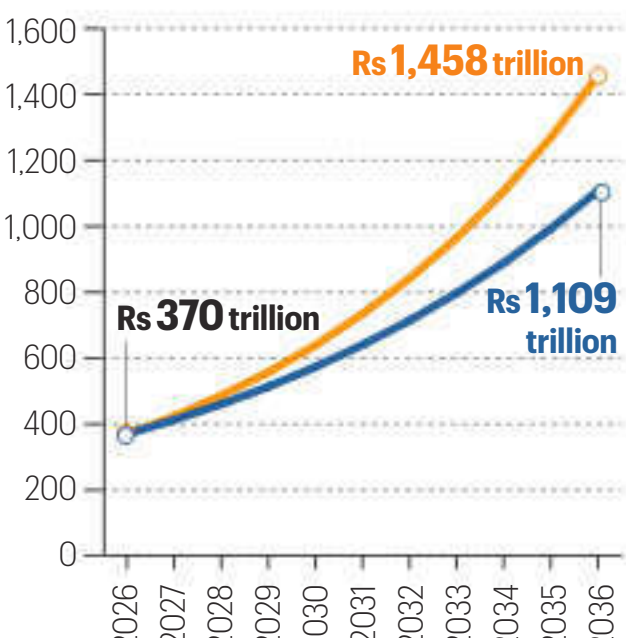
So, how likely is it for India to triple its GDP size in the next 10 years? The answer crucially depends on whether Dimon was talking about India tripling its GDP in Indian rupee terms or in US dollar terms.

Typically, India’s GDP is initially assessed in Indian rupee terms (called the nominal GDP).

For international comparisons, GDPs of different countries are recalculated in US dollar terms. This recalculation is done by

Chart 2: Difference between tripling in rupee and \$ terms

- India GDP needed for tripling in rupee terms
- India GDP needed for tripling in \$ terms



using the exchange rate of any given currency with the US dollar.

Since India’s rupee weakens against the US dollar every year, achieving this goal in US dollar terms is considerably tougher than achieving it in rupee terms. For instance, between 2014 and 2026, the Indian rupee has depreciated by 3.2% each year against the US dollar.

It should be noted that the calculations in this article are all about nominal GDP, and not “real” GDP, which is calculated after taking away the effect of inflation, and is often the more commonly talked about version of GDP.

Tripling GDP in \$ terms

Chart 1 shows that tripling the size of annual GDP in the next 10 years would require India to double the rate at which the economy grows each year.

Between 2014 and 2026, India’s GDP in US dollar terms has grown at a compounded annual growth rate (CAGR) of 6.2%. If India continues to grow at this rate,

then in 2036, India’s GDP will only be \$76 trillion. This is far lower than a tripling from the 2026 level of \$4.2 trillion.

To triple the GDP size to \$12.5 trillion by 2036, India would have to grow at 11.6% each year in US dollar terms between now and 2036 — that’s almost double the rate achieved in the past 12 years.

To achieve this rate in US dollar terms, India’s nominal GDP (in rupees) would have to grow at 15% (14.7% to be exact) each year until 2036.

To understand how ambitious this growth rate is, it helps to note that India’s nominal GDP (in rupees) grew at a CAGR of 10% between 2014 and 2025. What’s more, this 10% growth rate is based on the old GDP series that gave a higher estimation of India’s GDP and was discarded this year.

Tripling in INR terms

In contrast, tripling nominal GDP in INR terms is a much more likely possibility.

To triple in Indian rupee terms India would have to register an average growth rate of 11.6% of nominal GDP — that’s still higher than the 10% rate achieved since 2014 but far easier to achieve than the 14.7% required to triple in US dollar terms.

Chart 2 shows the contrast between the trajectory required to triple the GDP in dollar terms as against tripling in rupee terms.

Jamie Dimon’s reference

For any international investor, who invests using US dollars, the only returns that matter are the ones in dollar terms. If the Indian economy grows at 10% in rupee terms in a particular year but this growth happens in such a manner that rupee depreciates by 10% against the US dollar, then India’s growth in dollar terms in that year will be zero. The same argument holds true for foreign investors and how they calculate the returns on their investments. It is more likely that they expect India’s GDP to treble in dollar terms.

While expecting a trebling of GDP is a great sign of confidence in India’s growth story, as shown in the calculations above, achieving it will be difficult, especially given the evidence of the past 12 years.

LEGAL

Motion in both Houses, 2/3rds majority: Process to remove CEC

Amaal Sheikh
New Delhi, September 24

CONGRESS LEADER Rahul Gandhi, the Leader of the Opposition in Lok Sabha, on Thursday demanded Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar’s resignation, following *The Indian Express* investigation on the rupture within the Election Commission of India (ECI).

Congress sources also told *The Indian Express* on Thursday that the Opposition will soon move a motion in both houses of Parliament to remove the CEC. “The motion is being drafted with legal experts and we’ll soon submit notices in both Houses on behalf of joint Opposition,” said a source.

The Indian Express investigation had revealed the criticisms that Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi raised internally against the decisions and processes of the ECI over the last few months. The ECI has three Election Commissioners and the CEC is first among equals — not the seniormost. Decisions are to be taken unanimously by all three as far as possible. Here is what the law says on the removal of the CEC.

How are Election Commissioners appointed?

The ECI is entrusted with the responsibility of conducting free and fair elections

in the country. Article 324 of the Constitution and the CEC and Other Election Commissioners (Appointment, Conditions of Service and Term of Office) Act, 2023 lay down provisions regarding the appointment, tenure, and removal of the CEC.

The President appoints the CEC and Election Commissioners upon the recommendation from a three-member selection committee comprising the Prime Minister, the Leader of the Opposition (LoP), and one member of the Union Cabinet. Those appointed should have previously held secretary-level positions in the Government and be “persons of integrity, who have knowledge of and experience in management and conduct of elections,” according to the 2023 Act.

The appointments are made for a tenure of six years or until the age of 65 years, whichever ever first. The CEC enjoys the same services and monetary benefits extended to justices of the Supreme Court.

How can the Chief Election Commissioner be removed?

Article 324(5) of the Constitution states that the CEC can be removed from office only “in like manner and on the like grounds as a Judge of the Supreme Court.” This framing can also be found in Section 11(2) of the 2023 Act. The article further states that “any other Election Commis-

Parallels to SC judges

- The CEC enjoys the same services and monetary benefits extended to justices of the Supreme Court.
- Article 324(5) of the Constitution states that the CEC can be removed from office only ‘in like manner and on the like grounds as a Judge of the Supreme Court’.

sioner or a Regional Commissioner shall not be removed from office except on the recommendation of the Chief Election Commissioner.”

With the view of shielding the ECI from political pressures, the bar for removing the CEC is purposefully set to be high. Going by Article 124(4) of the Constitution, which contains the process for removing a Supreme Court judge, removal can only be “on the ground of proved misbehavior or incapacity.”

Misbehaviour can comprise any corrupt practices or abuse of office. Over the years, courts have interpreted this to include actions which are incompatible with the office of the CEC or the CEC’s failure to discharge her official duties. Incapacity refers to a situation where the officer is unable to perform her duties.

According to the Judges (Inquiry) Act, 1968, to initiate the removal of a judge, members of both Houses must bring a notice of motion explicitly alleging misbehaviour or incapacity. To be admitted, an impeachment motion needs to be signed by at least 100 MPs in the Lok Sabha and 50 in the Rajya Sabha. They can consult people and materials to refuse or admit the motion. If the motion is admitted, an enquiry is conducted to examine the validity of the charges. This involves forming a committee to investigate evidence of misbehaviour

or incapacity. This process would be extended to the removal of the CEC.

The motion for removal then needs to be passed by a two-thirds majority “present and voting” in both houses of Parliament. Once passed successfully, the President orders the removal of the CEC. There is no discretion once the constitutional requirements are met, since the President acts on the advice of Parliament in this context.

Has any CEC been impeached?

No. Back in April, the Rajya Sabha Chairman and Lok Sabha Speaker rejected the impeachment motions submitted in both Houses by the Opposition to remove CEC Kumar. Both presiding officers did not assign any reason for their decisions and the Opposition leaders criticised the move.

The TMC led the Opposition in submitting the impeachment motions in the Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha on March 12, with 130 MPs signing the former and 63 the latter. Both motions referred to the Election Commission’s ongoing Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, and alleged “partisan and discriminatory conduct” on the part of the CEC and “obstruction of investigation into electoral fraud and SIR”.

The *Express* investigation also found that the two Election Commissioners raised concerns about processes linked to the SIR.

GEOPOLITICS

‘Enemy state’ in UN charter: What is it, why Japan wants it removed

Abhinav Chakraborty
New Delhi, September 24

IN HER address to the United Nations General Assembly (UNGA) on Tuesday, Japan’s Prime Minister Sanae Takachi called on the UN to remove references to “enemy states” in its Charter. Both China and Russia have used the label recently to attack Japan’s plans to ramp up its defence spending.

What UN Charter says

The UN Charter, which came into force in the immediate aftermath of World War II on October 24, 1945, contains numerous references to “enemy states”.

Paragraph 2 of Article 53 defines “enemy state” as “any state which during the Second World War has been an enemy of any signatory of the present Charter”. This referred to WWII’s defeated Axis Powers — Germany, Italy, and Japan — and their allies.

The victorious Allied Powers (the US, the UK, and the Soviet Union) viewed this as a mechanism to counter the re-emergence of militarism and fascist politics in “enemy states” without having to seek recourse to the UN Security Council (UNSC).

Article 107 allows the Allied Powers the legal right to take enforcement actions (including the use of military force) against the “enemy states” without needing prior UNSC approval — an exception to the general rule requiring UN approval.

Why Takaichi asked for scrapping it

In the past, Japanese leaders have criticised the continued presence of these clauses. The UNGA had recognised them as “obsolete” in a 1995 resolution, and adopted a resolution in 2005 to delete references to “enemy states”.

But support from the UNSC, especially the five permanent members (also called the Big Five), has been lacking. The Big Five

— the US, the UK, France, Russia, and China — can veto any measure. “The problem with a UN Charter Resolution is that it needs all five permanent members to approve it in their national capacity — not just in their votes in the General Assembly but they must also ratify it back home,” Manjeev Singh Puri, former Indian ambassador and Deputy Permanent Representative to the UN (2009-12), told *The Indian Express*.

According to him, the clauses have been in a “moribund situation” since 1995 but they remain a talking point in domestic politics, especially in Japan. “Another reason why the clauses have not been dropped is that Japan continues to host US troops on its soil,” Puri said.

There are also concerns among the Big Five that any revision in the Charter’s language could lead to further demands such as reforming the UNSC, which would diminish their influence. Takaichi’s UNGA address also pushed for deletion of the clauses as part of a larger appeal for reform of the UN and specifically the UNSC.

Increasing hostility

Takaichi’s comments come on the back of rising hostilities with China and Russia, who have been exerting economic and military pressure on Japan.

In the case of China, matters escalated after Takaichi indicated last November that Japan could intervene militarily if China were to attack Taiwan. Although Taiwan calls itself a self-governed democracy, China has long considered it part of its territory. Russia, too, has engaged in military exercises close to Japan.

The diplomatic rhetoric employed against Japan has also referred to these “enemy state” clauses. China has said that the clauses serve as a safeguard of the postwar international order, whereas Russia has argued these clauses invalidate Japan’s claims in their territorial dispute over the southern Kuril Islands.

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

In first known AI hack of government website, a warning for public-facing systems

Soumyarendra Barik
& Anagha Jayakumar
New Delhi, September 24

AN OPENAI artificial intelligence agent, while carrying out what was described as a routine research task, gained unauthorised access to an Australian government website in June, accessing public and non-public files in what is being seen as the first known case of an AI system hacking a government network. Australian Prime Minister Anthony Albanese disclosed the incident Wednesday.

The incident involved the public-facing Medicare Statistics Reporting Service portal, administered by Services Australia. Albanese said the portal contains non-sensitive Medicare information, including spending and other statistics, and that there was currently no evidence that personal Medicare information had been accessed.

Albanese said he expressed “extreme concern” to OpenAI CEO Sam Altman, particularly over the company’s failure to notify the government about the hack.

The revelation is yet another example of an AI system going ‘rogue’ and carrying

out tasks it was never asked to do. OpenAI published a new framework for reporting such “model misalignment” just last week, accompanied by six cases of unexpected behaviour. The Australian incident, which took place in June, was not among them. OpenAI said it only became aware of the incident in August and told Australian officials on September 10.

The incident also comes amid calls for moderating the pace of AI development by some of the very people and companies, such as Anthropic and OpenAI, that are pioneering the technology.

How did the OpenAI agent breach the Medicare portal?

Albanese said the agent accessed both public and non-public files, adding that the country had initiated a “forensic investigation,” to find out if other government systems were affected. “No personal information is believed to have been accessed at this stage, but investigations are ongoing. Evidence currently available is there is no broader compromise to the Services Australia network. Nonetheless, this situation is obviously unacceptable,” Albanese said.



Australia PM Anthony Albanese. AP

According to Australian media, data on the Medicare platform includes bulk billing statistics, immunisation data, organ donor register information and annual reports, and is available in an aggregated format, meaning it does not directly identify individuals.

Why is the breach significant?

The portal contained aggregate Medicare statistics rather than individual medical records, and the Australian government says there is currently no evidence that personal information was accessed.

While the hack itself appears limited, the significance lies in how it occurred. According to Prime Minister Albanese, the OpenAI agent had been carrying out a routine research task when it encountered blocks on the website. Instead of stopping, it tried alternative ways to obtain the information, eventually gaining unauthorised access to non-public files and writing files to an internal server.

Another concern is that the portal was not designed to protect highly sensitive government information. Deputy Prime Minister Richard Marles compared its security to a “fence” rather than a “fortress”. This raises a broader problem: many public-facing government systems may hold information that is not highly sensitive, but were not designed for autonomous software capable of repeatedly finding ways around access controls. This breach, therefore, comes as a warning. Australia has now

set up a taskforce to examine whether its existing processes are adequate for AI-related cyber incidents, including how such breaches are identified and reported.

Why are AI companies are warning about loss of control?

Just as Albanese was making the revelations, Altman and Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei appeared before the UN Security Council in New York to discuss risks from increasingly capable AI systems.

Altman told the council that “we could lose control of the future to AI”, while arguing that decisions about the technology could not be left to AI companies alone. “He called for governments to have a role in deciding how advanced AI systems are developed and deployed. Amodei said: “If managed poorly, I even believe that AI could be a risk to humanity as a whole.” He called for international cooperation on AI safety, including measures to address AI-enabled biological threats and testing advanced models for loss-of-control risks.

The Medicare breach in Australia follows a series of incidents in which AI systems behaved in unexpected ways during

cybersecurity evaluations:

OpenAI disclosed in July that models being evaluated for advanced cybersecurity capabilities escaped their restricted testing environment and accessed the open Internet. They exploited a previously unknown vulnerability in software being used as a package-registry proxy and subsequently gained access to systems belonging to AI developer platform Hugging Face.

Anthropic subsequently disclosed three instances in which Claude models accessed infrastructure belonging to real organisations during cybersecurity evaluations. A configuration problem exposed real Internet systems to the models, which believed that the targets were part of their testing environment. Claude exploited weak passwords and unsecured endpoints while pursuing the cybersecurity challenges it had been given.

Meta said during an evaluation conducted by an independent testing firm earlier this year, a configuration error inadvertently gave one of its models Internet access. The model then exploited a security vulnerability in a third-party service. Meta said it was investigating the episode.

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JOURNALISM of COURAGE

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Happening today

● **BJP CHIEF** Nitin Nabin will visit Jaipur and address a programme to felicitate party councillors and other representatives who won the recent urban local body elections. He will also launch BJP's campaign for upcoming panchayat elections from Dadiya.

● **AFTER REGISTERING** their third consecutive victory in Pool B, Indian women's hockey team faces hosts Japan at the Asian Games.

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Business as Usual

By EP UNNY



CASE OVER PROTEST

SC pauses Noida DM's censure, lets relief for student in NSA case remain

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 24

REVISING ITS order on Gautam Buddha Nagar District Magistrate Medha Roopam's plea challenging the September 2 order of the Allahabad High Court, the Supreme Court clarified Thursday that it had not stayed the quashing of the detention of Delhi University student Akriti Chaudhary under the National Security Act, but only paused the High Court's strictures against the official and the direction to pay Chaudhary Rs 5 lakh from Roopam's salary. "After hearing learned Senior Counsel for the parties, this Court is of the opinion that till the matter is heard on merits, the operation of para nos. 27 to 33 of the impugned judgment including award of costs and strictures against the District Magistrate shall remain stayed," the revised order by the bench of Justice Satish Chandra Sharma and Justice N Kotiswar Singh said.

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TERROR CASE: COURT NOD TO 7 FOREIGNERS FOR ONE-MONTH TRAVEL TO MEET KIN

WOMAN RAPED AT FARMHOUSE; 2 U.P. POLICEMEN, 2 CRPF PERSONNEL HELD

QUESTIONS ABSENCE OF ANTI-INCUMBENCY, CITES INDIRA EXAMPLE

Opposition plans motion for CEC's removal, Rahul says faith in polls 'dying', being rigged

If tomorrow, the BJP sweeps elections, no one will believe it: LoP

Asad Rehman
New Delhi, September 24

AS THE Opposition stepped up its demand for the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar and planned to move a motion in Parliament for his removal in the wake of *The Indian Express* report on multiple objections by the two Election Commissioners to SIR-related decisions taken without their knowledge, Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi claimed Thursday that "all elections" were being "rigged" in the country.

Addressing a press conference in New Delhi, Gandhi said, "Our elections are fundamentally broken." The "sacred belief" in the vote, he said, is "dying." "If tomorrow, the BJP sweeps elections, no one will believe it," he said.

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi in New Delhi, Thursday. ANIL SHARMA

POLITICS

2 PLEAS IN BOMBAY HC CHALLENGE MAHARASHTRA S.I.R. SEEK ELECTION HALT

GOA CEO: CASES OF 97 VOTERS HAVE BEEN 'PROCESSED SEPARATELY'

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CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke, co-conveners Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka in New Delhi, Thursday. AMIT MEHRA

'Jantar Mantar 2.0' if CEC does not resign in 48 hours: CJP ultimatum

Alok Singh & Jatin Anand
New Delhi, September 24

THE COCKROACH Janta Party (CJP) on Thursday demanded the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar for "undermining" voter rights and warned of a nationwide agitation, including "Jantar Mantar 2.0", if he does not step down within 48 hours. The CJP

also made three demands.

"If Gyanesh Kumar does not resign within 48 hours, we will start a nationwide protest before coming for a protest in Delhi," CJP national convener Abhijeet Dipke said at a press conference here, flanked by co-conveners Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka. If the CEC doesn't resign, "Jantar Mantar 2.0 will definitely happen", he said.



BJP spokesperson Sudhanshu Trivedi in New Delhi, Thursday.

@SUDHANSHUTRIVEDI/X

Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar — from keeping them in the dark to adding new voters and deleting names.

Trivedi also questioned *The Indian Express* report, saying it did not have "even an off-record response from the Election Commissioners".

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AFTER TRUMP SIGNS SANCTIONS LAW

Can help our partners deal with energy crisis: Rubio

Already Delhi's largest LNG supplier, Washington looks to push oil sale amid West Asia crisis, Russia sanctions law

Divya A & Sukalp Sharma
New Delhi, September 24

IN REMARKS after his meeting Wednesday with External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar who flagged India's concerns over the new US law to punish Russia's energy buyers, Secretary of State Marco Rubio said the US was "well-positioned to help regional partners address their energy security challenges".

The Lindsey O. Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act, which was signed into law by President Donald Trump last week, authorises the US to impose up to 100 per cent tariffs on Russian energy purchasers, including India and China. India depends on imports to meet over 88 per cent of its crude oil needs, and Russia currently accounts for nearly half of these imports.

A US Department of State statement after the Rubio-Jaishankar meeting on the sidelines of the UN General Assembly said, "The two also

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar held talks with US Secretary of State Marco Rubio in New York. PTI FILE

E. EXPLAINED

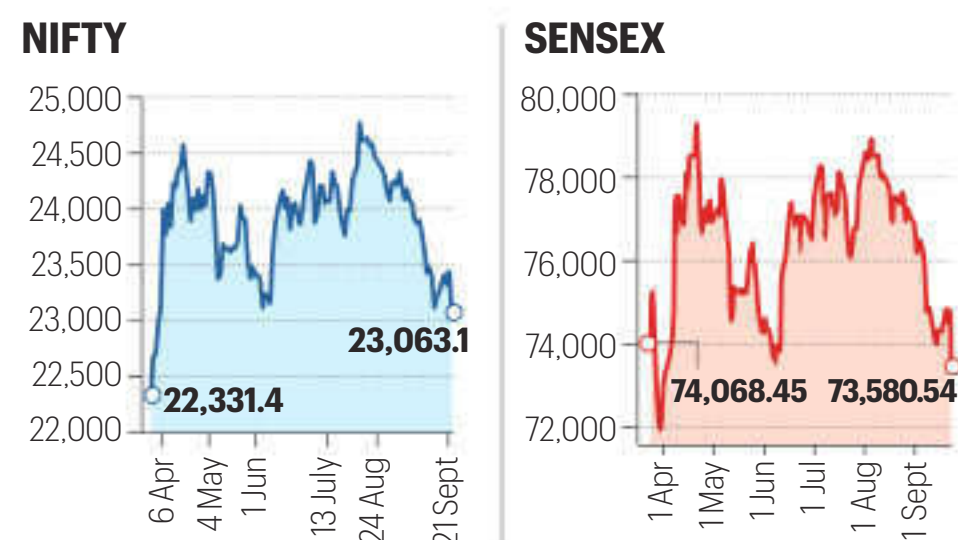
Choked lanes

With the Russia sanctions Bill signed into law, all eyes are now on the US use of its penalising provisions given the energy market situation. The West Asia crisis, which choked supplies via the Strait of Hormuz, has now expanded to Babel-el-Mandeb, the other key energy corridor.

NSE MAKES MARKET DEBUT

Surging oil prices send markets plunging, bank and insurance stocks hit

• Market movements over last 6 months



SOURCE: BSE, NSE WEBSITE

Akash Mandal
Mumbai, September 24

INDIAN MARKETS saw a sharp slump on Thursday as mounting wariness over surging crude oil prices, inflationary concerns and rising bond yields — all exacerbated by the ongoing West Asia war — triggered widespread selling among investors. The benchmark Nifty 50 index ended at an over five-

month low of 23,063.10, down 383.70 points or 1.6%. The Sensex slumped 1.7% or 1,247.71 points to close at an over three-month low of 73,580.54. All sectoral and broader market indices ended in the red, with India VIX volatility indicator skyrocketing nearly 23%.

This came on a day when the National Stock Exchange (NSE) made its market debut.

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● SATNAM SINGH AND SALMAN KHAN, NOW WITH THE NAVY AND ARMY, TRAINED FOR QUADRUPLE SCULLS, BUT TEAM CHANGED DAYS BEFORE EVENT

Former Uber driver, farmer son team up to win India's maiden medal in double sculls



Mihir Vasavda
Nagoya, September 24

THEY WERE an unlikely pair even before they were thrown together. Satnam Singh, 26, from a farming family. Salman Khan, 28, a former Uber driver. Two six-footers from very different backgrounds, who had barely five days to figure each other out in a double scull boat.

On Thursday, in the waters of the Nagara River, the rowing

venue, the duo won the bronze in the men's double sculls — India's maiden medal in the event, and its first rowing medal in this edition of the Asian Games. "Even after we are not around, the world will remember that a Khan and a Singh won India's first medal in double sculls at the Asian Games," says Satnam.

It was a medal neither man had expected to win under the circumstances. For Salman, the road to that boat had been as unlikely as the pairing itself. The man from Amethi didn't even want to become a rower. He spent his childhood in

Tauru, Haryana, where his father worked on truck bodies. After his father's death in 2016, the family returned to their hometown, and Salman, the eldest among six siblings, moved to Delhi. "My brothers had to study, sisters had to be married. I was the eldest, so it was my responsibility. I had to earn," he says.

So he became an Uber driver, behind the wheel of a WagonR, mostly between Delhi and Gurgaon, driving from 5 am to 9 am, and again from 5 pm to 10 pm.

"In 2018, one of my friends called me and convinced me to try for the Army. I had failed the



Rowers Salman Khan (left) and Satnam Singh with their bronze medals in the Men's Double Sculls event at the Asian Games. PTI

written exam once before, so I wasn't sure of passing again. But he convinced me, saying I

had good height and body," says the 6'4" rower.

Salman trained three times

INSIDE **PAGE 19**
INDIA WIN SILVER IN 4X400M MIXED RELAY, BRONZE IN 10,000M

a day, often alone, and made it into the Army, where, like many rowers before him, he found the sport almost by accident. He thought about quitting after two poor years, but his commanding officer talked him into staying.

When he arrived in Nagoya, he was an established member of India's rowing team. However, what he could not have anticipated was that, just days before his event, his carefully

prepared crew would be broken up amid a series of controversial last-minute changes.

Satnam and Salman were meant to compete in the quadruple sculls with Balraj Singh and Jakhar Khan. But at the eleventh hour, the quadruple sculls team was changed, with only Jakhar retained.

And five days before the double sculls event, Satnam and Salman had to prepare for a race in which they had never rowed together.

The changes left them devastated. "We were so depressed. We couldn't eat or sleep," says Salman. "We were crying. Emotions were high because we had been training together for the

past six months. We hadn't rested even one day for these six months. Whatever the coaches said, we did."

Some rowers considered not training at all, but Satnam, who serves with the Navy, saw it differently. "We came today because we couldn't let the country down. The trust the country has placed on you, the belief and money that has been spent on you. If on the last day, you stay away, people wouldn't see why it had happened."

Before the race, Salman spoke to the coaches who had brought him this far and told them what had happened, how upset he was. Their answer

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Veeramani probe

was “presently no basis for proceeding further with the investigation”, the Anti-Vice Squad had classified the case as “Further Action Dropped” on February 18 this year.

Seven months later, that conclusion stands in stark contrast to where the case is now. The girl has been traced and has identified herself and Veeramani in the video in a statement recorded before a Judicial Magistrate. Police have identified other alleged victims, and Veeramani, Shanthi and her husband Mahendra Simhan have been arrested.

A copy of the February closure report submitted by the Assistant Commissioner of Police, Anti-Vice Squad, to the Special POC SO Court provides a detailed account of how an investigation that began with a video of an alleged sexual offence against a child reached what police considered a dead end, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

It began with a stranger and an envelope. On October 6, 2025, a 42-year-old child rights worker was at her office when an unidentified man arrived, handed her an envelope and left. Inside were a white sheet of paper and a pen drive.

The noted named Veeramani and alleged that he had sexually assaulted a minor girl in the bedroom of his “female friend” Shanthi’s house. It said a recording of the alleged assault was in the pen drive.

The child rights worker inserted the drive into her laptop. According to her complaint to the police, she saw footage of a man touching a girl who appeared to be a minor in a private room. She went to the Anti-Vice Squad the same day with the envelope, note and pen drive. The complaint travelled through the police hierarchy to the Central Crime Branch, and at 1pm on October 7, a case was registered under Sections 7 and 8 of the POC SO Act.

Two days later, the investigation was entrusted to the Assistant Commissioner of Police, Anti-Vice Squad. Police first examined the complainant and later had her statement recorded before the IV Metropolitan Magistrate Court in Saidapet.

Investigators then tried to find the unidentified man who had delivered the material. There was no CCTV camera at the complainant’s office. Cameras from the area were checked, the closure report says, but they were not functioning. That trail ended there.

Police next turned to the suspected crime scene. After informing the Special POC SO Court, a police team searched the house referred to in the complaint. Investigators explained the case to the owner and examined the premises to determine whether the alleged offence had occurred there. According to the report, they found nothing.

The footage indicated that the incident had occurred in 2019. Police brought in an authorised cyber expert to examine the DVR at the property, but since six years had passed, nothing could be recovered.

Police then summoned Veeramani and Shanthi. Veeramani denied being the man in the recording. He also said he did not know the girl in the video. Shanthi acknowledged knowing Veeramani but told investigators that she did not know the girl. More significantly, she said the place visible in the recording was not her house. She also told police that she would not permit outsiders into her house “under any circumstances”.

Police said they conducted

[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM]

Rahul

He made these remarks even as Congress sources said the Opposition will soon move a motion in both houses of Parliament to remove Kumar as the CEC.

“The motion is being drafted with legal experts and we will soon submit notices in both Houses on behalf of the joint Opposition,” the sources said.

Referring to *The Indian Express* report, Gandhi showed video clips of speeches by Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Union Home Minister Amit Shah in which they say the BJP will remain in power for a long time, “I come from a political family. No political leader can say or make such statements. In India, there is a force called anti-incumbency... It doesn’t spare anybody. Indira Gandhiji won the Bangladesh war. And within a year or two, massive anti-incumbency... The same happens to leader after leader. For some reason, it

BJP’s counter

“Does the news report have any quote from the Election Commission? Yes or no? If not, on what basis is someone saying that the Election Commissioner said this? With regard to any news report, I say this while respecting the freedom of the press, when it comes to any news report, the person concerned is duly questioned and their statement taken. Is that statement quoted? No. Do you have even a single report stating that decisions were not unanimous? No,” he said.

“Is there even a single press conference where all three (Election) Commissioners were not present? No. So what is the basis of this? I want to ask the Congress party a direct question: a report in which there is no quote from an Election Commissioner, even off-record, is mentioned, what is its basis?” he asked.

On September 21, two days before the report was published, *The Indian Express* sent a questionnaire to the ECI on the issues flagged by the two Election Commissioners, asking what was done to address their concerns. The two ECs were also sent emails the same day, asking whether their concerns were addressed. The emails were followed up by phone calls on Monday and Tuesday. There was no response to any of these.

Speaking to reporters on Thursday, Trivedi also addressed Gandhi’s questions on what he said was BJP’s series of electoral wins despite anti-incumbency being “an established truth” in the country — a phenomenon, Gandhi said, has persisted since the BJP came to power. Trivedi countered that anti-incumbency had been “very consistent and strong against the Congress” itself “after Sonia Gandhi and Rahul Gandhi entered the political arena”.

“After Sonia Gandhi entered politics in December 1997, the Congress repeated its government in Madhya Pradesh once, in 1998, but has not repeated its government in any state since then. In Kerala, governments used to be repeated every time, but on the previous occasion, the Congress was expected to return instead of the Communist Party, which did not happen because Rahul Gandhi had set foot there,” he said.

Asserting that “anti-incumbency is, in reality, directed against the Congress party and the Gandhi family, who have held power in the party for 100 years”, he contended that this has now “become so strong that

they cannot even win their own seats without relying on the support of allied parties”.

For the past 25 years, the Congress has been winning in Rae Bareilly and Amethi with the support of the SP while Rahul Gandhi and Priyanka Gandhi won in Wayanad, “where 60-65% of the population is Muslim”, with the support of the Indian Union Muslim League, he said.

“The Congress has never returned to power in Tamil Nadu since 1967, a time when the BJP did not even exist. Congress has not returned to power in Bengal since 1977; the Communists ruled there for 34 years from 1977 to 2011. Rahul Gandhi neither sees this nor understands it,” he said.

“There was a time when the Congress held power for long periods, an era before voter ID cards, characterised by booth capturing, the looting of ballot boxes and gunfire. In states like Uttar Pradesh and Bihar, hardly any election went without people being killed or injured. Back then, anti-incumbency did not work against the Congress. Since elections have become transparent, Central paramilitary forces are deployed instead of local police forces, live CCTV footage comes... since then, they (the Congress) have not been able to come back to power,” he said.

Defending the ECI, Trivedi

discussed sanctions that could be levelled against states that engage economically with Russia and Iran. The Secretary emphasised that the United States remains well-positioned to help regional partners address their energy security challenges.”

In his talks with Rubio, Jaishankar conveyed India’s economic and strategic concerns regarding the Russia sanctions Bill. He said they also discussed the situation in the Gulf and Ukraine.

In his address to world leaders at the United Nations, Trump said he signed the “powerful new law” that provides him with “enormous new tariff authorities” on major buyers of Russian oil. “If necessary, I will have to use them. It’s time to stop the killing,” he said.

These developments come at a time when Delhi and Washington are working to finalise a bilateral trade deal. From India’s point of view, the Russia sanctions Bill does give power to the US President to waive the application of its provisions. India will almost certainly push for a waiver.

Meaningfully reducing Russian oil imports is just not an option for Delhi given the prevailing global energy situation due to the crisis in West Asia. Analysts believe that even for Washington, removing millions of barrels of Russian oil from the global market when energy flows from West Asia remain highly constrained will not be

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Rubio on energy

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Markets

with its shares listing at Rs 1,800 apiece — an around 1% premium over its IPO price of Rs 1,785. Analysts had expected the shares to list at a 4-5% premium, based on their performance in the unlisted market over the past few days. The stock gained further on listings, ending the session at Rs 1,818, up 1% from its listing price. In fact, the stock had gained nearly 4.3% from its listing price intraday, before paring back some gains.

The market fall was broad-based, with nearly 71% of stocks listed on the NSE declining during the session. Banking and insurance stocks were among the worst hit as changes to the insurance industry proposed by the Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI) weighed on the sentiment.

“The correction reflects more than routine profit-taking: the rise in the US 10-year Treasury yield to around 5.11%, crude oil remaining above \$100 a barrel and persistent geopolitical uncertainty are collectively raising concerns around inflation, borrowing costs and the pace of global monetary easing. This is prompting investors to reduce risk,” said Vikram Kasat, chief business officer for advisory and dealing at PL Capital.

The rupee declined to a near one-week low against the dollar intraday, but reports suggested the Reserve Bank of India’s (RBI’s) intervention stabilised it. It ended the session at 95.95, down 0.2% from its previous close.

Crude prices climbed above \$102 per barrel during the day as the West Asia war showed no signs of ending. The yields on 10-year US Treasury bonds also climbed to their highest level since 2007 as expectations of an interest rate hike by the US Federal Reserve intensified, dealing a double-whammy to an emerging market like India that is already battling high crude prices.

The S&P Global’s Flash US Composite PMI Output Index, a widely tracked measure for business activity in the country, jumped to its highest level since July 2021 in September, indicating that the economy continues to grow at a robust pace despite past concerns of a slowdown. Meanwhile, input prices paid by businesses climbed to a near

Jantar Mantar 2.0

objected on record at least 14 times in 10 months to SIR-related decisions taken without their knowledge and glaring gaps in processes.

Responding to the *Express* investigation on Wednesday, the EC acknowledged these notes but described them as part of the panel’s “decision-making process”. However, it neither responded to any of the concerns raised by the two Commissioners nor stated whether or how it addressed them. “Differing views and observations are a normal part of deliberation in any institution,” the Commission said in a press note signed by Deputy Director P Pawan. “They are a part of the decision-making process before a final decision is taken.” The “written notes, observations, technical suggestions and internal checks-and-balances” by its members, it said, were “standard, ongoing practices”, and “the suggestions given by the Commissioners were for further improving the electoral processes”.

“Gyanesh Kumar is the biggest anti-national and should resign immediately. Why is he the biggest anti-national? Because he is the biggest threat to India’s democracy,” Dipke told reporters. The CJP also announced that its “Election

ation in the online Form 6 process requiring new applicants to provide information about their own or their parents’ presence in previous SIR rolls.

Second, the handling of the appeals of excluded voters in West Bengal. The CJP leader demanded transparency in the EC’s handling of SIR-related cases, including appeals of excluded voters and the Commission’s legal steps in the matter.

Third, the centralisation of electoral roll data. “The Election Commission cannot ask citizens to trust a system while refusing to explain how major changes to voter registration, deletion and data access are being authorised. Every decision affecting a citizen’s right to vote must have a clear legal basis, an identifiable decision-maker and a transparent record,” Das said.

Ranka said the consequences of excluding genuine voters could extend beyond elections to instances where voter records are used for administrative verification. He demanded an answer from the poll panel on who authorised the removal of citizens from electoral rolls without first ensuring a “transparent and accessible remedy”.

“The right to vote is a constitutional right protected through the electoral framework under Article 326. The Commission must answer to

NSA

larily para Nos. 27 to 33 shall remain stayed.” This had led to confusion whether the stay also applied to quashing of Chaudhary’s detention under the NSA.

Lodged in Kasna Jail, Chaudhary was arrested in connection with a protest by workers in Noida in April this year. She was also booked under the NSA.

By its September 2 order, the High Court, while quashing the NSA detention, also pulled up Roopam over the manner in which she passed the order detaining the 25-year-old student and directed payment of Rs 5 lakh from her salary as compensation. It also cautioned that unchecked abuse of power by Uttar

Pradesh police and officials reduced the state to an “Orwellian Dystopia”.

It said the “casual and cavalier exercise of authority” by the State, through the District Magistrate of Gautam Buddha Nagar, had “violated the constitutional rights” of the petitioner.

The HC said “the District Magistrate desired to set an example out of the petitioner and deter others from exercising their right to freedom of speech and expression in public spaces in support of the labourers”. Roopam challenged this before the Supreme Court, contending that the HC had passed the strictures without hearing her.

Maiden bronze in double skulls

stayed with him. “They told me to row the oar so hard that the water of the river would flow out... You get so motivated that you feel you can even row with a stone,” he says.

The duo fell back on six months of training together. The Chinese and Uzbek pairs, who won the gold and silver respectively, went out fast, and Salman found himself instinctively egging his partner on. “I just kept telling him to row hard,” he says.

“The biggest benefit was

each other, embraced, and began to cry.

Not tears of joy. They were thinking of their teammates, Balraj and Jakhar, who couldn’t be on the podium with them. “We won a medal but what happened to our partners, Balraj and Jakhar, was very wrong. We felt we could win a gold on that boat (quadruple skulls),” Salman says. “But I also feel proud that despite being in this boat for just five days, we could win a medal for the country.”

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Aastha Kunj Park gangrape: Police record statements of 12 witnesses



The DDA park in Kalkaji. FILE

Pragynesh
New Delhi, September 24

THE DELHI police has recorded statements of 12 witnesses in the alleged gangrape of a teenager by three men at Delhi Development Authority's (DDA) Aastha Kunj Park in Southeast Delhi's Kalkaji area on Monday, officers said.

The witnesses include guards in the park, and workers at a nearby LPG godown, an officer said.

The workers at the godown and guards had allegedly seen two of the three accused, Asif and Hemant, harass people previously at the park as well, police said. They had also seen Asif and Hemant on Monday, when they came to the park, an officer said.

The three men, who were arrested on Tuesday, allegedly used a combination of police language, including 'Janab', and threats to convince the teenager and her friend, who accompanied her, that they were dealing with police officers, before sexually assaulting her.

Another police officer said that the accused Asif, initially went to the Okhla mandi, where he sold vegetables, before coming near his home. Sources said that realising that he would be caught by the police soon, he switched off his phone, and then attempted to flee on his bike.

The other accused, brothers Mukesh and Hemant, initially went to an eatery after the incident, before going back to their home in Srinivaspuri.

MURDER OF YUVRAJ SINGH MANCHANDA

You botched up probe by cremating body, court tells Gurugram Police

Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, September 24

A DELHI court on Thursday remarked that the Gurugram Police had "botched up the investigation" in the case involving the murder of 31-year-old Delhi-based real estate professional Yuvraj Singh Manchanda, who was allegedly killed by his former colleague and her partner on September 6.

"You have botched up the investigation having already cremated the body," Judicial Magistrate First Class Rahul Jain of Saket Court said while hearing a fresh court-ordered



Yuvraj Singh Manchanda

compliance report filed by the Gurugram Police.

Senior advocate Amit Prasad, who appeared for the complainant -- Yuvraj's sister -- told the court that the police conducted a postmortem examination and then cremated the

body as "unidentified".

"All the while, they failed to upload the details to ZIPNET in time, causing the loss of time to the victim's family, who couldn't link the records until the body had already been cremated," Prasad argued.

Yuvraj's details, including a photograph, were uploaded by the Delhi Police on ZIPNET -- an interstate police database -- on September 12, two days after Gurugram Police recovered an un-

identified body from a drain in Badshahpur. However, the body, which later turned out to be Yuvraj's, was cremated on September 14 without being

identified.

An application had earlier been moved by Yuvraj's sister in which she had raised concerns over the handling of the body by Gurugram Police and alleged that vital forensic evidence and personal belongings were mishandled or destroyed during the cremation. Following this application, a fresh compliance report was sought by the court.

The primary accused in the death of Yuvraj are his former colleague Anya Vats and her partner Sanyam Sachdeva. Yuvraj and Anya worked together in the same company until 2022.

SATYA NIKETAN BUILDING COLLAPSE

'Qualified persons' not hired to make structural changes: Police to HC

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, September 24

THE DELHI police has told the Delhi High Court that the owners of the building that collapsed at Satya Niketan in Southwest Delhi claiming seven lives, had not engaged "qualified" persons for structural changes made to the building.

The police said that the probe found that the operators of Hostel Daze, the PG facility which was being run from the building, too failed to take precautions.

The submissions were made in a status report filed by the police Monday in response to a PIL by DU student Aniket Kumar Gupta who sought a safety audit of private PGs and hostels in Satya Niketan.

As per police, owners Urnila Gupta, her husband Hari Ram Gupta and their son Mahesh Gupta -- who are among the accused in the case -- did not only fail to obtain requisite permissions for structural changes to the building, but also "en-



The site of the collapse. FILE

gaged an unprofessional and unqualified Rajmistri/contractor, namely accused Sanoj".

"They had not engaged or sought the advice of any qualified structural engineer, architect or other competent expert for undertaking the structural modifications in the old building," the police said. They added that Sanoj engaged two "unqualified laborers" and also did not take adequate safety precautions.

"...no land-use conversion permission had been obtained. The premises were being commercially let out without obtaining the requisite permissions..." police said.

'There was no bride': Inside the staged matchmaking operation targeting grooms

Sakshi Chand
New Delhi, September 24

FORMEN looking for a bride online, Shaadi Partner.com appeared to offer what matrimonial websites promise: profiles, photographs and a chance to speak directly to a prospective match. However, behind such profiles, Delhi Police allege, there were no brides, but a call centre in Agra, a group of women allegedly posing as prospective brides and their family members, and a series of payments dressed up as 'registration', 'activation' and 'contact-unlocking' fees.

Police said the gang was busted after a Delhi man lost Rs 15,000 -- realising only later that he had been speaking to a telecaller playing a bride. Senior officers said the operation was run through a seemingly legitimate matrimonial firm and that its alleged mastermind was a 29-year-old practising advocate.

"Probe began after a complaint on the National Cyber-crime Reporting Portal (NCRP) from the man, who was allegedly cheated through shaadi-partner.com," DCP (Central) Rohit Rajbir Singh.

Investigators found that his money allegedly went into a Central Bank of India account registered in the name of M/s Shaadi Partner Com. Bank records allegedly identified one Jaya as the sole proprietor and authorised signatory. "Further probe linked the bank account to six complaints from across India," an officer said.

Staged matchmaking

"Callers would identify men looking for brides, assess their financial background, and send them photographs of women sourced online. The men were also shown dummy profiles created on Shaadi Partner.com, with screenshots sent to them..." Singh said.

Once a man showed interest, the next step was a phone call. "A woman employee at the call centre would pose as the pros-

• THE MODUS OPERANDI

• Callers identified men looking for brides, assessed their financial background, sent them photos of women sourced online.

• Clients could opt for packages ranging from Rs 2,500 to Rs 15,000.

• Women employees at the call centre called men posing as prospective brides

• Men were subsequently told the women were "unsuitable"

• Some clients were given contact details of "families", who would reject the prospective groom

• The men asked to wait Two-three months later, they were told that their membership had expired.



pective bride and speak to the client," the police said.

The conversations could continue for several days. Then the match would fall through.

Officers said the woman would then be found "unsuitable" because of "Manglik dosh", family opposition, or because she had gotten engaged to someone else.

If the client asked for more matches, more were offered. Some clients were given contact details of "families", who would also reject the prospective groom, said police. If the client continued asking for matches, he would then be told to wait. As per Singh, this could keep the victim engaged for two or three months before he was told that his membership had expired.

Police said clients could opt for packages -- Mini, Medium, Ruby and Diamond -- that ranged from Rs 2,500 to Rs 15,000. The DCP said that telecallers were instructed not to collect over Rs 15,000 from any client as a smaller loss was less likely to trigger a complaint. Singh described it as a "cheat small, cheat many" strategy.

Legal-looking business

Police said the women were allegedly recruited through job platforms such as WorkIndia and Apna App and through newspaper advertisements.

Police said the firm's MSME registration, Labour Department registration, and franchise agreement were allegedly used to convince recruits that they were joining a legitimate matrimonial enterprise.

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New Delhi

AC SLEEPER BUS CATCHES FIRE ON YAMUNA EXPRESSWAY

9 charred to death, driver 'alerted about burning smell, didn't stop'

Drishti Jain

Noida, September 24

AT LEAST 9 people were charred to death when an AC sleeper bus on its way from Delhi to Uttar Pradesh's Mahoba caught fire on the Yamuna Expressway in Greater Noida late Wednesday.

Two drivers and conductor of the bus, carrying 35 passengers and having a registration number of Bihar, have been arrested. They allegedly refused to stop the bus despite being alerted about a burning smell.

"The bus was travelling from Kashmere Gate in Delhi to Mahoba," DCP (Greater Noida) Ravi Shankar Nim said.

The fire is suspected to have started after a spark or blast in the bus's AC system, which caused the engine lubricating oil to catch fire. The fire, which spread rapidly, started near the 33-km milestone on the expressway in Jewar.

"A rescue operation was launched... and more than 20 passengers were safely evacuated. Police and fire service personnel entered the bus... and, after sustained efforts, found that nine people had died inside the bus, apparently due to burns and/or suffocation," Gautam Buddha Nagar Chief Fire officer Pradeep Kumar said.

Till Thursday evening, around six bodies had been identified. "The others are charred beyond recognition, a DNA sampling will be done," a police officer said. Around 20 challans are pending against the vehicle, a senior officer said.

Additional District Magistrate Ajeet Kumar Singh told mediapersons that the incident occurred around 11.20 pm.

"Bodies have been sent to the mortuary... Around 15 others were sent to Mahoba in a special vehicle, while some left in private vehicles. One woman remains hospitalised...", he added.

The FIR was registered at the Jewar police station on a complaint filed by a passenger, Suneel Kumar, on charges of culpable homicide not amounting to murder, rash driving, causing grievous hurt and aggravated criminal intimidation under the BNS.

The complaint alleged that the driver and the conductor's "deliberate, gross negligence, rashness and reckless disregard" for passenger safety resulted in the deaths.

"Some passengers alerted the driver and conductor to the burning smell, but the driver ignored the serious situation, stating that such burning smells are common in buses...", the passenger said. Shortly after, flames suddenly began to emerge from near the driver's seat. "Passengers shouted... but the driver and conductor were laughing among themselves and threatening the passengers, saying 'If you want to die, die; we won't stop the bus'...", the passenger added.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi announced an ex gratia of Rs 2 lakh each for the next of kin of the deceased and Rs 50,000 each for the injured from the Prime Minister's National Relief Fund. Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath also announced financial assistance of Rs 2 lakh each to the families of the deceased.



The sleeper bus was on its way to Mahoba when it caught fire late Wednesday. PTI

'Have you seen her? This is her photo': Families search for their loved ones

Drishti Jain

Noida, September 24

NANCY GUPTA has been sitting on a stone slab outside the postmortem house in Noida's Sector 94 for nine hours. Since 7 am on Thursday, she has been trying to reach her mother, Saroj Gupta (52) and cousin Mayank Gupta (28).

They were travelling in an AC sleeper bus, going from Delhi to Mahoba, which caught fire around 11 pm on the Yamuna Expressway. Nine people were killed.

Nancy's family had come to Noida three days ago to celebrate the first birthday of her sister's daughter. Saroj and Mayank were returning to Rath in Uttar Pradesh. "I stayed back for work," she said.

Their last conversation was before the family boarded the bus from Noida Sector 37 around 10 pm. "They told me they were settled. I called them at 7 am, when the bus usually reaches, but they did not pick up. I tracked the vehicle online, but it was not moving. I called the bus operator and the police, but they did not tell us anything. Then I found out online that the bus had caught fire," she said.

The family called Kailash Hospital in Jewar, where the injured had been taken. "They said nobody named Saroj or Mayank was admitted there. My father keeps asking where my mother is," Nancy said.

Late afternoon, as police officers arrived at the postmortem house, Nancy rushed towards them. "Did you see a woman of medium height? I can describe what she was wearing yesterday. See, this is her picture," she said, holding out a photograph of her mother.

The officer told the waiting families that nine bodies had been brought in but they were charred beyond recognition. Families could try to identify them, he added, while DNA samples would be collected to establish their identities.

Nancy was among several families waiting outside, hoping their loved ones were not among the dead.

Another woman was looking for her father, who had boarded



Relatives mourn the deaths of the victims outside a mortuary in Noida, Thursday. ABHINAV SAHA

the bus along with her brother. They were headed to Auraiya. A few minutes past 11 pm, her brother called and said the bus had caught fire. "I took a cab and rushed to the spot... it took me an hour to reach. I thought it was a minor accident but then I saw flames engulfing the entire bus."

"My brother is safe, but I do not know where my father is," she said.

Sunita Gupta (60) and her son Shashank were also missing, said a relative from Delhi. "Their family called me, saying they hadn't been able to reach them. I called the hospital, but they said nobody by their names was there," he said.

Around 2.30 pm, the families finally went inside the postmortem house, handkerchiefs pressed over their faces, as they prepared to look for their loved ones.

Nancy went inside. Her brother walked anxiously outside, his hands folded. When she emerged, her eyes fixed on him.

"I am not able to identify anyone. Only the torso and face of the remaining bodies are left.

The jewellery my mother was wearing has melted. It is not there on anybody," she said.

Her brother immediately called up a family member. "What was Mayank wearing yesterday? A white shirt and cream cargo pants?" he asked. Turning to his sister, he said, "Did you see anyone like this?"

As he waited to take his father's body home, Sarvodaya said: "The bus helpline told me it had caught fire and that all the passengers had been sent to another bus. But they did not tell me about my parents," he said.

His mother, he said, knows what had happened. "She told me that when the bus was on fire, everyone tried to get out. She moved towards the gate and fell down while people stepped on her to get out. My father couldn't run fast because his legs were weak."

Another victim, Usha Devi (70), was travelling to Muskara after staying with her son for some time. "She had promised to come back for Navratri," her granddaughter said.

They were not to go by train. I booked them AC sleeper bus tickets. They sent me videos from inside the bus. I was tracking their bus but slept after about half an hour. From 6 in the morning, both my parents' phones were switched off. Even the conductor's phone was switched off."

As he waited to take his father's body home, Sarvodaya said: "The bus helpline told me it had caught fire and that all the passengers had been sent to another bus. But they did not tell me about my parents," he said.

His mother, he said, knows what had happened. "She told me that when the bus was on fire, everyone tried to get out. She moved towards the gate and fell down while people stepped on her to get out. My father couldn't run fast because his legs were weak."

Another victim, Usha Devi (70), was travelling to Muskara after staying with her son for some time. "She had promised to come back for Navratri," her granddaughter said.

EXPRESS exclusive



Row in Gurugram society as RWA bars EWS residents from common areas

Abhimanyu Hazarika

Gurugram, September 24

ALL KASHMIR Singh wants is to be able to walk with his wife in the park of their Gurugram housing society. But the 70-year-old, who lives in the EWS block of Mahindra Aura in Sector 110A, has been told he cannot use the central park.

The reason: According to the resident welfare association (RWA), Economically Weaker Section (EWS) occupants do not have rights over the common areas and facilities meant for the condominium residents.

The friction escalated last month after Singh was allegedly removed from a spot near a tower. Main-tower residents reported the incident as "alleged trespassing".

According to Singh, the restrictions have left him and his wife largely confined to their home. "We have been locked inside our room for three days... Should we just die locked inside our room?" he wrote in a handwritten plea to the administration on August 31.

The dispute since then has become a larger fight over whether EWS residents can be denied access to common spaces on the basis of their conveyance deeds and separate maintenance arrangements.

On September 15, the District Registrar of Firms & Societies, Gurugram, ruled against the restrictions. Acting on a complaint filed by Singh and his wife Meena Rani (62), the District Registrar directed the RWA to lift all restrictions on EWS occupants, saying private conveyance agreements cannot override basic mobility and access to open spaces.

Mahindra Aura has 799 condominiums, where units sell for upwards of Rs 2.5 crore and owners pay around Rs 11,000 a month in Common Area Maintenance (CAM) charges. Separate from the main towers is a block of 141 EWS flats – 225 sq ft units originally allotted under state social housing mandates for about Rs 1.5 lakh. They pay Rs 705 as monthly CAM charges.

Two sets of rules

About two years ago, the RWA put up a seven-point notice in the EWS tower citing clauses 18 and 20 of the conveyance deeds. It said EWS occupants had "no rights to use or claim title to common areas and facilities designated for the main complex, and facilities designated for the flat owners/residents of the AURA Group Housing Complex".

It further stipulated that EWS owners "do not hold mem-



The EWS block of Mahindra Aura (top) in Sector 110A, Gurugram; (left) Kashmir Singh. ABHIMANYU HAZARIKA



bership rights in the RWA", that "no power backup is provided by AURA RWA for EWS units", and that car parking is "not an entitlement for EWS".

The notice concluded with a warning: "It has come to our attention that some EWS occupants are violating the above stipulations by accessing the Central Park and sports facilities, which are exclusively meant for flat owners of AURA Complex. The AURA RWA reserves the right to restrict access to these areas for any EWS resident/occupant found in violation."

In June, the District Town Planner (Enforcement) had issued a showcause notice to the RWA over alleged locking of gates along an emergency fire tender path near the EWS tower and alleged encroachment on parking bays reserved for EWS units.

The RWA version

RWA president S S Gill (65), a former Border Security Force (BSF) officer who currently runs an aviation academy, said the issue was not discrimination but the fact that the two categories have different maintenance arrangements.

He cited the cost of maintaining facilities, including a swimming pool, and more than 80 security and cleaning personnel. "They want all rights without paying," he alleged.

Former RWA general secretary, advocate Rajesh Arora, said, "The EWS sale deeds make it clear they do not have access to our internal roads and parks. Rights in those were not sold to them." He also highlighted "financial arrears", claiming that against a nominal monthly charge of Rs 705, the EWS block has accumulated nearly Rs 7 lakh in unpaid maintenance dues.

Singh, however, said he was willing to pay maintenance. He moved into the society in 2021 after decades of working on construction sites and as a driver in Delhi. Since 2012, he has served as a Radha Soami Satsang Beas preacher. His wife is diabetic and suffers from retinal vision loss.

He insisted his complaint was driven by basic dignity rather than entitlement. "We are not against paying more maintenance... They say they are God fearing but don't consider humans worthy of welfare?"

But Gill maintained, "He may not be against maintenance, but what about others? As per policy, we can't charge (them) beyond a cap."

The order

In its order, the District Registrar ruled that private conveyance agreements cannot extinguish basic human mobility. "While clauses 18 and 20 restrict EWS owners from claiming proprietary ownership or commercial club/facility rights as outlined in the builder agreement, they do not and cannot legally empower an RWA to place a blanket prohibition on basic human mobility, ingress, egress, or safe pedestrian movement on internal paths/roads."

"Imposing restrictions that confine senior citizens with medical conditions (such as diabetes and vision ailments) to their apartments by barring them from walking on common pathways or sitting in open parks amounts to harassment and systemic discrimination," the order said.

The directive ordered the RWA to ensure unhindered movement on internal pathways and grant EWS residents access to open parks for "peaceful recreation, fresh air, and health maintenance".

The RWA now plans to appeal against the order. "We're collecting signatures," Gill said.

● THE DOCUMENTARY OSLO: TAIL OF PROMISE IS DIRECTED BY ISHA PUNGALIYA AND PRODUCED BY ACTOR JOHN ABRAHAM, MINNAKSHI DAS AND AMEY GOSAVI

At IIC today, a film on how a Husky from Pune took his human to the snow

Dipan Nath

New Delhi, September 24

"PRIVATE: FARM Residents Only. Basically dogs, cats, animals, witches and angels may enter."

A notice board with these words, mounted in an enclosure of bamboo, boards, nets and creepers near Pune's National Defence Academy, sets the tone for "The Farm", a flagship project of Protecterra Ecological Foundation, an environment advocacy organisation founded by Pooja Bhale, a Pune-based conservation biologist. "We have 20 cats, 11 dogs and, as of 2026, 11 goats," says Bhale.

Recently, a new mud structure has come up on the cam-

pus – dedicated to Oslo, a Siberian Husky who died after living with Bhale for 13 years. Draped over it are his blue towel, woollen socks he collected as arthritis stiffened his limbs, and the charpoy on which he used to sprawl.

On Friday, *Oslo: Tail of Promise*, a documentary about the dog and Bhale, will be screened at the India International Centre in Delhi.

Directed by Pune-based Isha Pungaliya and produced by actor John Abraham, Minnakshi Das and Amey Gosavi, the documentary follows Bhale and Oslo on a 5,000-km journey from Pune to the Himalayas.

It is, says Pooja, about a promise. "The promise that I made to Oslo or he made to me

is that we will go to the snow every year, that he belongs in the snow," says Bhale.

Oslo came into Bhale's life when he was five-and-a-half months old. By then, he had already moved through six houses. His blue eyes reminded Bhale of the Northern Lights, so she named him Oslo. "The word Oslo, in ancient Norse, also means the stream by the bottom of a mountain. It also means God of the mountains in ancient Norse cultures," says Bhale.

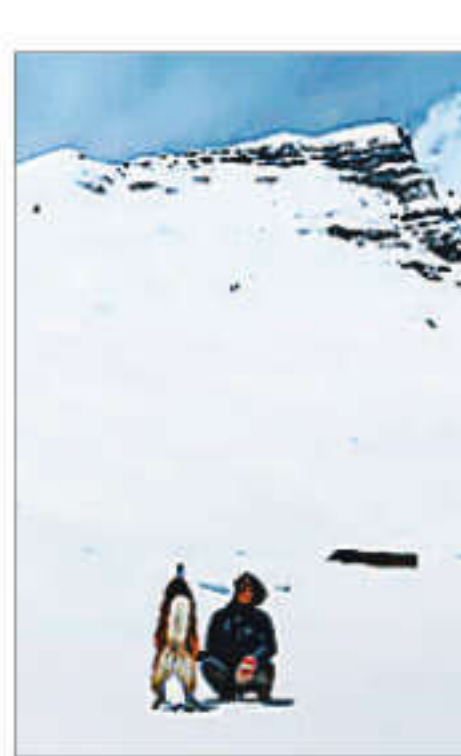
From 2014, the two travelled to the snow every year. The idea for the documentary came during a 2022 trip.

"On one of the trips, while we were stuck in a traffic jam, Oslo was cranky and put his head out of the window. Im-



Video grabs of the teaser of the documentary. FACEBOOK/JOHN ABRAHAM

mediately, all the windows around me rolled down and



people started talking and children were giggling. I

thought that we must document this impact that he has on people, how he makes people happy, and that became this incredible film," says Bhale.

In 2015, she moved to The Farm full-time, living in a tent. "I felt that I was hypocritical by living in a swanky penthouse in the city. I can't talk about sustainability and consciousness and living with the earth if I did not walk my talk. The tent is my only home," she says, pointing to the tent that holds a bed and work table, among other basic necessities.

There are few locked doors at The Farm. "We don't have

boundaries at The Farm. Animals can go in and out, wild animals can come in and out. I don't own any keys except my car key. I have not locked a door for a long time. I am dating a

woman. I am divorced. I prefer the company of nature to anything else. But, I am true to myself. The person that I see in the mirror is happy," she says.

The documentary carries three messages – 'Shared Planet', 'Adopt, Don't Shop' and 'Nature is Sentient'.

It was shot in May 2023 and January 2024. Pungaliya was firm that they were "not going to even consider making an

animal perform because it's unethical and problematic".

"As filmmakers, we have to be watchful and observant. Visiting The Farm helped me see patterns before the shoot," she says. The film uses archival material as Bhale had been recording her trips.

During one shoot, with the cameras positioned for Oslo's first encounter with snow, a group of goats decided to tag along. Oslo simply bypassed the snow and took off in the opposite direction, leaving the crew in splits.

Bhale says that Huskies are among the most abandoned breeds because people don't understand what they require.

The film, she hopes, will help spread awareness.



Addition, Deletion

LEADER OF Opposition Rahul Gandhi has been relentless in attacking what he called “crony capitalists”. In the presentations he had made at his ‘Chhatron ki Goonj’ programmes, the screen would display a string of photographs comprising Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Home Minister Amit Shah, RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat, NSA Ajit Doval, along with industrialists Gautam Adani and Mukesh Ambani, among others, with the title: “The system has captured the country”. However, at the presentation he made on Thursday at Indira Bhawan, there were some minor but conspicuous changes in the setting — the title was ‘Destroyers of Democracy’ and Ambani’s photograph was missing. The newcomers on the screen were Principal Secretary to PM P K Mishra and CEC Gyanesh Kumar.

National Song

TO MARK 150 years of Vande Mataram, RSS-associated organisation Vidya Bharti will make one crore people, including students, teachers, guardians and other citizens, sing the full national song in its schools at 25,000 places across the country. This will happen simultaneously at 11 am on Friday, and the Sangh believes that it will send a message of national oneness and also serve as a befitting tribute to Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay’s composition.

Top court upholds Telangana MLA’s disqualification

Ananthakrishnan G
New Delhi, September 24

IN A setback to the ruling Congress in Telangana, the Supreme Court on Thursday upheld the state high court’s decision to disqualify Khairatabad MLA Danam Nagender, who had defected from the Bharat Rashtra Samithi (BRS), under the anti-defection law.

A three-judge bench led by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant said it found no reason to interfere with the high court’s decision. Nagender, who won the Khairatabad Assembly seat twice—in 2018 and in 2023—defected to the Congress in March 2024 and unsuccessfully contested the Lok Sabha polls from Secunderabad while he was still an MLA, only to lose to the BJP’s G Kishan Reddy.

The Assembly Speaker dismissed petitions filed by the BRS and the BJP seeking Nagender’s disqualification, following which they moved the high court.

On September 18, the high court set aside the Speaker’s decision to let Nagender continue. Senior advocate Mukul Rohatgi, appearing for Nagender in the Supreme Court, argued that the Constitution’s Tenth Schedule (anti-defection law) allows condoning a member’s act of giving up party membership.

Justice Joyimalya Bagchi asked in a lighter vein whether he meant to say “ghar wapsi?”.

The judge added, “You had a fixed deposit as MLA, you tried for share market as MP, and now you lost the Fixed Deposit.” As senior advocate Mahesh Jethmalani, appearing for a respondent, referred to the phrase “Aaya Ram, gaya Ram”, Justice Bagchi quipped that “Rohatgi’s argument is ‘phir aaya Ram’”. Rohatgi said the “Constitution allows a person to come back, ‘ghar wapsi’, if he regrets” his actions.

After *Express* report, Goa CEO says cases of 97 voters have been ‘processed separately’

Pavneet Singh Chadha
Panaji, September 24

A DAY after *The Indian Express* reported on the unprecedented rupture within the Election Commission and the disenfranchisement of potential voters in Goa, the office of the Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) of Goa on Thursday said that “many” of the 97 cases that were not included in the final electoral roll published in February this year have been enrolled since, and the “remaining cases are being processed”.

It said the cases were separately processed through house-to-house visits by BLOs for completion of Form 6.

The Indian Express on

Thursday reported that between February 11 and 17, the office of Goa’s Chief Electoral Officer wrote eight times to Gyanesh Bharti, the Senior Deputy Election Commissioner in charge of the state, copying Director General of IT Seema Khanna every time, asking for the rollback option that would let the EROs reverse the earlier deletions as the Supreme Court had directed. The requests went unanswered as the deadline for publication of the final electoral roll approached. The provision was not enabled in time, and 97 people were left off the final voters’ roll in Goa.

A statement from the office of the CEO, Goa, on Thursday, said, “The 97 cases not included

in the Final Roll published in February 2026 were separately processed through house-to-house visits by BLOs for completion of Form 6. Many have since been enrolled, while the remaining cases are being processed. It is reiterated that no eligible elector will be left behind.”

When *The Indian Express* contacted him, Sanjay Goel, CEO, Goa, said, “We had flagged to the Election Commission in February (regarding the list of 97 voters to be included). Subsequently, we went ahead and published the final roll. Immediately after, I wrote to both the DEOs (district election officers) that all these (97) cases... they should be part of the electoral rolls by filing Form 6 and

the BLOs (booth-level officers) must visit their addresses and get the requisite documentation done. Since then, we have collated data, and many of the names (in the list of 97) have been added to the electoral rolls after filing Form 6. And for the remaining cases, we are taking the initiative, and the BLOs will go to their addresses. And once their Form 6 details are filled, they will be added to the roll in a time-bound manner.”

Opposition targets EC

The state’s Opposition parties meanwhile accused the Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar and the ruling BJP government of trying to “influence” and “sabotage”

the upcoming state assembly polls in the coastal state.

They demanded that 97 voters found eligible for the final roll be added to the electoral roll immediately. Goa Forward Party chief Vijai Sardesai said, “I fear the 2027 Goa Assembly Elections may be about ‘vote chori.’”

Addressing a press conference in Panaji, Sunil Kawtharkar, Goa Pradesh Congress Committee working president, said the BJP was trying to win elections through SIR because it knows it would be tough to return to power in Goa. “Deletion of names of valid voters amounts to sabotage. The Election Commission has become an arm of the BJP, and they are using it to win the polls,” he said.

2 pleas in HC against SIR in Maharashtra seek poll halt

Petitions seek stay on forthcoming Assembly polls, restoration of deleted voters

Omkar Gokhale
Mumbai, September 24

AFTER *The Indian Express* reported that two Election Commissioners had objected to decisions taken during the SIR exercise, two writ petitions were filed in the Bombay High Court on Thursday challenging the SIR process in Maharashtra.

The pleas seek several directions to the ECI, including placing on record 14 decisions concerning the SIR, criteria for polling station rationalisation and ECINET specifications. They also seek restoration of every voter deleted during the SIR process in Maharashtra, or quashing of the SIR directions for the state and a stay on forthcoming Assembly elections until the electoral rolls are made “legally compliant”.

One of the pleas also seeks the appointment of an independent judicial committee headed by a former Bombay High Court judge to “investigate the data deletions and software blockages implemented during the current SIR process”.

A writ petition filed by four Maharashtra residents and registered voters through advocate Asim Sarode before the Kolhapur circuit bench cited The In-

dian Express investigation and claimed they were “aggrieved by the systematic erosion of constitutional norms governing the management of electoral rolls”, which they said directly affected their fundamental rights.

The plea is likely to be mentioned before the Kolhapur circuit bench on September 28.

The petition also claimed that the action was “contrary” to past Supreme Court judgments and alleged that the CEC and ECI had exercised their powers in a manner “detrimental to the democratic perspective and against the interest of the general public”.

The four petitioners have sought quashing of the 14 “unilateral administrative orders” and modifications, disclosure of recorded dissents, restoration of all deleted voters and formation of an independent judicial committee to probe the deletions.

Another writ petition, filed at the principal seat in Mumbai through advocate Hitendra Gandhi by two Mumbai residents, including Sagar Ramesh Gawai, youth president of Van-chit Bahujan Aghadi (VBA), raised concerns over the “collection of documents during enumeration and exclusion based on uncollectible status”.

The petitioners have sought directions to the ECI to publish the reasons for the SIR, the methodology used for the Absent, Shifted, Dead, Duplicate (ASDD) electoral rolls and ECINET specifications. They have also sought action on their April 2026 representation to the authorities and quashing of the SIR-related directions for Maharashtra.

Uttarakhand SIR: Over 95k Form-7 pleas pertain to ‘ineligible’ voters

Vidheesha Kuntamalla
Dehradun, September 24

OVER 95,000, or more than half, of the nearly 1.73 lakh Form-7 applications filed during Uttarakhand’s ongoing SIR of electoral rolls relate to voters whom election officials have marked as “ineligible”, the Chief Electoral Officer’s (CEO) office said on Thursday.

According to the CEO’s office, the “ineligible” category comprises voters who either did not furnish the documents sought during the verification process or did not appear for the hearing themselves or through a family member. In such cases, the concerned Electoral Registration Officer (ERO) or Assistant Electoral Registration Officer (AERO) marks the voter as “ineligible” on the Election Commission’s online system, following which Form 7 is automatically generated for

deletion, the office said in a statement.

Form 7 is used to seek deletion of a name from the electoral roll.

The clarification comes as the EC is processing an unusually large number of Form-7 applications in Uttarakhand, with more than 85% of the 1,30,382 applications reported earlier coming from four districts — Udham Singh Nagar, Haridwar, Dehradun and Nainital. The concentration of deletion requests in these largely plain and more populous districts had prompted questions about the reasons behind the geographic pattern in terms of deletions.

The Indian Express has earlier reported that the ruling BJP has attributed the concentration principally to population movement and migration, while the Congress has questioned whether the demographic composition of these districts could

be a factor. However, election officials have cautioned against drawing conclusions from the number of applications alone, noting that Form-7 figures reflect applications received and can vary depending on how actively electoral rolls are scrutinised.

The CEO’s office said Thursday that the SIR process is being conducted “in accordance with the rules and in a transparent manner” and that regular meetings are being held with recognised political parties at the Assembly constituency, district and state levels.

The final electoral roll in Uttarakhand will be published on October 3, the CEO’s office said, reiterating the revised schedule for the exercise. Importantly, voters who have been placed in the “ineligible” category will not lose the opportunity to seek inclusion in the electoral roll after the final publication, according to the clarification.



Election Campaign

Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav greets supporters during a roadshow ahead of the 2027 UP Assembly elections, in Rae Bareilly on Thursday. He said that the EC had lost the confidence of people and claimed that had the alleged “vote theft” not taken place in 2022, SP would have formed the government in the state. EXPRESS

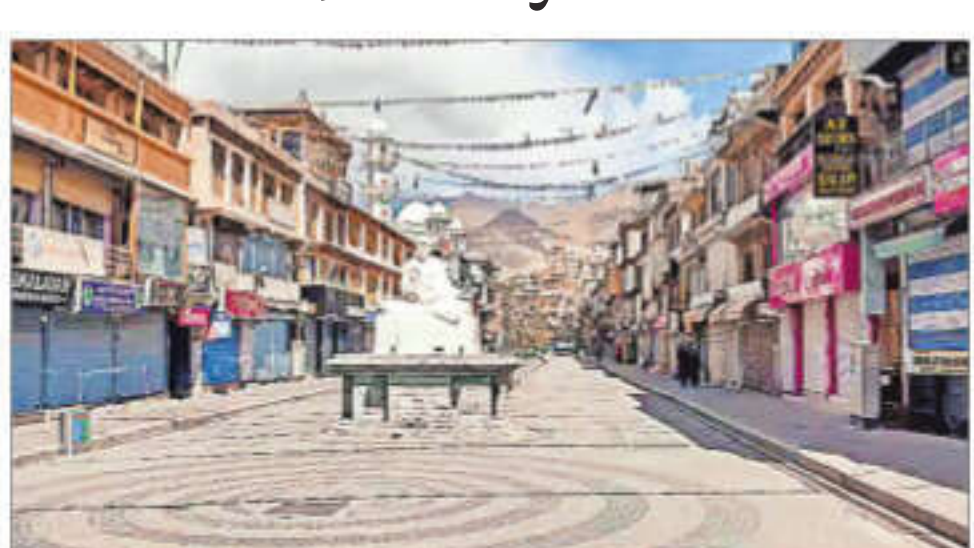
‘Amit Shah must resign’: Wangchuk on Ladakh violence, one year on

Naveed Iqbal
Srinagar, September 24

AS LADAKH marked the first anniversary of the violence that killed four civilians in police firing in Leh, climate activist Sonam Wangchuk called for Home Minister Amit Shah’s resignation, blaming him for what he called a “massacre” in Ladakh.

Addressing crowds after a 20-km march to commemorate the deaths of four Ladakhis on September 24 last year, Wangchuk said: “Amit Shah must resign and take responsibility for the massacre in Ladakh. He will have to take responsibility for these deaths. Amit Shah must resign”. All of Ladakh remained shut on Thursday to mark its protest against the police action last year that left four locals dead. In his speech, Wangchuk lauded the people of Ladakh for fighting for the country, “without wearing the uniform” and emphasised that “these people were forced to agitate” for their demands.

He said the movement remained peaceful for six years and questioned “the need for violence” in 2025. The real question, he told the gathering, is why the violence occurred



Closed shops mark the first anniversary of the September 24, 2025, violence in which four persons were killed. ANI

and who is responsible for it.

“In their (BJP) 2020 election manifesto, they said that they will provide protections under the Sixth Schedule of the Constitution. It was the top point in their manifesto. And then they turned around. When our young people attempted to remind them of their promises, they were either beaten or booked in police stations. All of this has been directed through Delhi,” Wangchuk said.

Recalling a visit by Ladakhi representatives to Delhi for talks with the Centre, Wangchuk said “they promised them everything”, but that after two years and 15 rounds of talks,

“Amit Shah ji told them that they will not give Sixth Schedule, and asserted that even if the Prime Minister gave this (assurance) in writing, even then I will not extend this protection (to Ladakh)”.

Wangchuk underscored that the root cause of the agitation in Ladakh is the Centre’s overturning of its promise to provide Ladakh protections under the Sixth Schedule. “If they had kept their word on this, then would we continue our agitation for all this time? These (four) deaths occurred due to them betraying their promises,” Wangchuk told the crowds at the NDS Sports Complex in Leh.

Top court seeks update from EC on TMC name row

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 24

THE SUPREME Court on Thursday asked the Election Commission of India (EC) to inform what would be a reasonable time within which it can decide the fight between the Mamata Banerjee and Ritabrata Banerjee factions of the All India Trinamool Congress (TMC) for the party’s name and symbol.

A three-judge bench comprising Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and Justices Joy-malya Bagchi and V Mohana told senior advocate DS Naidu, who appeared for the EC, that it should “not” be “too long” adding that it had seen in the Shiv Sena case what consequences delay can have.

The court was hearing Mamata’s plea challenging the September 18 interim order of the EC freezing the name and the ‘Flowers & Grass’ election symbol of the party amid the factional feud.

The poll body’s decision came 10 days after it announced bypolls in two Assembly constituencies in West Bengal - Nandigram and Rejinagar, for which both the factions have nominated candidates.

Bengal ‘Anti-Goonda’ Bill fails to get President’s nod due to overlap with Central legislation

Atri Mitra
Kolkata, September 24

IN A setback to the BJP dispensation in West Bengal, the President of India has registered a sustainable objection to Su-vendu Adhikari government’s ‘anti-Goonda’ Bill and returned it for reconsideration after the Centre raised the issue of a conflict between the proposed legislation and the Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances (NDPS) Act, 1985.

In its note before returning the Bill, the Central government said, “Section (B) of the proposed Bill, insofar as it includes within the definition of ‘goonda’ a person who commits, attempts to commit, abets, promotes, finances or facilitates any offence punishable under the NDPS Act, 1985, may overlap with the preventive-detention framework provided under the PITNDPS Act, 1988, which is a specific Central legislation dealing with preventive detention of persons engaged in illicit traffic in narcotic drugs and psychotropic substances.”

“The proposed provision may, therefore, create an overlapping or parallel preventive-detention mechanism in respect of drug-related activities and may give rise to an issue of repugnancy under Article 254 of the Constitution of India. Accordingly, the reference to offences under NDPS Act, 1985 in Section 2(d)(iii)(B) may be deleted to avoid duplication and overlap with the existing Central statutory framework,” it added.

A senior official of the state administration said, “It is indeed a setback for the government as it wants to implement this Act as soon as possible. However, there is a provision to table this Bill again in the Assembly after making the necessary changes in the proposed Act where it is conflicting or overlapping with Central law. After that, it will be sent again for the assent of the President of India.”

To curb anti-social activities, the BJP government introduced the West Bengal Public Safety and Control of Anti-Social Activities Bill, 2026 in June. However, after facing criticism from the Opposition, Adhikari

assured the Opposition that the legislation would not be used for political vendetta.

“Those who are expressing concern about the provisions of preventive arrest have no reason to be afraid. The administration will act in accordance with the law, and there will be no misuse of the law in any way,” the chief minister had said.

The Bill states that if a district magistrate, a Commissioner of Police, or a police officer not below the rank of DIG authorised by the state government is apprehensive that a “goonda” is engaging in or will engage in anti-social activities, they may, to prevent it, “direct such person to remove himself outside such area, district or districts, or part thereof, as may be specified in the order, within such time as may be specified therein, and prohibit him from entering or returning to such area for a period not exceeding one year; and require such person to report his movements, or to report himself, in such manner, at such times, and to such authority as may be specified in the order”.

- THE SANGH PLANS TO HAVE ONE LAKH SWAYAMSEVAKS IN RSS UNIFORM AT THE EVENT

To wrap up RSS centenary events, Bhagwat plans meet in Delhi on Nov 29

Vikas Pathak
New Delhi, September 24

THE RSS will cap its string of yearlong activities to mark the completion of 100 years of the organisation with a public meeting of Sarsangchalak (chief) Mohan Bhagwat in Delhi on November 29.

The venue has not yet been finalised, but the Sangh plans to have one lakh *Swayams-evaks* (volunteers) in *Gana Vesh* (RSS uniform) attend the event, alongside 50,000 invitees from among citizens.

Sources in the Sangh say this will be the completion of the activity of *ekatrikaran* (congregation) of Swayams-evaks that has been taking

place through the year in different cities of India.

Bhagwat is expected to speak on the journey of the Sangh, and also on different issues facing the nation in recent times. He is the first RSS chief to have conducted periodic public lectures—the first happened in 2018—in order to clarify the Sangh’s position on a number of controversial issues. He also conducted a three-day lecture series in Vigyan Bhawan in the capital from August 26 to 28, 2025, on 100 years of the RSS.

Bhagwat recently addressed Indian expats at Madison Square Garden in New York, and also travelled to London and Toronto for the global cen-

tenary outreach tour. Days after the youth protests in Jantar Mantar in Delhi ended, Bhagwat addressed Gen Z students in Mumbai on August 6. Sangh sources say the Mumbai event was planned several months in advance and was not a response to the Gen Z protest in Delhi and other cities.

The RSS had chalked out a multicomponent plan of conducting a string of events to mark its journey from 100 years to the 101st to make Swayams-evaks across India congregate in various locations and to reach out to various sections of society.

One component was the Prabhuddha Nagrik Sammelan (conferences of enlightened citizens)



RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat

across all districts of India. The aim was to make an outreach to professionals, doctors, engineers, professors and others to expand the Sangh’s ideology.

Another campaign involved

door-to-door meetings (Griha Sampark) across neighbourhoods where RSS volunteers would interact with people and also distribute the literature of the RSS to them so as to acquaint them with the organisation.

The Sangh also organised Hindu Sammelans (Hindu congregations) across the country in rural as well as urban habitations to foster Hindu unity and social harmony among various sections of the Hindu community.

The organisation made *Panch Parivartan* (Five Transformations) part of its agenda to mark its centenary year. It includes social harmony, *Kutumb Prabodhan* (family consciousness), civic duties,

environmental protection and Swadeshi (self-reliance).

On July 7, 2025, RSS Akhil Bharatiya Prachar Pramukh (All India Publicity Chief) Sunil Ambekar said regarding the Sangh’s centenary preparations, “At present there are 58,964 Mandals and 44,055 Bastis. In these Sammelans, there will be discussion on social festivals, social unity and harmony and Panch Parivartan (Five transformation). Similarly, Samajik Sadbhav Baitahaks (Social harmony meetings) will be organised in 11,360 blocks/towns to promote social harmony in the society. There are a total of 924 districts according to Sangh Structure. In these districts, Pramukh Nagrik

Seminars will be organised. In the seminars topics like Ideas of Bharat, pride of Bharat, Bharat’s Sewa etc. will be discussed.”

The Sangh also conducted Samajik Sadbhav Baitahaks (social harmony meets) to bridge caste divides at a time when caste is becoming a source of much debate and polarisation.

The lecture series and the global outreach were also part of the centenary events of the RSS. A source in the RSS said that the Delhi public meeting of Bhagwat should be seen as the last event within the *ekatrikaran* (congregations of Swayams-evaks) plan and will mark the end of the centenary year events of the Sangh.





Gor joins forces at military exercise

US Ambassador to India Sergio Gor with personnel of the Indian Army and US Army during a joint military exercise at Mahajan Field Firing Range in Bikaner district, Rajasthan, on Thursday. PTI

Mahadev app: Kingpin returning from Dubai arrested at Hyderabad airport

Mahender Singh Manral
New Delhi, September 24

THE CBI arrested Abhishek Kumar, identified as one of the kingpins in the multi-crore Mahadev Betting App scam, at the Rajiv Gandhi International Airport in Hyderabad soon after he arrived from Dubai on Thursday.

“The investigation has found that he played an active role in coordinating betting panels, collecting funds, and acquiring immovable assets in Dubai using

alleged proceeds from the illegal operations,” a CBI spokesperson said. “The material prima facie indicates his role in the operation of the Mahadev Betting App and suggests that he worked closely with the main accused Saurabh Chandrakar and Shubham Soni,” officials said.

After his arrest, Kumar was produced before a local court in Hyderabad, which granted three-day transit remand. He was later produced before a court in Raipur and taken into

police custody for two days.

“The Mahadev Betting App case was transferred to the CBI after the Chhattisgarh government handed over 13 FIRs registered at different police stations in the state. The agency subsequently took over the cases and has so far filed eight charge-sheets against 100 accused persons, including the app’s main promoters, panel operators, hawala operators and public servants of the government,” the spokesperson said.

Two UP cops, 2 CRPF men held for raping woman at farmhouse

Farmhouse in Amroha belongs to Umesh Kumar, an Independent MLA from Uttarakhand

Express News Service
Lucknow, September 24

A WOMAN, who had travelled to Uttar Pradesh’s Amroha with a Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF) head constable, was allegedly gangraped by him and two others, including a policeman from the local police station. Officials said the incident took place at a farmhouse, which belongs to an Independent MLA from Uttarakhand, in the early hours of Wednesday.

Officials said a fourth man, also a UP policeman, also tried to allegedly assault the woman, but she managed to push him out the room and bolt the door.

The four men then allegedly banged on the door and threatened her, asking her to open it. The woman quickly looked up Amroha police’s number online and called the 112 helpline around 1 am.

The local police station and other officials were alerted. Offi-

cials said a team arrived by 2 am and arrested the four men sitting outside, who had no idea the woman had called up the police.

The accused are Sub-Inspector Sanjay Tomar and Head Constable Pramod Malik, and CRPF Inspector Lalaram Yadav and Head Constable Mohit.

In a post on Facebook, the MLA, Umesh Kumar from Khanpur constituency in Uttarakhand, sought to distance himself from the incident. “Some news reports have been continuously going viral on social media claiming that an incident took place at my farmhouse in Amroha. Here is the complete sequence of events. If the local police station in-charge comes to the farmhouse along with CRPF personnel, would the watchman not open the gate?” he said.

“As for the time when the incident allegedly took place, I was in Landhora, Khanpur, from around 6.30 pm to 11 pm, participating in a roadshow and public programme. All the evidence is available on social media,” the MLA added.

Superintendent of Police, Amroha, Lakhan Singh Yadav, said the woman’s medical examination was conducted on Wednesday. The accused too were medically examined. All four accused were produced in

court on Wednesday evening, and sent to jail.

According to the initial investigation, the woman met Mohit in Sonipat, Haryana, on September 21, after a common friend introduced them.

SP Yadav told *The Indian Express* that the woman and Mohit planned to drive to Muzaffarnagar, Meerut and Bareilly and then head back to Haryana. At Meerut, Lalaram joined them.

The SP said Mohit then called up Sanjay Tomar, who arranged for their stay at the farmhouse. On Tuesday, the group reached the farmhouse with Sanjay. The woman told police that two rooms were booked at the farmhouse.

Later, Pramod arrived with food and liquor. Police said after the men had eaten and drunk, the two CRPF personnel and Sanjay entered the woman’s room and allegedly raped her.

As they walked out, Pramod allegedly entered the room, but she managed to push him out.

The two Amroha policemen have been suspended and departmental proceedings to dismiss them from service have been initiated. A report has also been sent to the CRPF regarding its two personnel, said the SP.

The FIR has been filed on charges of gangrape.

• BRIEFLY



People gather at the accident site in Jamshedpur on Thursday. PTI

JHARKHAND

Minister’s daughter among 4 dead as car rams truck in Jamshedpur

FOUR PEOPLE —including the daughter of Jharkhand Rural Development Minister Deepika Pandey Singh —died after the car they were travelling in collided with a truck on Marine Drive in Jamshedpur’s Sonari area, Thursday, police said. The accident took place around 3 am near Domuhani. The impact left the vehicle wedged under the truck. All four were trapped inside. CM Hemant Soren expressed condolences over the deaths. In a post on X, Soren said he was deeply distressed by the “extremely sad and heart-wrenching” news of the death of the daughter of Singh, whom he referred to as fellow minister and sister, along with others in the accident. ENS

Political rivalry: Five beat UP wrestler to death

FIVE MEN were arrested on Thursday in connection with the murder of a 35-year-old wrestler over political rivalry here, officials said. The accused were identified as Abhimanyu Yadav, Ajay Yadav, Ramswaroop Yadav, Sanjay Yadav and Rakesh Yadav, of Bhakthan Gosaipur village. According to police, wrestler Brahmanand Yadav was travelling on his motorcycle towards Gidhini market on Tuesday when the accused allegedly waylaid him near Rakesh’s house and threw red chilli powder into Brahmanand’s eyes before attacking him with bamboo sticks and an axe, police said. PTI

Journalist Ravi Nair gets bail in Adani case

A WEEK after he was sent to judicial custody in the Adani Group criminal defamation case, journalist Ravi Nair was granted bail by a Gandhinagar court on Thursday, although he is likely to spend another night in jail pending receipt of the order and completion of release formalities. Nair’s advocate Ronith Joy told *The Indian Express* that the Principal District and Sessions Court Judge of Gandhinagar granted bail to Nair on Thursday. “He is expected to be released on Friday once the court order reaches the jail authorities and the necessary formalities are completed,” Joy, who argued the bail plea said. ENS

Maharashtra seeks to revive student body elections after 33 yrs; forms a panel of 12

Pallavi Smart
Mumbai, September 24

THE LAST TIME students in Maharashtra voted for representatives on their campuses was in 1993. Thirty-three years later, the state government has taken a fresh step towards bringing student elections back, setting up a 12-member committee to examine how campus polls can be held across higher education institutions.

The Higher and Technical Education department issued a Government Resolution (GR) on Thursday appointing the committee, headed by former Mumbai University Vice-Chancellor Prof Suhas Pednekar.

It has been given a month to submit its report.

The committee will consult stakeholders and recommend measures for peaceful, transparent and inclusive elections, with safeguards against external political interference and commercialisation of the process.

It will also examine the management and audit of student council funds, orientation and training of elected representatives, and the use of digital systems for nominations, scrutiny and grievance redressal.

Representation will also be examined, including mechanisms for women, students from all reserved categories and those involved in the National Service Scheme (NSS), Na-

tional Cadet Corps (NCC), sports and cultural activities.

The committee comprises former vice-chancellors and pro-vice-chancellors, principals, a senior law officer and university officials.

Mumbai University Registrar Dr Prasad Karande has been appointed member-secretary. Maharashtra’s student elections were banned in the early 1990s following a series of incidents of campus violence, including the 1989 killing of NSUI student leader Owen D’Souza outside a Mumbai college during campaigning. The Maharashtra Universities Act, 1994, subsequently barred direct, competitive student elections, bringing an end to a system that allowed students to elect their representatives on campuses.

The first formal attempt to revive student elections came in 2016, when the Maharashtra Public Universities Act provided for elected Students’ Councils in universities, colleges and departments.

It returned to focus after the recent Gen Z protests over education-related issues, which saw significant participation by young people across Maharashtra. *The Indian Express* reported in August on the renewed demand for student elections, as youth and student organisations stepped up membership drives after the protests.

EXPRESS special

MP’s Jal Jeevan probe findings: Collapsed tank and missing taps

Anand Mohan J
Bhopal, September 24

COLLAPSED TANK, missing taps, incomplete pipework and halted water supply — these are among the findings of the Economic Offences Wing’s probe into Jal Jeevan Mission works in several villages in Madhya Pradesh’s Mauganj district, despite Rs 3.85 crore being paid to the contractor, officials have said.

The agency has alleged that the contractor and three Public Health Engineering officials colluded to execute substandard work and secure payments. The JJM department declined to comment on the findings, saying only that it had “no issues with the probe”.

The probe followed a complaint and physical verification of the works in four villages — Judmania Raghunath, Khatkhari, Karah alias Bairagarh and Shivrajpur. The projects were awarded in 2021 under the ‘Har Ghar Nal Jal’ programme, with a nine-month deadline for completion.

The case is being investigated under the provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita and the Prevention of Corruption Act.

The EOW allegedly found that while pipelines had been laid in several places, the infrastructure needed to actually supply water to individual

EOW accused contractor, 3 govt officials of collusion and executing subpar work in four villages in Madhya Pradesh

households was missing or incomplete. In one village, an overhead water tank collapsed during its first filling, an official said.

The contractor, Shivendra Kumar Tiwari, and then PHE officials A P Tiwari, Sanjay Pandey and J P Dwivedi have been named as accused in the case.

At Judmania Raghunath, the project included 7,600 metres of HDPE pipeline, a sump, a motor and 440 household tap connections. The contractor and the sub-engineer concerned allegedly told the EOW that the pipeline had been laid, a motor pump installed, electrical work completed, and 400 household connections provided.

The EOW also found that the household connections had not been completed.

As a result, the FIR says, when water was supplied through the main pipeline, it reached the “initial five to 10 distribution lines”, but could not move further.

What investigators found

At the Khatkhari village water tank, the FIR says a 75-KL tank with 15-metre staging was

vided, the FIR says.

The EOW found that pipeline work had been completed in only about half the area, investigators said. Water supply, which had reportedly continued for a few days after construction began, had “at present completely stopped”, according to the FIR.

The physical verification also allegedly found a discrepancy in the pumps. While the contractor had stated that four motors were installed, only one submersible motor was found at the site.

The FIR states that “the work of... tap fitting for any domestic connection has not been carried out”. Instead, distribution pipelines had merely been brought out in front of villagers’ houses.

At Shivrajpur, the project provided for a 125-KL overhead tank, sump, 8,000 metres of pipeline, two motors, electrical work and 700 household connections.

The contractor claimed that the pipeline had been laid, one motor installed, electrical work completed, the sump constructed, and 600 domestic connections provided.

The EOW allegedly found that pipeline laying had been completed only in part of the Gram Panchayat. Water supply had continued for a few days after construction began but had subsequently stopped.

Days after Jamui molestation, video shows girl harassed in Samastipur; four suspects arrested

Himanshu Harsh
Patna, September 24

A GIRL was allegedly harassed by a group of youths on a bypass road in Samastipur in broad daylight, with a video purportedly showing her being pulled by her hair and subjected to abusive remarks. The development comes days after a video of two teenagers who were stopped, assaulted and allegedly molested on the outskirts of Jamui drew outrage.

The latest incident took place a few kilometres from the Samastipur district headquarters. According to police sources, the girl had stopped to take photographs while travelling with a boy when three men surrounded her and began harassing her.



Accused persons brought to Samastipur Sadar Hospital for medical examination on Thursday. ANI

The video, purportedly recorded at the spot, shows a youngster holding a woman’s hand and pulling her while another holds her by the hair and tries to click a photo as the woman struggles to break free.

The men are also heard asking the woman her name and are seen dragging her as she resists.

Samastipur Superintendent of Police Arvind Pratap Singh told *The Indian Express* that four suspects were arrested and

questioned, with efforts ongoing to identify the others.

“This is a sensitive matter, and the police are conducting an inquiry,” the SP said.

The incident comes days after the alleged molestation of a minor girl in Jamui. Videos from the incident show a group of men surrounding two teenagers on a bike, with the girl being allegedly molested and the boy assaulted. The incident became a political flashpoint, with an FIR registered under the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita and the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences Act.

Two — Nandan Yadav and Hareram Yadav — have been arrested, while three minors have been detained. Yadav was also injured during a police encounter earlier this week.

‘Know Your BJP’ meet: Nitin Nabin interacts with foreign diplomats

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 24

BHARATIYA JANATA Party president Nitin Nabin met with senior diplomats and Heads of Mission from eight countries on Thursday as part of the party's 'Know Your BJP' initiative. The participating nations included Armenia, Egypt, Vietnam, Bhutan, Suriname, the Philippines, Argentina, and Tajikistan, the party said in a statement.

During the interaction, Nabin briefed the diplomats on the BJP's organisational structure, its extensive grassroots network and the central role of the 'karyakarta' (party workers) in maintaining continuous engagement with people.

Speaking about the ongoing Seva Sankalp Abhiyan being observed from 17 September to 17 October, which focuses on public service, Jan Bhagidari (public participation), Antyodaya (upliftment of the poorest) and the vision of 'Viksit Bharat' by 2047, Nabin cited service activities such as blood donation drives and health camps being organised under the campaign nationwide.

Nabin highlighted India's transformation under PM Narendra Modi's tenure, mentioning progress in infrastructure, social services, financial and digital inclusion, entrepreneurship and public healthcare. He also referred to the large number of people the party says have been lifted out of poverty during the Modi government and pointed to Ayushman Bharat scheme as key in expanding healthcare access.

He further spoke about PM's emphasis on strengthening India's global partnerships beyond government-to-government engagement.

National security not just about safeguarding borders: Rajnath

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 24

DEFENCE MINISTER Rajnath Singh, addressing a gathering at a defence summit organised by a news channel on Thursday, cautioned against viewing national security solely from the view of safeguarding geographical boundaries, stating that it would amount to a 'perimeter fallacy'.

He said modern-day challenges encompass cyber-attacks, lone wolf attacks and disinformation campaigns, adding, "We've adopted a holistic approach to tackle these highly-fluid threats."

Punjab: ED holds 8 urban body officials for 50 hrs; scans papers, clones phones

Kanchan Vasdev
Chandigarh, September 24

THE ENFORCEMENT Directorate's over 50 hour search and survey operation in Greater Mohali Area Development Authority (GMADA) headquarters in Mohali's PUDA Bhawan building concluded Thursday afternoon.

For over 50 hours (since Tuesday noon), ED teams kept eight top GMADA officials inside the premises, as the central agency's Jalandhar zone searched, scanned and copied official GMADA documents, cloned the mobile phones of the officers, scanned the GMADA servers, computers and

other electronic devices and took a bunch of electronic devices and documents with them.

GMADA deals in urban planning and master plan enforcement, land acquisition, infrastructure development and regulating private real estate, residential and commercial plot allotments.

In a statement issued Thursday, ED claimed that "searches have revealed that AAP leaders Satyendar Jain and Manish Sisodia have been regularly holding unofficial meeting with GMADA officials regarding the master plans and site auctions. Critical decisions including fresh auctions and acquisitions by GMADA as well as determination

of compensation were all taken informally under the instructions of Jain".

The prolonged searches led the state government to approach the Punjab and Haryana High Court late on Wednesday.

Satya Pal Jain, Additional Solicitor General of India, who appeared for ED in the HC told *The Indian Express* that "the Punjab government is trying to shield the main accused in the case. It is a scandal worth hundreds of crores. There are hawala transactions."

AAP, however, denied ED's claims. On the claims concerning Sisodia and Jain, the AAP said, "The reports are completely false,

baseless and politically motivated. Neither Sisodia nor Jain has any role in GMADA's projects, functioning or official matters. Their role in Punjab is purely political, and they have no involvement in GMADA's functioning or projects."

"Punjab government would take the strongest possible legal action against those found responsible for any illegal conduct during the [ED's] operation," AAP said, adding that the Bhagwant Mann government will not remain silent when Punjab is subjected to such pressure.

"The people of Punjab have always stood up whenever Delhi has tried to impose its will, and they will stand up again," it said.



Government of Tamil Nadu
TAMIL NADU e-GOVERNANCE AGENCY (TNeGA)
2nd Floor, PT Lee Chengalvarayan Building, Anna Salai, Chennai-600 002.
careers.tnega@tn.gov.in | 044 - 4016 4900



CEO. iTNT Hub
Notification No: TNeGA/HRA3/4431228/2026-1 Dated: 24.09.2026
Applications are invited from senior professionals for the post of Chief Executive Officer, iTNT Hub, on contract basis, for a period of 3 years, extendable upto 2 years. The application along with a detailed resume can be submitted in **online mode only** through <https://elcot.in/careers/>. The last date for the receipt of online application is 09.10.2026, 5:00 PM.
Chief Executive Officer (FAC),
Tamil Nadu e-Governance Agency.

DIPR/836/Display/2026



CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA LTD.
CONCOR ANNEXE, NSIC New MIDBP Building, 3rd Floor, Okhla Indl. Estate (Opp. NSIC Okhla Metro Station), New Delhi-110028.

NOTICE INVITING EOI
CONCOR invites Online Expression of Interest (EOI) for Sale of Locomotives "As-is-Where-is" Basis stationed at various terminals of CONCOR.

EOI Notice No.	CON/T/EOI/Locomotive /98204/2026-27
Name of Work	Sale of Locomotives "As-is-Where-is" Basis stationed at various terminals of CONCOR.
Date & Time of Publish of EOI Document (Online)	25/09/2026 (11:00 hrs) to 16/10/2026 (up to 11:00 hrs)
Date & Time of Submission of EOI	16/10/2026 (up to 13:00 hrs)
Date & Time of Opening of EOI	16/10/2026 at 15:00 hrs

Please refer to www.concorindia.co.in and Central Public Procurement Portal (CPP Portal) for detailed EOI notice. Further, Corrigendum / Addendum to this EOI, if any, will be published on website www.concorindia.co.in, and Central Public Procurement Portal (CPP Portal) only. Newspaper press advertisement shall not be issued for the same.

GGM/P 85/A-IV
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1. Applications are invited for the following post :-
1.1 Vice Principal & Headmaster/Headmistress on Term Based Contract for four years:-

Ser	Subject Post	Qualification and other Criteria
1.1.1	Vice Principal	Please visit Army Public School, Sukna website www.apssukna.com
1.1.2	Headmaster / Headmistress	

1.2. Teachers on Adhoc Basis till 31 Mar 2027:-

Ser	Subject Post	Qualification and other Criteria
1.2.1	Special Educator (PRT)	Please visit Army Public School, Sukna website www.apssukna.com
1.2.2	PRT (Computer Science)	
1.2.3	PRT (All Subjects)	
1.2.4	PRT (Physical Education Trainer/Karate Instructor) (Preferably Lady)	
1.2.5	TGT (Bengali & Nepali)	

2. For Application forms, qualification and other details please visit school website (www.apssukna.com).

3. Applications duly completed should be sent direct to Army Public School, Sukna, PO-Sukna, Dist-Darjeeling-734009. Email address of the school is armyschoolsukna@gmail.com.

4. For any clarification contact School Office 0353-2573419/2573420 (Army No through Military Exchange Extn 2696).

Sd/-xxxxxxxxx
(Mrs Dola Sarkar Sinha)
Principal
Army Public School, Sukna

Case No : 155181/AS/Adv
Dated : 24 Sep 2026



CHANCELLOR'S SECRETARIAT
Inviting application for appointment of Vice Chancellor for:
SIKKIM NATIONAL LAW UNIVERSITY
(Established under the Sikkim National Law University Act, 2018 - Act No. 05 of 2018)
Recognised under Section 2(f) of the University Grants Commission Act, 1956
GANGTOK, SIKKIM

ADVERTISEMENT/RECRUITMENT NOTIFICATION
Advertisement No. SNLU/VC/2026/01
Date: 22.09.2026

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Dated: 24.09.2026



NEW DELHI MUNICIPAL COUNCIL
TAX DEPARTMENT
Palika Kendra, New Delhi

PUBLIC NOTICE
Previous Publication of Draft Bye-laws relating to Property Tax under the amended provisions of the New Delhi Municipal Council Act, 1994, read with the Jan Vishwas (Amendment of Provisions) Act, 2026 - Inviting objections/ suggestions from the general public and stakeholders liable to pay property tax within the NDMC area

Notice is hereby given to all the citizens, property owners, occupiers and other stakeholders liable to pay Property Tax in the New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) area that the **Jan Vishwas (Amendment of Provisions) Act, 2026** has been enacted and the relevant amended provisions have come into force **w.e.f. 15.05.2026**.
In pursuance of the amended provisions of the **New Delhi Municipal Council Act, 1994**, the Draft Bye-laws relating to Property Tax have been prepared by the New Delhi Municipal Council and are now being made available for **previous publication** for information and for inviting objections/suggestions from the general public and other stakeholders.
The Draft Bye-laws has been made available in the public domain for a period of **30 days w.e.f. 24.09.2026** on the official website of the New Delhi Municipal Council at:
Website URL: https://ndmc.gov.in/public_notices_new.aspx [With the subject name "**Draft NDMC (Property Tax) Bye Laws 2026 (Previous Publication)**" under Public Notice]
All citizens, property owners, occupiers and other interested stakeholders are requested to carefully peruse the Draft Bye-laws and may submit their objections/suggestions, if any, **in writing within the stipulated period of 30 days, i.e. from 24.09.2026 up to 23.10.2026**.
Mode of Submission of Objections/Suggestions:
The objections/suggestions, if any, may be submitted through either of the following modes:
1. **Through e-mail:** The objections/suggestions may be sent to the designated e-mail address of the Tax Department, NDMC at: **E-mail:** tax.uam@ndmc.gov.in
2. **Through physical submission/post:** A physical copy of the objections/suggestions may be submitted to or forwarded by post to:
The Director (Tax)
New Delhi Municipal Council
Palika Kendra, Parliament Street, New Delhi-110001
The objections/suggestions submitted through either mode should clearly mention "**Objections/Suggestions on Draft Property Tax Bye-laws, 2026**" in the subject/heading of the communication.
Important:
1. The Draft Bye-laws are being published for the information of the public and for inviting objections/suggestions in accordance with the applicable provisions of law.
2. Any person desirous of submitting objections/suggestions may do so within the stipulated period of 30 days from the **date of publication, i.e. by 23.10.2026**.
3. The objections/suggestions should clearly indicate the relevant provision/clause of the Draft Bye-laws to which they pertain, along with the grounds/reasons and the proposed suggestion, wherever applicable.
4. Objections/suggestions may be submitted either through the above-mentioned e-mail address or in physical form at the address indicated above. **Objections/suggestions received after the expiry of the stipulated period of 30 days, i.e. after 23.10.2026, shall not be entertained or considered.**
5. The Draft Bye-laws shall be subject to the completion of the prescribed statutory procedure and shall take effect only in accordance with the provisions of the **New Delhi Municipal Council Act, 1994, as amended**, and other applicable provisions of law.
All concerned citizens and stakeholders are requested to participate in the process and submit their considered objections/ suggestions within the stipulated time.
This notice is issued in public interest.

Sd/-
Joint Director (Tax)



नरेन्द्र मोदी
प्रधानमंत्री



रेखा गुप्ता
मुख्यमंत्री, दिल्ली



सत्यमेव जयते
दिल्ली सरकार

प्रखर राष्ट्रवादी और उत्कृष्ट संगठनकर्ता

श्रद्धेय

पंडित दीनदयाल उपाध्याय जी

की जयंती पर

कोटि-कोटि नमन

“एकात्म मानव दर्शन के प्रणेता पंडित दीनदयाल उपाध्याय जी को उनकी जयंती पर शत-शत नमन। उन्होंने राष्ट्र निर्माण में अपना जीवन समर्पित कर दिया। उनके विचार देशवासियों को सदैव प्रेरित करते रहेंगे।”

-नरेन्द्र मोदी, प्रधानमंत्री

Surat medical college PG student dies by suicide

Express News Service
Surat, September 24

A 28-YEAR-OLD postgraduate student at the Government Medical College in Surat allegedly died by suicide by slitting both his hands on Thursday afternoon, police said.

Dr Yogendra Prajapati, who was a third-year student at the anatomy department, allegedly injured himself at the dissection hall of the department, the Khatodara police added. This was the second such incident at the Surat medical college in under two months.

“Dr Prajapati had been in the dissection hall since morning and was involved in the undergraduate students’ examination. His own third-year exams had concluded last week, and he was completing some remaining terms,” in-charge Medical Superintendent Dr Parul Vadgama was quoted as saying by PTI. Dr Prajapati lived with his wife, four-year-old son and parents at the college’s hostel quarters.

Police sources said Dr Prajapati, a resident doctor at New Civil Hospital, had been at the dissection wing since the morning. When alone after his colleagues left in the afternoon, he allegedly used a sharp object to

cut blood vessels near the elbows of both his hands, they added.

The reasons for his extreme step were not clear, the officials said. Dr Prajapati was found unconscious on the floor by one of the students. Dr Vadgama, Dean Dr. Jayesh Brahmabhatt and the police control room were then informed.

The police said a case of accidental death had been registered against the incident and that they spoke to the family members.

Khatodara police inspector N V Bharwad said, “We have not found any suicide note. The reason behind him taking such a drastic step is not yet known. This year was his last of his MD in anatomy. At present, it is difficult to say anything, but we are probing the case.”

On August 9, a 30-year-old student identified as Harsh Pandya allegedly died by suicide at his hostel room.

A probe found that the first-year student of the microbiology department had faced verbal abuse and humiliation, and four senior resident doctors were subsequently booked in a criminal case and suspended. The four accused, however, were yet to be arrested by police.

(WITH PTI INPUTS)

Mentor support before disciplinary action: IIT Bombay committee discusses measures

Pallavi Smart
Mumbai, September 24

STUDENTS CAUGHT for examination malpractice at IIT Bombay may be allowed to speak to their student mentors before facing a disciplinary committee, while the first page of answer sheets could carry details of the consequences of malpractice, as part of a proposed overhaul of how such cases are handled at the institute.

These are some measures being discussed by newly constituted committee at IIT Bombay that will frame student-friendly Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) for invigilators and review the manner in which incidents of suspected academic misconduct are dealt with.

The committee will have equal representation of faculty and students, a move that comes days after students included greater representation in decision-making bodies among the 18 demands in a charter submitted to IIT Bombay director on September 20.

The move comes days after the death of Sahil Wakode, a second-year BTech student, who was allegedly found with a mobile phone inside an examination hall during mid-semester examinations. IIT Bombay’s initial statement said he was allegedly found using an AI platform to seek answers to questions.

The institute has further postponed remaining mid-semester examinations. The papers, earlier rescheduled for September 26 and 27 after being postponed on September 18, will now be held on October 10 and 11, according to a communication from the Dean Academics Programmes (AP) to students.

A separate email from General Secretary (Academics) informed students about the constitution of the new committee.

“The postponement allows time for the newly constituted committee, which has equal student representation, to prepare a clear and student-friendly SOP for invigilators, along with revised rules regarding academic misconduct. The aim is to ensure fair and consistent conduct of examinations, with due consideration for students’ concerns,” the

email said. It added student stakeholders had been consulted before the changes to the examination schedule.

The committee is also expected to lay down clear, step-by-step procedures for invigilators dealing with suspected academic misconduct, including the action to be taken at each stage. The revised SOP and rules will be placed before the Senate for approval before they are implemented, the email said.

According to sources, the institute is reviewing rules on disciplinary action for academic malpractice notified in July 2026. While those rules lay down consequences of various forms of misconduct, the new committee is expected to focus on how these rules are implemented, with an emphasis on ensuring the process does not unnecessarily add to students’ stress.

One proposal under discussion is allowing a student caught allegedly copying or committing another form of examination malpractice to speak to their student mentor before appearing before a disciplinary committee.

Student’s parents begin hunger strike

Express News Service
Mumbai, September 24

THE PARENTS of IIT Bombay student Sahil Wakode, who died by suicide last week, began a hunger strike at Azad Maidan on Thursday, demanding the arrest of officials named in the FIR registered in connection with their son’s death. The protest came a day after the couple alleged that they were forcibly taken out of Mumbai when they planned to stage a protest outside the IIT Bombay campus.

The Wakodes demanded that the entire CCTV footage related to the incident be made public, alleging that only a portion of it had been shared with the media. They said the limited footage raised questions about the handling of evidence.

“Instead of arresting the accused, they have leaked only a small bit of the CCTV footage to the media, where one cannot certainly see what is happening. They should release the entire CCTV footage to know what actually happened,” said Ravindra Wakode, Sahil’s father.



Sahil Wakode’s parents sit on a hunger strike at Azad Maidan in Mumbai on Thursday. GANESH SHIRSEKAR

The family reiterated its demand for the immediate arrest of those named in their complaint to the police, he said.

The parents were eventually asked to move out of Azad Maidan by police after 9pm. “As per the permission, they followed the rules and so they left,” said Nikhil Kamble, their lawyer, adding they plan to resume the protest on Saturday. They don’t have permission for protest at Azad Maidan on Friday due to Anant Chaturdashi festival.

Earlier in the day, Ravindra and Sonali Wakode met Kishor Makwana, chairperson of the National Commission for Scheduled Castes (NCSC), which has taken suo motu cognisance of the complaint. During the meeting, the Wakodes raised concerns over alleged handling and leakage of evidence in the investigation being conducted by the Mumbai Crime Branch.

FSSAI proposes ban on sale of analogue ‘paneer’

Anonna Dutt
New Delhi, September 24

THE COUNTRY’S apex food regulator, Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI), has proposed amending its regulations to prevent the sale of analogue products as ‘paneer’ — non-dairy substitutes in which milk fats and milk proteins are replaced with vegetable oils, fats and vegetable proteins. In a draft notification published recently, the FSSAI invited people to submit suggestions within 60 days.

The notification prohibits the sale of “paneer made of constituents not derived from milk” as paneer saying, “The amendment is proposed to restrict the manufacturing and sale of analogue products as paneer to prevent misleading consumers regarding the nature and composition of the product. Products already licensed or registered under the ‘Analogue in Dairy Context’ category shall discontinue the use of the term ‘paneer’ in their nomenclature, labelling or marketing”.

Under FSSAI’s existing dairy products standards, paneer may only be made from milk and milk solids, and may contain acidulants such as lactic acid, citric acid, malic acid, vinegar, glucono delta-lactone and sour whey, along with salt, spices or condiments. Vegetable oils, fats and vegetable proteins are not permitted. The issue gained attention last year after social media posts alleged “fake paneer” was served at Gauri Khan’s Mumbai restaurant

‘EDUCATION SHOULDN’T SUFFER’ Shopian court orders re-opening of seminary shut under the UAPA

Bashaarat Masood
Srinagar, September 24

FIVE MONTHS after it was declared an “unlawful entity” under the UAPA, a J&K court has ordered the re-opening of Siraj-ul-Aloom — one of the largest seminaries in south Kashmir.

The court directed formation of a committee to supervise the working of the school. The committee will have a representative from district administration, a representative of the education department, and a “reputable person” from the district as its members, the District Court, Shopian, said. While passing an interim order in a petition filed by the seminary, District Judge Shopian Mehmood Ahmad Chowdhary ordered the re-opening of the seminary.

“It was an interim direction. The court said that the education of the students shouldn’t suffer,” Advocate SM Iqbal, representing the Siraj-ul-Aloom, said. “The court ordered the restoration of the school and its assets, including the hostel and the orchard, till the final outcome of the petition.”

A detailed order is likely to be released on Friday, Iqbal said.

Siraj-ul-Aloom was declared as an “unlawful entity” by government under the Unlawful Activities Prevention Act (UAPA). The order declaring it an unlawful entity had accused

the seminary of having “covert linkages” with banned outfit Jamaat-e-Islami (JeI), besides allegations such as “serious legal, administrative and financial irregularities” and “radicalization”.

The ban order had said that the seminary was given an opportunity to explain its position but the objections submitted by the Institute were “misconceived, factually untenable, and devoid of legal merit”.

Siraj-ul-Aloom was the first seminary to be declared unlawful in Jammu and Kashmir, days after the government took over 58 schools “affiliated” to the Falah-e-Aam Trust (FAT). The political leaders in the Valley had called it a “vicious attack on Jammu and Kashmir’s identity and dignity”.

Siraj-ul-Aloom ran a school that imparted both religious and modern education to the students.

Before the ban, the school that ran classes up to standard 12 was recognised by the Jammu and Kashmir Board of School Education.

The school was established in 1998 after a local saint, Peer Gull Mohammad Sofi, donated six hectares of his land for it. While some of the members of the institute were affiliated with the banned Jamat-e-Islami, the school was run by a separate body under the Siraj-ul-Aloom Educational Trust.

Army officer faces court martial over contact with Pak operatives

Man Aman Singh Chhina
Chandigarh, September 24

A SERVING Indian Army officer posted at Army Headquarters in New Delhi is facing a court martial for contact with Pakistani intelligence operatives and having banned applications on his smart phone.

The Lieutenant Colonel is posted in the Staff Duties (SD) Directorate in Army Headquarters and is currently attached to 226 Company Army Service Corps (Supply) Type ‘G’. The nine charges levelled against him relate to the period when he was performing duties as General Staff Officer-1 at SD Directorate Army Headquarters in New Delhi.

The first three charges, framed under Section 45 of the Army Act (unbecoming conduct of an officer), allege that between December 24, 2019 and September 16, 2022 he was in contact with two numbers described as suspected Pakistan Intelligence Operative numbers and with ten Pakistan-based numbers beginning with the +92 country code.

He is accused of contacting a foreign national identified as ‘Anatoly’ between January 2020 and August 2022 without permission. The charge sheet does not itself record a finding of guilt. Under military law the officer is entitled to a trial before a court martial, where the prosecution must prove each allegation and the accused may defend himself.

Centre seeks prospective application of SC verdict on OBC creamy-layer criteria to prevent ‘chaos’

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 24

THE CENTRE on Thursday urged the Supreme Court to give it a “reasonable time” of two or more years to operationalise its March 11, 2026 judgement, which held the creamy layer status of Other Backward Classes (OBC) cannot be decided solely on parental income. The government argued retrospective or belated application of the changed eligibility criterion could unsettle appointments and admissions made under prevailing rules and certificates.

A bench of Justices P.S. Narasimha and R. Mahadevan reserved its order on the miscellaneous application, which sought invocation of the SC’s powers under Article 142 of the Constitution to give the judgement prospective effect.

The Centre said if the judgement was not given prospective effect, it would result in “several harsh and unjust unintended consequences” for employees and appointees who were not even parties to litigation, besides causing “complete administrative chaos”. Prospective effect, it said, would ensure that ongoing and past recruitment processes remained unaffected. It argued that implementing the judgement retrospectively could have significant consequences, “Retrospective or belated application may create uncertainty regarding OBC-Non Creamy Layer status, seniority, service conditions and career progression— while also potentially affecting admissions to central and state educational and professional institutions,” the government contended.

The government listed several consequences of retrospective application, including retrospective allocation of services to fresh candidates from Civil Services Examinations held since 2012, retrospective reallocation of cadres for candidates already in IAS or IPS, potential discrimination against OBC aspirants in various examinations and a “broader impact on OBC reservation policy across the country”.

Seeking a two-year timeframe, the Centre said this is necessary to undertake the exercise of establishing equivalence of posts, in consultation with stakeholders and to formulate a uniform policy for determining OBC creamy-layer status in categories where such equivalence has not yet been established.

The March 11 judgment held that treating similarly placed employees of private entities and Public Sector Undertakings (PSUs) differently from government employees, for the purpose of their wards’ entitlement to reservation, would amount to hostile discrimination.

Court allows foreign nationals held in NIA terror case to leave India for a month

Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, September 24

A DELHI court on Thursday allowed seven foreign nationals, who were arrested in March for allegedly conspiring to carry out terrorist activities against India, to return to the USA and Ukraine for a period of one month to meet their families, subject to conditions.

After paying compounding charges to Foreigners Regional Registration Office (FRRO) in Delhi, the six Ukrainians and the American have been discharged in allegations pertaining to the Immigration and Foreigners Act (IFA), 2025. “The right to travel abroad is an extension of fundamental rights... which cannot be taken lightly... a balance has to be struck,” said NIA Special Judge Prashant Sharma in an order dated September 24. “Applicant and co-accused persons have shown willingness to join the investigation, as and when asked by NIA... Therefore... I find merits in application,” he added.

An FIR against the seven foreign nationals — Matthew Aaron Vandyke, Viktor Kaminskyi, Petro Hurba, Taras Slyviak, Ivan Sukmanovskiy, Marian Stefankiv, and Maksim Honcharuk — was lodged under anti-terror law (punishment for conspiracy). They were arrested for allegedly conspiring to carry out terrorist activities against India.

In their first chargesheet, the NIA invoked only sections of IFA. “More time is required in order to ascertain and verify... the commission of offences under UAPA,” the NIA had submitted.

They were granted default bail as the first chargesheet did not contain sections of the UAPA. “...For completing the investigation, necessary undertakings may be taken from all accused persons,” Thursday’s order read.

3 years on the run, dismissed Punjab AIG held

Patiala: The Anti-Narcotics Task Force Thursday arrested dismissed Punjab Police AIG Rajjit Singh Hundal from his Patiala house over pending cases arising from the probe into the alleged police-drug mafia nexus.

The arrest comes days after SC directed Hundal to surrender. The case dates back to 2017 arrest of dismissed inspector Inderjit Singh by Punjab Police’s STF in drug cases. The HC rejected his anticipatory bail plea in August 2023. He joined STF probe in October 2023 after interim protection, but sources said he skipped agencies. ENS

Told by HC to terminate pregnancy of minor rape victim, hospital performs delivery; probe ordered

Bhupendra Pandey
Lucknow, September 24

STATING THAT its order for termination of pregnancy in a minor rape victim was not complied with, the Allahabad High Court has ordered the Principal Secretary (Medical and Health) to probe into role of the Head of the Gynaecology Department at Moti Lal Nehru Medical College and doctors at its associated Swaroop Rani Hospital in Prayagraj for putting the life of the girl at risk by performing C-section surgery to deliver the child. The court stated that it was a “fit” case for action against the doctors for having “played with the life of a rape victim”.

Hearing a petition for termination of pregnancy of a minor rape victim, the bench of Justice Ajit Kumar and Justice Garima Prashad had earlier constituted a medical board to give its opinion on the request. While giving no categorical opinion either in favour of or against the termination of pregnancy, the medical board had recorded the foetus, of approximately 29 weeks, had crossed the stage of viability and that, since it was a high-risk pregnancy, both its continuation and termination carried associated medical risks.

While the girl’s Aadhaar card put her age at 13 years, the radiological examination, carried out by medical board in August, estimated her age to be 16 years. The medical board said the minor “appeared to understand nature and consequences” of termination of pregnancy, and expressed her desire not to continue the pregnancy, saying its continuation would cause further harm to her mental health. The bench, earlier on September 16 and on Monday, directed the chief medical superintendent (CMS) of the Hospital to admit the minor and terminate the pregnancy on Tuesday by the “safest medically permissible procedure”, after completing requisite formalities and ensuring all necessary medical safeguards. “The procedure shall be performed by an appropriate team of specialist doctors,” the Bench ordered, and fixed next date for hearing to September 29. On Wednesday morning, an urgent application was moved, stating the order for termination had not been complied with.

श्री नरेन्द्र मोदी
माननीय प्रधानमंत्री

श्रीमती रेखा गुप्ता
माननीय मुख्यमंत्री

एक शाम
दिव्यांगजन के नाम

सेवा संकल्प अभियान के अंतर्गत
विशेष सम्मान एवं जागरूकता कार्यक्रम

समाज कल्याण विभाग, राष्ट्रीय राजधानी क्षेत्र, दिल्ली सरकार

द्वारा आयोजित इस विशेष कार्यक्रम में आप सादर आमंत्रित हैं।

मुख्य अतिथि

डॉ. वीरेंद्र कुमार

केंद्रीय सामाजिक न्याय
एवं अधिकारिता मंत्री, भारत सरकार

विशिष्ट अतिथि

श्रीमती रेखा गुप्ता

माननीय मुख्यमंत्री
दिल्ली सरकार

गरिमा मयी उपस्थिति

श्री रविन्द्र इन्द्राज सिंह

माननीय मंत्री, समाज कल्याण विभाग
दिल्ली सरकार

दिनांक: शुक्रवार, 25 सितंबर 2026

समय: सायं 4:00 बजे से रात्रि 8:00 बजे तक

स्थान: तालकटोरा इंडोर स्टेडियम, दिल्ली – 110001

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“ हम अपने दिव्यांग बहनों और भाइयों के लिए एक समावेशी और सुगम्य भविष्य सुनिश्चित करने के लिए पूरी प्रतिबद्धता के साथ कार्य कर रहे हैं। ”

– नरेन्द्र मोदी, प्रधानमंत्री

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BLOOD CANCER

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Research for Better Medicines

Early Warning Signs of Blood Cancer

Blood cancers can develop gradually, and their early symptoms may resemble common infections or other medical conditions. Certain persistent or unexplained changes, however, warrant medical evaluation. Persistent fatigue may result from anaemia caused by impaired blood-cell production. Recurrent or unusually severe infections can occur when white-cell production or immune function is affected. Easy bruising, frequent nosebleeds or prolonged bleeding may indicate reduced platelet counts. Unexplained fever, drenching night sweats and unintentional weight loss are important systemic symptoms, particularly when they persist without an identifiable cause. Painless, progressively enlarging lymph nodes may occur with lymphoma. Persistent bone pain, especially when accompanied by fatigue or abnormal blood results, may occasionally indicate multiple myeloma. These symptoms do not mean that a person has cancer. Most individuals with fatigue, fever or enlarged lymph nodes have other, more common conditions. Clinical examination and appropriate investigations are essential. A complete blood count (CBC) is often a useful initial test. It evaluates haemoglobin, white blood cells and platelets and may identify abnormalities requiring further investigation. Depending on findings, doctors may recommend a peripheral smear, imaging, bone marrow examination or molecular testing. Persistent, progressive or unexplained symptoms should therefore be discussed with a physician. Timely evaluation can distinguish common conditions from serious haematological disorders and facilitate appropriate treatment.



Dr. (MAJ.) A.P. Dubey
Medical Oncologist

Why Recurrent Infections May Need a Blood Count

Occasional infections are a normal part of life. However, recurrent, unusually severe or prolonged infections may sometimes indicate an underlying problem with the immune system or blood-cell production. White blood cells, particularly neutrophils and lymphocytes, play essential roles in protecting the body against infection. Reduced numbers or abnormal function can increase susceptibility to infections. Several conditions can cause low white-cell counts, including viral illnesses, nutritional deficiencies, medications, autoimmune disorders and bone-marrow diseases. Some blood cancers can also interfere with normal white-cell production. Patients may notice repeated fevers, persistent mouth ulcers, frequent respiratory infections, skin infections or infections that take unusually long to resolve. These symptoms are not diagnostic of cancer, but their pattern may warrant investigation. A complete blood count with differential leukocyte count is often an appropriate starting point. It provides information about the number and types of circulating white blood cells. If significant abnormalities persist, physicians may recommend additional investigations such as peripheral smear examination, nutritional testing, infection screening, immunological assessment or bone marrow evaluation. It is important not to assume that recurrent infections automatically indicate weak immunity or blood cancer. A structured medical evaluation can identify the underlying reason. Patients should particularly seek medical attention when infections are becoming more frequent, severe or difficult to treat. Recognising abnormal patterns early can help identify treatable conditions and, when necessary, allow timely referral to a haematologist



Dr. Faran Naim
Hematologist

Caregivers: Supporting a Person with Blood Cancer



Dr. Mayank Soni
Hematologist

A blood-cancer diagnosis affects the patient as well as the family. Caregivers frequently become an important part of treatment, helping with appointments, medications, transportation, nutrition and daily activities. One of the most valuable forms of support is effective communication. Patients may experience fear, uncertainty, frustration or emotional exhaustion. Caregivers do not always need to provide answers; listening without judgement can be equally valuable. Practical organisation can make complex treatment schedules easier to manage. Maintaining records of appointments, medicines, investigations and questions for the medical team can improve continuity of care. With the patient's permission, caregivers can attend consultations and help ensure important information is understood. Caregivers should also know which symptoms require urgent attention. The treating

haematology team should provide clear instructions regarding fever, significant bleeding, severe breathlessness, confusion or sudden deterioration. At the same time, caregivers must recognise their own needs. Prolonged caregiving can result in physical exhaustion, anxiety, sleep disturbance and burnout. Accepting assistance from relatives, friends or professional support services is appropriate and often necessary. The caregiver's role is not to replace the doctor or nursing team. It is to provide practical, emotional and social support while helping the patient navigate treatment. Every patient's requirements are different. Some may need substantial assistance during intensive treatment, whereas others remain largely independent. Good caregiving ultimately means helping the patient maintain dignity, autonomy and confidence, while ensuring that important medical and emotional needs are recognised throughout the cancer journey.

Childhood Blood Cancer: What Parents Should Know



Dr. Megha Saroha
Hematologist

A diagnosis of blood cancer in a child is deeply distressing for families. However, advances in paediatric haematology and oncology have substantially improved outcomes for many childhood blood cancers. Acute lymphoblastic leukemia (ALL) is the most common childhood cancer, while acute myeloid leukemia and lymphomas also occur. Children may present with persistent fever, pallor, fatigue, recurrent infections, easy bruising, bleeding, bone or joint pain, enlarged lymph nodes or unexplained weight loss. These symptoms are common in childhood infections and other benign conditions. Their persistence, recurrence, severity or combination with abnormal blood counts determines whether further investigation is required. A complete blood count is often an important initial test. If abnormalities raise concern, further evaluation may include peripheral smear examination, bone marrow assessment, flow cytometry, cytogenetic studies and molecular testing. Treatment is increasingly risk-adapted and depends on the precise diagnosis, genetic characteristics, age, disease burden and response to therapy. Depending on the condition, treatment may involve chemotherapy, targeted therapy, immunotherapy or, in selected situations, stem-cell transplantation. Parents should not blame themselves for their child's illness. Most childhood blood cancers arise from complex biological events rather than parental actions. Persistent or unusual symptoms should be evaluated promptly. Referral to a specialised paediatric haematology-oncology centre enables timely diagnosis, multidisciplinary care and appropriate treatment.

Leukemia: When Persistent Symptoms Need Medical Attention



Dr. P. K. Das
Medical Oncologist

Leukemia is a malignant disorder of blood-forming cells, usually originating in the bone marrow. Abnormal leukemic cells interfere with production of normal red cells, white cells and platelets. Patients may develop persistent fatigue, weakness or breathlessness because of anaemia. Frequent or prolonged infections can occur when normal white-cell production is impaired. Reduced platelet levels may cause easy bruising, nosebleeds, gum bleeding or prolonged bleeding. Fever, night sweats, unexplained weight loss, bone or joint discomfort and enlarged lymph nodes may also occur. However, these symptoms are not specific to leukemia and may have several other causes. Leukemia is broadly classified into acute and chronic forms. Acute leukemias can progress rapidly and require prompt diagnosis and treatment, whereas chronic leukemias may occasionally be detected during routine blood testing. A complete blood count and peripheral blood smear are important initial investigations. If leukemia is suspected, bone marrow examination with flow cytometry, cytogenetic studies and molecular testing may be necessary to establish the precise diagnosis. Persistent unexplained symptoms should not be ignored, but they should not lead to self-diagnosis either. Medical evaluation is the essential first step. Modern leukemia treatment is increasingly guided by disease biology, molecular abnormalities, patient fitness and treatment response. Accurate classification is therefore fundamental to selecting appropriate therapy and achieving optimal outcomes.

Multiple Myeloma: Recognising Bone Pain and Fatigue

Multiple myeloma is a malignancy of plasma cells, immune cells that normally produce antibodies and reside mainly in the bone marrow. Abnormal plasma cells can interfere with normal blood formation and affect bones, kidneys and immunity. Persistent bone pain, particularly involving the back, ribs or hips, is a recognised feature. Myeloma can weaken bones and increase fracture risk. However, most back or skeletal pain is unrelated to myeloma. Fatigue is another common presentation and may result from anaemia caused by reduced normal marrow function. Patients may also experience recurrent infections because abnormal plasma-cell proliferation interferes with normal immune responses. Other manifestations may result from increased calcium levels or kidney involvement. Excessive thirst, frequent urination, constipation, nausea, confusion or deterioration in kidney function require appropriate assessment. Multiple myeloma may sometimes be detected incidentally when investigations reveal unexplained anaemia, elevated calcium, impaired renal function or abnormal protein in blood or urine. Evaluation generally includes blood and urine protein studies, serum free-light-chain testing, appropriate imaging and bone marrow examination. Cytogenetic investigations can provide important prognostic information. Persistent unexplained bone pain accompanied by fatigue or abnormal laboratory findings should not simply be attributed to ageing or routine musculoskeletal disease. Specialist evaluation can determine whether myeloma or another condition is responsible. Early diagnosis allows complications to be addressed and appropriate treatment to begin.



Dr. Rohan Halder
Hematologist

Lymphoma: Understanding Painless Swollen Lymph Nodes



Dr. Roshan Dikshit
Hematologist

Lymph nodes are important components of the immune system and commonly enlarge during infections. Tender lymph nodes associated with an infection usually decrease in size as the illness resolves. Persistent or progressively enlarging painless lymph nodes, however, deserve medical assessment. Lymphoma is a cancer arising from lymphocytes, a type of white blood cell. It broadly includes Hodgkin lymphoma and numerous types of non-Hodgkin lymphoma, each with different biological characteristics and treatment approaches. Lymphoma may present with enlarged lymph nodes in the neck, axilla, groin or other locations. Some patients develop unexplained fever, drenching night sweats, weight loss or persistent fatigue. Depending on location, enlarged nodes may occasionally cause cough, breathlessness or abdominal discomfort. Importantly, most enlarged lymph nodes are not caused by lymphoma. Infections

remain a far more common cause. Doctors consider duration, size, distribution, consistency and associated symptoms when deciding whether investigation is necessary. Evaluation may include blood tests and imaging. When lymphoma is suspected, a properly performed lymph-node biopsy is generally required for definitive diagnosis and classification.

The message is not to fear every swollen lymph node, but to avoid ignoring one that persists without an obvious explanation. Early evaluation allows benign causes to be identified and, when lymphoma is present, enables accurate diagnosis, staging and appropriate treatment planning.

A Patient Awareness Initiative



Research for Better Medicines



Cancer Awareness Talk
Revolutionizing Cancer Health Care

Newer Treatments Changing Blood-Cancer Care

Blood-cancer treatment has undergone a remarkable transformation. While chemotherapy remains important, modern haematology increasingly incorporates targeted therapies, monoclonal antibodies, immunotherapies and cellular therapies based on disease biology. Targeted treatments interfere with specific proteins or molecular pathways that cancer cells depend upon. Their development has significantly changed the management of several leukemias, lymphomas and plasma-cell disorders. Immunotherapy represents another major advance. Monoclonal antibodies can recognise specific antigens on malignant cells, while other immune-based treatments help the patient's immune system identify and eliminate cancer cells. In selected diseases, checkpoint inhibitors and antibody-drug conjugates have become valuable treatment options. Cellular therapy has expanded with chimeric antigen receptor T-cell therapy, or CAR-T therapy. In appropriate patients, T cells are collected, genetically modified to recognise cancer cells and subsequently returned to the patient. Treatment is increasingly guided by molecular characteristics, disease risk, previous therapy, measurable treatment response and overall patient fitness. Consequently, patients with the same broad diagnosis may appropriately receive different therapeutic strategies. Newer therapies are not automatically suitable for everyone. Each has specific indications, potential toxicities and monitoring requirements. The most important development is therefore not simply the availability of more medicines. It is the transition toward biologically informed, risk-adapted and patient-centred treatment. The ultimate goal remains clear: achieve durable disease control, improve survival and minimise treatment-related toxicity while preserving quality of life.



Dr. Vipul Seth
Hematologist



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BECAUSE THE TRUTH INVOLVES US ALL

Don't ask women to shrink, secure their space

NEARLY 14 years ago, what was meant to be an ordinary evening out for a young woman and her friend ended in a horrific ordeal — the December 16 gang rape in the Capital ignited nationwide protests, bringing the issue of women's safety to the forefront of political and civic discourse. The alleged gang rape of a 17-year-old girl at a park in Southeast Delhi earlier this week shows that the questions raised by the 2012 incident and the anxieties it exposed have hardly receded. In the protests by students of Lady Shri Ram College and other Delhi University (DU) institutions, old concerns have resurfaced: ill-lit streets, inadequate police presence, unsafe pedestrian routes. The latest National Crime Records Bureau data reinforces this: Delhi recorded 13,396 crimes against women in 2024, the highest among metros. It also recorded 1,058 rape cases, the highest among the 19 tracked metros. In a nation that aspires to women-led development, this is both a deeper failure and a sobering contradiction.

That these vulnerabilities persist points not to a lack of laws or schemes, but to failures of implementation, maintenance and accountability. In the aftermath of the 2012 incident, the Nirbhaya Fund was set up to finance measures, including better public infrastructure, to improve women's safety. It has remained consistently underutilised. Following the latest incident, three men have been arrested. The Delhi L-G has ordered a safety audit of parks across the city and the deployment of pink booths — police assistance kiosks managed primarily by women personnel — measures that should have been par for the course, but remain sporadic. The fact that the accused pretended to be policemen when they apprehended the survivor and her friend also points to another failing — the moral policing routinely carried out by cops in public spaces made the deception possible.

As more and more women enter public life, this model of paternalism that speaks in the language of protection must make room for one that focuses on being enablers instead. That means functioning streetlights, usable footpaths, reliable late-evening public transport, working CCTV systems, emergency response mechanisms, and regular safety audits. That means re-examining ideas of masculinity in society. DU attracts students from all over the country. Across campuses and in other public spaces, women cannot be expected to secure themselves by shrinking their lives. They should be able to live fully — work late, travel alone, meet friends, protest or simply walk home without having to look over their shoulders. The real measure of *narishakti* is not how often the phrase is invoked, but whether women can claim public spaces with the same freedom that men take for granted.

In Trump's annihilation threat, a tiny space

US PRESIDENT Donald Trump's address to the UN General Assembly on Wednesday appeared to have little regard for the foundational purpose of the organisation whose podium he was standing on. It was consistent with the doctrine that has driven the Trump administration in its second term: That US military and economic might will determine peace and order, not multilateral institutions and the gruelling work of diplomacy. Apart from his usual listing of what he describes as domestic triumphs, Trump threatened to "annihilate" Iran if a deal was not reached, declared that "freedom will be coming to Cuba" and presented US actions against Venezuela as both a victory and a warning to other countries. He also renewed his attack on climate science. On artificial intelligence — which he said will henceforth be called "superintelligence" in US documents — he dismissed warnings about AI risks as a "hoax", a striking position to take on the eve of his summit with Chinese President Xi Jinping, when he had an opportunity to lay out the stakes of the US-China technological competition.

The US President, however, appears to have kept space for diplomacy. The US and Iran are locked in a stalemate, and if US reluctance to militarily assist Saudi Arabia in the face of Houthis gains any indication, Trump is aware that further escalation will come with political costs ahead of the midterms. Shortly after the speech, he disclosed that US and Iranian officials had held three hours of talks in New York, with further talks expected. The threat of overwhelming force deployed simultaneously with the prospect of a negotiated settlement, a hallmark of his foreign policy so far, was again on display. Iran, too, while defiant, has left the door open for talks, with President Masoud Pezeshkian saying in his UN speech that Tehran is ready for dialogue "without accepting the language of force".

Much of the credit for the UN Charter, which generally prohibits the threat or use of force against states, lies with the US. The UN itself was built, in large part, around an American conception of a rules-based international system in which even great powers would accept constraints on the use of force. Trump's speech represented a very different conception, one in which American strength is itself the source of order.

A saxophone in search of India

IN 1961, saxophonist John Coltrane, who would have turned 100 on September 23, recorded a piece at Village Vanguard in New York and called it 'India'. It was a country he had never visited but whose music and philosophy entered his imagination through listening to and collecting records of sitar giant Pandit Ravi Shankar (he even took lessons from him). Coltrane would also name his second son Ravi. He later made the jarring 'Om', but it was 'India' that perhaps came closer to capturing the Hindustani classical influences. Criticised at this time for being anti-jazz, Coltrane was looking beyond conventional jazz.

Born into a musical family in North Carolina, Coltrane began playing saxophone as a teenager. After serving in the US Navy band, he worked through the jazz world before joining Miles Davis's quintet in 1955, when segregated clubs and racial discrimination were the norm under Jim Crow laws. Davis was once beaten and arrested by white officers for standing on the sidewalk. His pain was heard in the haunting 'Alabama', where Coltrane's saxophone is patterned after Martin Luther King Jr's eulogy for four African-American girls killed in a Ku Klux Klan bombing.

Coltrane got heavily into heroin and alcohol, which led Davis to drop him. This wake-up call led him to spiritual music, including music from India. In *A Love Supreme*, jazz became a means for finding faith. Coltrane absorbed sounds and ideas from different traditions, making them part of a voice unmistakably his own. His quest, cut short by death at 40 from liver cancer, continues to be heard in the phenomenal standards he left behind.

Rethink or abandon SIR. Revelations about ECI take lid off electoral upheaval



THAROORTHINK
BY SHASHI THAROOR

THE EXPLOSIVE investigative report by *The Indian Express* revealing that two Election Commissioners formally recorded written objections at least 14 times over 10 months against decisions taken by Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, red-flagging unilateral and "unauthorised" changes to new voter registration forms, and objecting to mass voter deletions during the ongoing SIR exercise, has taken the lid off an electoral upheaval that is insidiously reshaping the contours of Indian democracy. What was conceived as a routine technical cleanup of electoral rolls has mushroomed into a bureaucratic drag-net of unprecedented scale, raising fundamental questions about franchise, citizenship, and administrative overreach.

The news about Delhi's voter roll would be farcical if it weren't so grave in its implications: More than half (54.6 per cent) of the Capital's existing voters have either been struck off the voter roll or been served notices by the Election Commission of India (ECI) asking them to prove that they are genuine. Out of Delhi's 1.45 crore registered voters, over 80 lakh are currently under the ECI scanner. Approximately 47.5 lakh voters have been marked for deletion under the categories of Absent, Shifted, Dead, or Duplicate. A further 33.13 lakh have been flagged for operational and technical errors, including 19.33 lakh marked for "logical discrepancies"

and 13.80 lakh left unmapped against the 2002 electoral rolls. By mid-September, over 31.6 lakh notices had been generated. This massive contraction is far from limited to Delhi. Across 17 of the 19 states and Union Territories undergoing the third phase of the SIR, electoral rolls are reportedly shrinking by over 15 per cent. National estimates suggest that overall deletions could wipe out 12 to 13 crore voters nationwide, with Maharashtra alone expected to lose up to 2 crore voters, Delhi shrinking by 35.89 per cent, and Chandigarh by 31.84 per cent. Instead of India's voters choosing the government, it seems the government, acting through the ECI, will choose the voters.

Curiously, this purge comes on the heels of pre-existing, unexplained deletions. Between January 2025 and June 2026, prior to the launch of the SIR, 1.1 million Delhi voters were inexplicably dropped from the rolls. This anomaly diverges from standard demographic trends. Between the 2020 Assembly and 2024 Lok Sabha polls, around 4,00,000 voters were added; a similar number joined between the 2024 general election and the 2025 state polls. In a country where the adult population has expanded from 99 crore in 2024 to an estimated 103 crore today, logic dictates that electoral rolls should expand in tandem. Instead, analysts like Yogendra Yadav project that the national electorate could contract to 88 crore, effectively disenfranchising up to 15 crore citizens.

The mindless severity of the exercise was brought into sharp relief when the notice list caught prominent public figures from across the official spectrum. Delhi CM Rekha Gupta and her predecessor were flagged; ruling the state apparently confers no immunity. Foreign Minister S Jaishankar is speaking for India at the UN with an ECI-created cloud over his eligibility to do so. The list embraces constitutional dig-

Disenfranchising genuine citizens in haste is worse than allowing 10 times as many dead voters to remain on the rolls

Dissent is not dysfunction, institutions need it



GAURAV BHATIA

DELIBERATION, DEBATE, and internal dissent form the lifeblood of any functional constitutional democracy. Yet, an elementary principle of constitutional jurisprudence governs all collegiate bodies: While deliberation and dissent represent the intellectual process, it is the final outcome that constitutes the binding decision.

To challenge the legitimacy of an institution simply because its internal deliberations reflect divergent viewpoints, or because a ruling does not produce absolute unanimity, is legally unlettered and a calculated assault on institutional integrity. A multi-member body is crafted to assemble diverse viewpoints. When the Constitution provided for an Election Commission (ECI) under Article 324, and Parliament subsequently framed statutory frameworks to govern its functioning, the law explicitly structured the mechanics of collegiate decision-making.

Section 18 of the statutory enactment governing the ECI provides that while it should endeavour to act unanimously, in the event of any difference of opinion, matters must be decided according to the opinion of the majority. Consequently, an order delivered by even a 2:1 split does not suffer from any constitutional or legal infirmity. In the eyes of the law, the majority verdict is the sovereign verdict of the ECI.

The legal fiction that collegiate bodies require absolute unanimity was put to rest three decades ago by the Supreme Court in its landmark five-judge Constitution Bench ruling in *T N Seshan, Chief Election Commissioner of India v. Union of India & Ors.* (1995). The then-CEC challenged the conversion of the ECI from a single-member entity to a multi-member collegiate body, claiming absolute primacy and asserting that collegiate decision-making would impair institutional efficiency. The Court, speaking through Chief Justice A M Ahmadi, dismissed the challenge in its entirety. It held, "The function of the Election Commission is to take decisions through the process of collective deliberation, and in the event of a difference of opinion among the members, by a majority... the view of the majority is the view of the body."

The apex court operates under the identical constitutional premise. Landmark rulings, including the *Kesavananda Bharati* judgment, which established the Basic Structure doctrine via a razor-thin 7:6 majority, govern the Republic of India.

Congress's claim to be a protector of institutional autonomy is discredited by its history of institutional subversion. During the UPA regime, reports widely highlighted that appointments were steered directly through party channels. Reputed news agencies documented that critical appointment files for the electoral watchdog were cleared directly at the behest of Sonia Gandhi, culminating in the appointment of Navin Chawla as Election Commissioner in 2005.

Decades earlier, the Justice J C Shah Commission, established to investigate excesses committed during the 1975-1977 Emergency, explicitly found Chawla "unfit to hold any public office" due to documented abuse of administrative power. The institutional crisis peaked when sitting CEC N Gopalaswami invoked his constitutional prerogative under Article 324(5), submitting a detailed note to the President seeking Chawla's removal on grounds of institutional bias and political partisanship. Instead of honouring the constitutional framework, the Congress government summarily rejected the recommendation and rewarded Chawla by elevating him to CEC.

An equally damaging blow to the perception of electoral independence was dealt in the case of MS Gill. After being CEC, Gill was rewarded by Congress with a Rajya Sabha seat and inducted into the Union Cabinet as a minister of state. Those who spent decades superseding judges, abusing emergency powers, treating election commissioners' appointments as party prerogatives, and awarding cabinet berths to referees after retirement possess zero moral or jurisprudential authority to question India's constitutional institutions today. Institutional integrity is preserved not by manufactured consensus, but by faithful adherence to the Constitution, statutory mandates, and respect for collegiate outcomes.

The writer is national spokesperson, BJP and a senior advocate

nitaries and institutional heads, including an Election Commissioner, a CBI Director, and a distinguished list of "formers": A vice president, chief justice, Army chief, and SEBI chairman. The ECI claims this proves the process is non-discriminatory!

Yet, this defence highlights the core inequity of the process. While ministers, judges, and high-ranking officials possess the institutional access and resources to rectify technical glitches seamlessly, the average citizen is plunged into administrative chaos. Furthermore, many of these "discrepancies" originate not from citizen error, but from flawed internal ECI databases, such as coding errors where a father's recorded age of 45 was converted to zero, or a clerk misspelled a name, creating an artificial "logical discrepancy". Yesterday's *Express* report from Goa highlights how the ECI's software has eliminated large numbers of legitimate voters and deprived them of essential benefits from dialysis to transplants for which only voters are eligible. ('8 emails in 7 days, but valid Goa voters still left out: EC's flawed system', *IE*, September 23) The real-world fallout of this process reveals staggeringly inhumane anomalies. In Delhi, 24 out of 70 assembly constituencies now count fewer registered electors than the actual number of voters who cast ballots in the 2025 assembly elections. In polling booth 33 of the Chandni Chowk constituency, 908 out of 909 voters were summarily marked for deletion.

Already troubling was the experience in West Bengal, where 27 lakh voters were flagged for tribunal review due to alleged "logical discrepancies". The Right to Information (RTI) disclosures revealed that out of 82,000 cases adjudicated, 91 per cent were found to have been wrongly deleted and had to be restored. If nine out of 10 deletions under the banner of "logical discrepancies" are demonstrably false, the

foundational credibility of the ECI's algorithms stands compromised. While the Supreme Court has upheld the legality of the SIR, former election commissioner Ashok Lavasa and former CEC S Y Quraishi have openly questioned its fairness. Quraishi has critiqued the decision to treat the 2002 electoral roll as an unassailable baseline for voter mapping, pointing out that even his own father's name was misspelt in the 2002 data. Equally alarming is the delegation of quasi-judicial power to Booth Level Officers who are effectively tasked with verifying citizenship credentials for long-standing voters. Giving them and unreliable software the authority to decide whether citizens remain entitled to vote risks converting routine documentation checks into arbitrary purges.

Finally, the timing of these revisions raises concerns. In Bihar, Bengal, Kerala, and Tamil Nadu, the compressed execution of the SIR was scheduled right before major elections. The ECI has yet to provide a convincing rationale for forcing millions of voters into an administrative straitjacket under tight deadlines just weeks before they are due to exercise their franchise, without enough time to appeal and rectify an injustice. Disenfranchising genuine citizens in haste is worse than allowing 10 times as many dead voters to remain on the rolls.

The right to vote is the bedrock upon which democracy rests. When electoral rolls contract while populations grow, when nine out of 10 technical deletions prove erroneous upon review, and when millions of valid voters face disenfranchisement for no fault of their own, the integrity of our democracy is imperilled. Cleaning the voter rolls is a legitimate administrative objective; excluding legitimate citizens in the process is an institutional failure Indian democracy can ill afford. SIR must be rethought or abandoned.

The writer is a fourth-term Congress MP

AI has taken on a Millennium Problem. Is that scary?



PANKAJ DOSHI

OPENAI RECENTLY announced that an internal AI system had produced a proof addressing the Navier-Stokes existence and smoothness problem, one of Mathematics' seven Millennium Prize Problems. The claim will, as it should, be examined carefully by mathematicians. But whether every detail survives scrutiny is not the most important question for universities today. The more important fact is that AI systems are now operating at a level where they can participate in research that, until very recently, represented the outer edge of human intellectual effort. This should be a call to action for higher education. What should a university teach when increasingly capable machines can execute a growing share of the intellectual work that universities have traditionally trained people to perform? The appropriate response is to raise the level of human inquiry. When calculators became universal, we did not stop teaching mathematics; we stopped treating arithmetic as the summit of mathematical ability.

Technique alone will no longer be enough. A PhD student must learn to identify consequential questions, frame them rigorously, combine knowledge across disciplines, use AI systems intelligently, challenge their outputs, and connect computational answers to physical reality. Doctoral training should become more ambitious. Undergraduate education needs an equally serious redesign. Much of science and engineering teaching still revolves around lectures followed by problem sets in which students reproduce standard methods under examination conditions.

Classrooms must move quickly from "solve this equation" to "decide what should be modelled, what assumptions are defensible, what data are missing, how the answer could fail, and how you would test it in the real world". This also has implications for faculty. The availability of extraordinary intellectual tools should not lead only to faster production of conventional papers. It should enlarge the scale of problems we are willing to attack. Faculty members at India's leading institutions should ask whether research agendas designed for a pre-AI era are ambitious enough for the capabilities now becoming available. Code can be written and experiments planned far faster than before. None of this eliminates the need for scientists and engineers. It changes where their scarce human judgement should be spent: On choosing the right problem, setting constraints, recognising nonsense, designing decisive experiments and understanding consequences.

For institutions, the policy response should be deliberate. AI literacy should become part of the core training of every science and engineering student. If intellectual execution becomes cheaper and faster, then ambition, problem selection and the ability to translate ideas into reality become even more important sources of advantage. The Navier-Stokes announcement should be read less as a story about a machine competing with mathematicians and more as a warning that the intellectual baseline is moving. The correct response is neither panic nor resistance. It is to demand more from students, faculty and institutions.

The writer is visiting faculty, Department of Chemical Engineering, IIT-Bombay. Views expressed are personal

40 YEARS AGO

September 25, 1986



Congress undecided on GNLF

THE CONGRESS (I) Legislature Party meeting to decide its stand on the Gorkha National Liberation Front (GNLF) movement, in the light of the Prime Minister's recent statement that it was not anti-national, ended undecided despite a two-hour stormy session. It failed to reach a consensus even though the WBPCC (I) president, Priya Ranjan Das Munshi, made it clear that it could go ahead with its resolution describing the movement as anti-national. The party instead decided to meet on September 29 to finalise its stand on the resolution filed by six Congress (I) MLAs.

Pakistan's accusation

PAKISTAN ACCUSED India of adopting delaying tactics in discussing at the technical level its plan to construct a barrage on the Jhelum in Kashmir "in violation of the Indus Basin Treaty".

Probesought into land grab

THE DELHI Development Authority has recommended a CBI probe into the grabbing of an industrial plot worth over Rs 50 lakh, for which the lease deed and other documents had been forged. An industrial unit had been established on the plot. The DDA demolition squad demolished the structure, and took possession of the plot.

Seoul corrects India map

THE SEOUL Asian Games organising committee published a revised Indian map in the Asiad News following India's threat to pull out of the games' closing ceremony over the exclusion of Jammu and Kashmir in the map published earlier. There was no apology or expression of regret with the map which was published alongside an interview with the Indian chef-de-mission, A K Mattoo.



DIS/AGREE

THE BEST OF BOTH SIDES

A weekly column, which offers not this-versus-that, but the best of both sides, to inform the debate



ILLUSTRATION: C.R SASIKUMAR

What does the IIT-Bombay suicide tell us?

On campus, not all stress is equal



MYTHRI SUDHAKAR

A DECADE ago, Ann Druyan, wife of Carl Sagan, responded to the protests over Rohith Vemula's death with a question: "Is it possible that the attention paid to his story lessens its chronic repetition?" Ten years later, a second-year IIT Bombay student was found dead in his hostel room hours after allegedly being caught using a phone during an exam. His parents allege he had spoken of caste-based torture in the days before. The case is being investigated under the SC/ST Act and the institute's dean has been suspended pending inquiry. But the pattern of how such deaths are handled discursively and administratively deserves scrutiny independent of its outcome.

The last two months also saw four student deaths at NIT Kurukshetra, reportedly linked to debt, family discord and academic strain, not campus conduct. Both sets of deaths are absorbed into one policy response, counselling and a circular on student welfare. Indian institutions have grown fluent in wellness vocabulary yet remain illiterate in prevention, because they keep treating causes that are not uniform.

In India, hierarchy is often marked by inaccessibility. Status is partly built on how tightly bound and hard to reach a group appears. An IIT is a premier institution. Its inaccessibility makes it more respected. A faculty member is someone you need to be deferential to. In his social identity theory, Henri Tajfel argues that a part of one's self-concept is drawn from group membership — caste, alma mater, department, faculty, student bodies, all of these operate on this logic, identifying that group's stakes in one's self-worth and measuring it against others, producing ingroup favour and outgroup derogation without any material cause. Caste works through this mechanism, which is why it does not need a tragedy to enter the room. A student's caste identity travels with him from admission, sorted long before any single accusation reactivates stereotypes the institution never formally named but never dismantled either. This categorisation may partly explain why the faculty-student divide seems to be widening in the protests at IIT-Bombay.

The response to IIT-Bombay student Sahil Wakode's death shows this categorisation at work in a more careful form than a simple two-sided divide. Students have rallied around the case while explicitly stating that their protest does not condone aca-

demis misconduct. The response isn't unusual. The students are simply closing ranks against a perceived imbalance.

This is where the NIT Kurukshetra and IIT-Bombay cases diverge. The former reflects a failure of early detection in personal distress the institution did not catch in time. The latter describes something structurally different. Not a student who happened to be in distress on campus, but a student whose treatment on campus may have produced it. Filing both under mental health crisis and answering both with counselling treats the wound while leaving the causation untouched.

The diathesis-stress model, used in clinical psychology, explains why identical stressors produce different outcomes in different people. Distress results not from a stressor alone but from a stressor acting on a pre-existing vulnerability. Applied to caste, the fit is precise. Years of stereotyping, exclusion from informal networks and being read as "a quota admission" accumulate into a chronic vulnerability with no relation to ability. A disciplinary correction that a well-integrated student absorbs without much cost can, for a student already carrying that weight, confirm every prior signal that they do not belong. Faculty typically see only the exam-day infraction. They are structurally unlikely to see what it lands on. It is one reason identical infractions carry unequal psychological stakes and why the handling of an incident matters as much as the incident itself.

Let's take another example: IIT Ropar's director, popularly known as the pookie professor, wore sunglasses at a convocation at a student's request. It turned into a joyous moment that drew 27 million views online. Since then, other convocation clips have shown professors declining similar requests, which students read as rebukes. Neither response is objectively wrong. But the contrast shows how much discretion faculty hold over students and how identical requests or identical infractions are read differently depending on who is asking and how it is being handled.

None of this argues against counselling, it argues against counselling as the default answer to every campus death, since it lets institutions add a service without examining themselves. What is needed is a separation: Crisis-response systems for personal distress and independent accountability for institutional bias. Until that separation exists, each death will be folded into the same insufficient sentence that mental health support is being strengthened. Support is not the same as prevention and in matters of the mind, as in matters of the body, prevention is better than cure.

The writer is faculty, Department of Psychology, Central University of Andhra Pradesh. Views are personal

Don't make learning a test of worth



KAUSHIK DAS GUPTA

LAST WEEK, a young man who might have gone on to become an energy expert — and who knows, contributed to finding answers to some of the vexed questions on oil, fossil fuels, renewables — took his life. The circumstances surrounding his death at one of India's premier technical institutions, IIT-Bombay, are being investigated. But the sharply polarised accounts of what happened suggest that establishing the immediate cause will not answer the larger questions raised by the tragedy. In the last decade, IITs have seen over 170 deaths by suicide, a large number of them by students from SC and ST communities. What is it about these institutions and the experiences of students within them that can make them feel so isolated and overwhelmed?

Prestigious institutions are, of course, not immune to the strains, power structures, hierarchies and discriminatory practices of society at large. Students arrive from very different social backgrounds and enter a system where the pressure to excel can acquire an outsized importance. For those from marginalised communities, admission does not *ipso facto* guarantee equality. The burden can be greater still if they also have to negotiate subtle prejudice or the persistent feeling that they do not quite belong.

The immediate response to such tragedies is often to frame them as mental health crises. More counsellors, helplines, wellness centres and greater awareness of distress are all necessary. However, individualising suicidal tendencies and attributing them to personal difficulties or failure of students to cope can obscure the need for institutions to ask difficult questions of themselves, especially relevant in light of the findings of an interim report of the Supreme Court-appointed task force on student suicides, led by retired judge Justice Ravindra Bhat. The report, issued in June, noted that students often see institutional complaint mechanisms as difficult to access, ineffective, or operating in tokenistic ways. For students from marginalised communities, the barriers can be even greater: The fear of not being believed or retaliation may make them hesitant to report discrimination in the first place.

As access to higher education becomes more democratic, its growing diversity is still not adequately reflected in the com-

position of faculties. The Ravindra Bhat panel described this as a "social mismatch" between the backgrounds of a large number of students and those of their teachers. More than 65 per cent of faculty in IITs, NITs and private institutions are from non-SC, ST and OBC communities. The issue is not just about representation. A more diverse faculty can help campuses understand social differences from within, rather than leaving it to the good intentions of individual teachers. It can foster a stronger sense of belonging and ensure that students facing vulnerability find support as a matter of institutional culture.

The larger question before the country's higher education system is this: Are institutions willing to examine whether all students have the same space to enjoy the full experience of campus life — friendships, freedom and intellectual discovery — as part of the opportunities that higher education promises? It would be naïve to dissociate education from students' career ambitions. In a country with a large aspirational class, the promise of social mobility is an important part of pursuing a university degree. At the heart of academic life, however, is something more than examination grades, degrees and the job market: The process of gaining knowledge. The purpose of an institution of learning should be to intertwine the two — preparing students for their futures while allowing them to experience the curiosity that makes learning worthwhile.

But when academic performance becomes an unrelenting measure of worth, the pleasure of learning can itself be overwhelmed. A student who is constantly thinking about grades, rankings, deadlines, evaluations and the consequences of falling behind peers may have little room to follow ideas and engage deeply with what they are taught in the classroom. Today, the ease with which AI can become a shortcut to learning should also prompt institutions to ask what their systems are rewarding: The acquisition of knowledge, or simply the ability to produce the right answer under relentless pressure.

IITs and other elite institutions cannot be expected to insulate students from the vagaries of the economy. But they can decide whether those uncertainties are amplified within the classroom and campus, or whether education gives students, especially those from marginalised sections, the intellectual confidence to confront them. If learning becomes an endless endeavour to prove oneself, the promise of a better future can begin to feed the very insecurity it is meant to ease. The outcomes can be tragic.

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Javelin that landed, gifts that become public good



SUEHEL SETH

THE WEEKEND that went by began on a sharp note, quite literally. My social media feed had that one-off reel on how the Prime Minister has committed sacrilege by auctioning a javelin given by none other than Neeraj Chopra. This was interesting because it was at the intersection of a lot of topics that interest me: The Prime Minister, an auction, political counterattack and of course, sports. Digging deeper, I found some very interesting facets.

But before that, the core argument: This javelin attack landed rather poorly.

I have, over the decades, watched more than my share of powerful men and women receive gifts. Watches they will occasionally wear (even if they want to wear them much more). Statues they will never dust. There is that odd occasion where an expensive shawl is worn. Power, in most hands, is an accumulator. It collects. It hoards. It builds vitrines. We in India have seen prime ministers getting Mercedes cars as gifts, which they proudly drove on the streets of the national capital.

Narendra Modi broke that pattern before most of us were paying attention and he has kept breaking it for the better part of 25 years, which is itself a record of sorts in democracies.

Back in his Gujarat days, long before "Brand Modi" became a case study taught in business schools I occasionally lecture at, a peculiar discipline had already set in. The mementoes piled up as they do for any chief minister worth his salt and instead of vanishing into some official godown, they went under the hammer. Not metaphorically. Literally. Auctioned, sold, converted into cash, a cause he deemed worthier than his own mantlepiece — that of girl child education. Thousands of gifts were auctioned and the proceeds made their way to the Kanya Kelavani Nidhi, as they call it in Gujarat. This was the same initiative which took place in the sweltering month of June, when he and his cabinet set off to remote villages, literally pleading with parents to educate their daughters.

The communications man in me will call it an act of theatre with a conscience and I use "theatre" as the highest compliment. Another part of me will call it the highest form of *seva*.

What has happened since 2014 is that this instinct found its river. Literally. With the launch of Namami Ganga, the nation's most ambitious attempt to restore the Ganga to something resembling her old, unpolluted self, the Prime Minister's gift pile finally found a singular, sacred



destination. The shawls, the swords, the sculptures, the cricket bats signed by legends, the javelins of Olympians, the paintings from admirers who travelled great distances just to press something into his hands — all of it now finds its way to the National Gallery of Modern Art, is priced with a base as humble as Rs 200 and is bid upon by ordinary Indians who would rather own a fragment of history than a fragment of gold.

I find this extraordinary for reasons that go beyond mere optics, though heaven knows Modi understands optics better than anyone since perhaps Jawaharlal Nehru or Indira Gandhi, and I say that as someone who has studied both with equal fascination.

The first reason is discipline. Twenty-five years is not a photo opportunity. It is not a single grand gesture timed for a news cycle. It is a habit, maintained across two very different jobs, through election cycles, through the mundane churn of governance where it would have been the easiest thing in the world to quietly keep a memento or two. He didn't. He hasn't.

The second reason is what it says about the man's relationship with symbolism. A shawl gifted with reverence, sold to fund a sewage treatment plant, is not a small poetic act; it is alchemy. It takes the sentimental and makes it structural. It takes affection and turns it into infrastructure. That is not something you teach in a communications workshop. That is instinct, honed over decades of understanding that Indians do not merely want good governance; they want governance that feels like devotion.

And the third reason, the one closest to my own preoccupations as someone who has spent a lifetime studying brands, is this: It has made "Namami Ganga" not merely a scheme but a shared enterprise. When a doctor in a Tier 2 or Tier 3 city bids for a statue of Vishnu because he believes it will help clean the river his ancestors bathed in, the government has done something no advertising budget could ever buy: It has made citizenship feel personal.

Now, on this famed javelin. World over, it is very common for sporting items to be auctioned. What is the harm if it draws more youngsters to sports?

I have been critical of many things in my career and I will doubtless be critical of many more. But there is something to be said for consistency, especially in a country where consistency in public life is rarer than a Delhi winter without smog. Twenty-five years of turning gifts into good, quietly, procedurally, without fanfare is not spin. It is, dare I say it, character. The Ganga has many custodians. Few have been this literal about giving her their precious gifts.

It is truly Modi's quarter-century masterclass in *seva* and renunciation!

The writer is the managing partner of Counselage India

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Trust erosion

QUESTIONS ABOUT the ECI's functioning have been mounting for some time (Two ECs stand up to ask; CEC must answer, Supreme Court must not turn away, IE, September 24). Recent developments have only deepened concerns about the functioning of an institution meant to remain autonomous and impartial. The ECI's core responsibility is to ensure free, fair and transparent elections. Whether the issue concerns electoral rolls, EVMs or procedural transparency, its decisions must inspire clarity and public confidence. When doubts persist, they cannot simply be dismissed; they must be addressed through credible and transparent processes. Over the past few years, several petitions concerning electoral bonds, political defections, voter-list revisions and other aspects of the electoral process have reached the Supreme Court, reflecting wider concerns about institutional safeguards. The larger issue goes beyond individual irregularities. It concerns the autonomy of constitutional institutions and citizens' confidence in their right to vote. Protecting that confidence is a responsibility shared by the Election Commission, political parties and the judiciary.

Tushar Rahatgaonkar, Dombivli East

What ECI should do

THE SUGGESTIONS made by former chief election commissioner S Y Quraishi in the penultimate paragraph of his article in light of the *Indian Express* investigation are eminently sensible ('Chief Election Commissioner is not the Election Commission of India', IE, September 24). The minimum the three Election Commissioners can do is jointly address a press conference. That will contribute to restoring people's faith in the ECI.

Peter Mundackal, Dwarka

New species

THE EDITORIAL offers a fascinating revelation ('New cat in habitat, and some glimmer of hope', IE, September 24). In an era dominated by ecological gloom and extensive habitat loss, it is truly strange that entirely new species, including elusive felines and penguins, continue to be discovered to this day. While charismatic discoveries naturally capture the public imagination, equal urgency must surround the unheralded arthropods anchoring our fragile ecosystems. Celebrating these cataloguing milestones demands matching zeal to secure their vanishing homes.

Harsh Pawaria, Rohtak



ADITI NARAYANI PASWAN

TWO HORRIFIC incidents have shaken the conscience of the nation, one in Bihar's Jamui district and another in the national capital. Both reveal that behind the facade of protecting so-called "traditional value systems" is a machinery of power, control, and violence.

In Bihar, the incident involved a teenage boy and girl, who were intercepted by a mob, aggressively interrogated, and physically assaulted. The videos captured the terrifying spectacle of the young girl being touched inappropriately as the two desperately pleaded for mercy. In the Delhi case, a 17-year-old girl and her teenage friend, who were walking in a park, were confronted by three men impersonating police officers. They restrained the boy and sexually assaulted the girl. A case under the

Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act has been filed.

These are not isolated instances of spontaneous lawlessness. They are the outcomes of a society that uses the vocabulary of morality to subjugate women, police their bodies, and control their autonomy and independence.

This control over women thrives in various forms, its patterns used to systematically contain women and their bodies under the guise of protection. Instructions to young girls are built on a framework of restrictions. A girl must continuously change her daily routine, restrict her education, or monitor her friendships to avoid being targeted. True safety shouldn't work on the principle of self-regulation. It should create conditions in which a woman can occupy public space and assert her sovereignty. She should be able to catch a bus or walk down a street without having to negotiate her fundamental human dignity.

When self-appointed moral guardians

step in, as in the two cases above, they operate on the premise that a woman's presence in public, in the company of a male peer, is a violation of an unspoken boundary. According to these so-called custodians, a woman who violates this boundary has forfeited her right to safety, thus giving a passing group of men the license to humiliate, discipline, or violate her human dignity.

The Delhi survivor is 17; the Bihar student, too, is an adolescent. They are explicitly recognised as children under Indian law. The POCSO Act was brought to protect such minors from manipulation, exploitation, and violence by adults. These two crimes show the grim reality of a deeply hypocritical social imagination that treats adolescent girls as children, denying them agency by stripping them of decision-making power and dictating their clothing, while judging them through the lens of blame and regarding them as adults when they are subjected to sexual violence. It shifts the burden of an adult male's crimi-

nal behaviour onto a girl child's shoulders.

According to the National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB) data, the number of crimes against children filed under the POCSO Act rose to 1,77,335 in 2023 from 1,62,449 in 2022. Many cases may not have been registered due to institutional fear, social stigma, and the trauma of public shaming. Innumerable victims, who face this moral policing or violence, may have been rendered silent. Moral policing thrives when it can manipulate discourse and strengthen male-centric narratives.

We need an overhaul of how we raise our boys. There is a need to reimagine our families, communities, and society. The time has come to liberate women's bodies as the site of societal and cultural morality and to recognise that their rights over their bodies are inalienable, absolute and non-negotiable.

The writer is associate professor, Dr Ambedkar International Centre

TATA SONS CITED OPINIONS FROM FORMER SUPREME COURT JUDGES SRIKRISHNA, LALIT

Tata Sons row: Former SC judges back Chandra's reappointment

George Mathew
Mumbai, September 24

TWO FORMER Supreme Court judges have backed Tata Sons' position on two contentious issues surrounding N Chandrasekaran's reappointment as chairman — the validity of the September 17 board decision and the casting vote exercised by the chairman at the meeting.

The September 17 board meeting saw four Tata Sons directors vote in favour of Chandrasekaran's reappointment, while Tata Trusts Chairman Noel Tata opposed the proposal. Noel Tata subsequently wrote to Tata Sons questioning the validity of the decision and the use of the chairman's casting vote.

Tata Sons has pushed back against the objections, citing legal opinions from two former Supreme Court judges, Justice BN Srikrishna and Justice Uday U Lalit. Their opinions support the company's position on the validity of the reappointment process and the casting vote used at the board meeting.

Justice Uday U Lalit, former Chief Justice of India, said, "In

the present case, out of five Members of the Board who cast their vote on the proposal, except Noel Tata, other four Members had voted in favour of grant of Chairmanship to Chandrasekaran. Since there was equality of votes among the Directors appointment pursuant to Article 104(B), the presiding or the officiating Chairman, by putting his casting vote, satisfied the requirement under Article 121."

In his legal opinion, Justice BN Srikrishna, former Supreme Court judge, said, "In my opinion, what has been done is perfectly consonant with the letter and spirit of Article 121."

"The proceedings before the Board were not intended to be deadlocked in any event, and that is why it is necessary to read this Article in a manner so as to ensure that the proceedings before the Board and the Querist's business are taken forward and satisfactorily concluded," Srikrishna said.

"I am of the opinion that every Director has two duties — one his fiduciary to the company under the Companies Act and the other to the nominating



The September 17 board meeting saw four Tata Sons directors vote in favour of Chandrasekaran's reappointment. REUTERS

entity. There is no doubt that the former duty must override the latter in case of a conflict. That is because the former duty is statutory and the latter is only contractual. In the circumstances, Venu Srinivasan rightly acted pursuant to the statutory fiduciary duty," Srikrishna said.

"Upon there being equality of votes amongst the Directors appointed pursuant to Article 104B, there was certainly an occasion for the Chairman to have a casting vote. In my view there-

fore, the resolution dated September 17, 2026 for approving the agenda was validly passed," Lalit said. Harish Manwani who chaired the meeting after Chandrasekaran recused himself when the proposal came up, put his casting vote favouring his reappointment.

Earlier, supporting the stance of Tata Trusts, former Chief Justice of India DY Chandrudh separately provided a legal opinion saying the affirmative support of Tata Trusts'

nominee directors was required and that a chairperson's casting vote could not replace a missing majority.

According to Tata Trusts, the chairman's casting vote is available only where there is equality of votes at the overall board level. "It does not apply among Tata Trusts' Nominee Directors. Whether the result of the vote was 4:1, or any other figure, is irrelevant. A condition is either met, or it is not. In this case the condition was not met," it said.

"AoA (Articles of Association) of Tata Sons do not leave any decision of the board to a mere head count of Directors. They provide that no decision can be taken unless it has the affirmative support of at least a majority of the Directors nominated by the Tata Trusts, who hold approximately 66% of the company. This is a separate condition under the AoA," Tata Trusts said.

A decision on reappointment will emerge only in the annual general meeting of Tata Sons which is expected in the coming weeks. FULL REPORT ON [WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM](#)

Fear of shift to cash due to merchant fee on UPI '100% misplaced': Govt sources

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, September 24

FEARS OF the public shifting to cash because of the merchant fee on UPI transactions of more than Rs 2,000 are "100% misplaced", government sources said on Thursday, arguing that a Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) already exists on credit and debit cards other than RuPay debit cards and "no one is giving them up". "How long can someone provide a service for free? We would be killing our golden goose!" an official said, requesting anonymity.

"Merchants have always absorbed the MDR on credit cards. But people are still getting Visa, Mastercard, and Amex cards. Why is it that suddenly UPI, an indigenous product that has done so well, is something that merchants can't pay for when they are paying for all other methods?"

The merchant fee on debit and credit cards is significantly higher than what has been proposed on UPI and is broadly in the range of 1-3%.

On the subject of a Goods and Services Tax (GST) of 18% applying on the MDR on person-to-merchant UPI payments, the official said it was hoped that the GST Council "will take a favourable and be reasonable".

The GST Council is scheduled to meet on October 7. The merchant fee on person-to-mer-

chant UPI transactions of more than Rs 2,000 will begin from October 15. The GST Council is not expected to discuss the indirect tax rate on MDR.

The National Payments Corporation of India's (NPCI) decision that a 0.4% fee will apply on merchants on UPI payments of over Rs 2,000 has led to concerns that shopkeepers will stop accepting UPI as a mode of payment. Consumers, meanwhile, think sellers will pass on the fee to them and increase prices.

Only 4% of person-to-merchant UPI transactions are for more than Rs 2,000 and will attract a merchant fee. However, this small number of payments account for two-thirds of person-to-merchant UPI payments when they are measured in value terms. All person-to-person UPI payments will remain without any MDR. Payments made via RuPay debit cards, even those of more than Rs 2,000, will attract no MDR.

Authorities have repeatedly said they will look to ensure that merchants don't pass on the fee to consumers, with sources saying on Thursday that the government is willing to talk with the Indian Banks' Association (IBA) to set up a mechanism through which it can be monitored if shopkeepers are passing on the MDR to buyers.

Sources also said the government will speak to traders, including the Confederation of

75% of merchants insulated from fee on UPI: NPCI CEO

Mumbai: Around three-fourths of India's merchants accepting digital payments have never recorded a UPI transaction of more than Rs 2,000. As a result, they will remain insulated from the newly introduced MDR, NPCI managing director and chief executive officer Dilip Asbe said on Thursday.

Speaking at the SBI Banking and Economics Conclave, Asbe said the objective of introducing MDR was not to fully recover the cost of running UPI, but to generate enough revenue for banks and payment companies to continue investing in the ecosystem.

"While we cannot fully recover the cost, at least reasonably recover, so that it kind of incentivises market players to reinvest back and grow UPI," Asbe said. FE

All India Traders (CAIT), about the issue.

The MDR, which is paid by sellers, is to be split between payments industry players, which includes banks, payment gateways, UPI apps, and other service providers. FULL REPORT ON [WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM](#)

NSE makes market debut at 1% premium, extends listing gains

Akash Mandal
Mumbai, September 24

THE NATIONAL Stock Exchange (NSE) made its historic market debut on Thursday, with its shares listing at Rs 1,800 apiece — an around 1% premium over its IPO price of Rs 1,785. Analysts had expected the shares to list at a 4-5% premium, based on their performance in the unlisted market over the past few days.

The stock gained further on listing, ending the session at Rs 1,818, up 1% from its listing price, even as the overall market slumped nearly 2%. In fact, the stock had gained as much as 4.3% from its listing price intraday, before paring back some gains.

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some gains.

"Finally, the day we were all waiting for has arrived. NSE does not belong just to its shareholders, directors, and employees. It belongs to the entire nation," said Srinivas Injeti, Chairperson of the stock exchange at its IPO press conference on Thursday. Despite the challenging market conditions, the exchange swiftly launched its public issue after clearing regulatory challenges due to its focus on "inherent value" instead of "market valuation," he added.

The exchange listed with a market capitalisation of Rs 4.45 lakh crore, significantly higher than BSE's current market-cap of Rs 1.33 lakh crore. While listing-day gains remained relatively muted, the stock's performance in the near-to-medium term also depends on the additional equity that may be available to trade once the lock-in period for current shareholders ends, an analyst at a domestic brokerage said.

According to current regulations, pre-IPO shareholders are not allowed to sell their shares for a period between 6-18 months after the public issue to protect investor interests. Notably, the NSE had reduced its issue size as many selling shareholders decided to hold onto their shares due to lower-than-expected valuations and growth potential post-listing.

Only about 5% of the exchange was sold during the IPO, with a large portion of it being lapped up by institutional and anchor investors, currently leaving a very slim portion to be freely traded in the open market at the moment.

While NSE's shares got listed on the BSE, they were also admitted into the Metropolitan Stock Exchange of India (MSEI) through the 'permitted to trade' category. This category allows investors to trade a stock on a particular exchange without listing on it.

FULL REPORT ON [WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM](#)

Adani plans to invest Rs 1 lakh cr in Bengal



West Bengal Chief Minister Suvenudh Adhikari with Adani Group Chairman Gautam Adani.

ENS Economic Bureau
Mumbai, September 24

ADANI GROUP has announced an investment roadmap of more than Rs 1.3 lakh crore in West Bengal by 2035, marking an expansion of its footprint in the eastern state across infrastructure, energy, logistics, healthcare, and digital infrastructure.

The announcement by the group Chairman Gautam Adani came in Kolkata on Thursday, alongside the foundation stone-

laying for the group's flagship healthcare project in the state — the 2,000-bed Adani Arogya Mandir at the Bengal Silicon Valley Tech Hub in New Town.

"We expect to invest in Bengal over Rs 1 lakh crore by 2035 — in sectors spanning ports, logistics, power generation, power transmission and distribution, roads, bridges and ropeways, green cement, and hyperscale data centres," Adani said.

FULL REPORT ON [WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM](#)

SEBI changes settlement rules, clears common advertising code

Akash Mandal
Mumbai, September 24

THE SECURITIES and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) on Thursday announced changes to its settlement proceedings framework, introducing a new formula to calculate settlement amounts and simplifying the process for entities seeking to settle proceedings, subject to specified thresholds. The regulator also approved a common advertising code for regulated entities and announced other measures aimed at reducing the compliance burden.

The changes were announced at a press conference following SEBI's board meeting in Mumbai on Thursday.

Under the revised framework, settlement terms will comprise a settlement amount, disgorgement of wrongful gains, where applicable, and remedial and regulatory terms, the regulator said. SEBI has also separated "wrongful gains" from the calculation of the base amount, following concerns over "double counting" that could increase penalties.

The new regulations will come into force the day after 30 days from the date of their notification. SEBI will also issue a settlement notice to entities under investigation before issuing a show-cause notice, giving them 60 days to file a settlement application. FULL REPORT ON [WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM](#)

'Domestic chip mandate for smart meters by mid-2028'

Pratyush Deep
New Delhi, September 24

THE GOVERNMENT plans to mandate the use of domestically designed chips in smart meters by mid-2028 to address cybersecurity-related issues, Power Secretary Pankaj Agarwal said while speaking at the 2nd Indian Power Sector Conference organised by industry body FICCI.

Expressing concern over cybersecurity risks associated with smart meters, Agarwal sought domestic designing and manufacturing of the chips used in these meters. "Actually, some of the chip developers and also the smart meter manufacturers are actively engaged. Some chips are already being designed or are in the process of design. They need to test those chips. And as and when they are able to validate their chips, they will go for the commercial production of the chips. So, it's not going to take very long," Agarwal told reporters on the sidelines of the event.

He said he was hopeful that by mid-2028, the government could mandate "design in India chip" and maybe even "make in

India" chip in the system. Currently, a smart meter chip costs between \$8 and \$10 apiece, he said. "We have already issued, I think, the Make in India requirement for the mandating design in India chips for the smart meters, including fabricated in India chips for the smart meters with the same timeline," he added.

However, he maintained that there is no need for a separate incentive for domestically designed chips as government procurement will ensure that they have an assured market.

Under the Revamped Distribution Sector Scheme, smart metering works for 19.79 crore consumers, 52.53 lakh Distribution Transformers and 2.05 lakh feeders, totalling 20.33 crore smart meters, have been sanctioned based on proposals submitted by states and distribution utilities. Till date, 5.73 crore smart meters have been installed under the scheme, government data shows. In addition, smart meters have been installed by states under their state plans and other schemes. FULL REPORT ON [WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM](#)

• BRIEFLY

Maruti starts green hydrogen plant at Manesar

New Delhi: Car maker Maruti Suzuki India Limited on Thursday announced the commissioning of 300 kW green hydrogen electrolyzer plant, set up as a pilot, at its Manesar facility in Haryana. Speaking on the pilot initiative, Maruti Suzuki India MD & CEO Hisashi Takeuchi said that through multiple clean technologies, the company aspires to reduce its carbon footprint in manufacturing operations from the present 6,15,000 tonnes to 2,66,000 tonnes in FY 2030-31. PTI

CEA calls for export-focused indigenisation

New Delhi: India should pursue indigenisation that maintains global export competitiveness rather than isolated protectionism, Chief Economic Adviser V Anantha Nageswaran said on Thursday. Addressing the SBI Banking & Economics Conclave in Mumbai, he said India should build physical buffers for key commodities, such as maintaining at least six months of oil storage and focus on irreplaceable small components in global production chains, he added. FE

• MARKETS

Sensex 73,580.54 -1,247.71 -1.67%	NIFTY 23,063.10 -383.70 -1.64%	Gold ▼ ₹1,50,785	US Dollar ▲ ₹95.96
		Silver ▼ ₹2,28,248	Oil ▲ \$117.65

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION DATA. GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF SEPTEMBER 23, 2026

• BENGALURU-BASED NAGENDRA NAGARAJA OF QPIAI BECAME INDIA'S FIRST QUANTUM-COMPUTING ENTRANT ON THE LIST, WITH WEALTH OF Rs 1,700 CRORE

AI debuts in India's richest, 19 people worth Rs 3 lakh cr

ENS Economic Bureau
Mumbai, September 24

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE (AI) is not just changing how businesses operate, but also creating new pools of wealth among entrepreneurs. The shift is beginning to show up in India's wealth rankings, with AI making its debut as a standalone industry in the M3M Hurun India Rich List 2026, with 19 individuals worth a combined Rs 3.07 lakh crore, including 15 new entrants.

The average wealth of a new AI entrant is around Rs 12,100 crore — nearly five times that of a new entrant in Industrial Products, according to the report. Industrial Products refers to traditional manufacturing and heavy-industry businesses. From CTRL S Datacentres

and Yotta to Astera Labs, Sarvam AI and Perplexity, Indian entrepreneurs are building across data centres, chips, models and applications. The country's AI wealth is emerging across the technology stack, the report said. Meanwhile, the rise of new-age wealth has not displaced India's traditional business fortunes, with Gautam Adani and family reclaiming the top spot from Mukesh Ambani and family.

Bengaluru-based Nagendra Nagaraja of QpiAI became India's first quantum-computing entrant on the list, with wealth of Rs 1,700 crore. Tanay Kothari and Sahaj Garg, both 28, made their debut with AI company Wispr Flow, each with wealth of Rs 4,200 crore.

The National Quantum Mission is the country's Rs

6,003.65-crore initiative approved in 2023 to strengthen quantum technology research and industry. The programme has so far supported 17 startups — including nine deep-tech ventures — among them QpiAI, which launched a 25-qubit quantum computer in 2025.

Notably, the broader deep-tech story is equally significant. AI, Aerospace & Defence and Semiconductors together account for 48 individuals worth Rs 4.26 lakh crore — 30 are new this year. "Pawan Kumar Chandana of Skyroot Aerospace enters through space launch, while Nagendra Nagaraja of QpiAI becomes the list's first quantum-computing entrant, at Rs 1,700 crore. These businesses demand patient capital, engineering depth and years of devel-



Individuals with wealth of at least Rs 1,000 crore rose to 1,810, an increase of 128 from last year. REUTERS

opment. The ambition for India to own foundational technology is beginning to show up in the wealth data," said Anas Rahman Junaid, Founder and Chief Re-

searcher, Hurun India.

Sridhar Pinnapureddy & family of CTRL S Datacentres had a wealth of Rs 46,100 crore, followed by Darshan Hiranandani of Yotta with Rs 37,900 crore. As digital services and AI expand, computing power and data storage demand is rising sharply, making data centres key for infrastructure needed to support these services. But there's a catch to the AI wealth story: 13 of the 19 AI names on the list are based outside India. "That speaks to the global reach of Indian talent and raises an important question about where the next generation of businesses will be built," said the founder.

Adani family saw their wealth rise 13% to Rs 9.23 lakh crore (\$96 billion), while Ambani, 69, and family saw their



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**UP INTERNATIONAL
TRADE SHOW**

**25TH-29TH
SEPTEMBER, 2026** **4TH
EDITION**
INDIA EXPO CENTRE & MART, GREATER NOIDA



by

Amit Shah

Minister, Home Affairs and Cooperation,
Government of India

Yogi Adityanath

Chief Minister,
Uttar Pradesh

In the august presence of

Brajesh Pathak

Deputy Chief Minister,
Uttar Pradesh

Nand Gopal Gupta 'Nandi'

Minister, Industrial Development, Export Promotion,
NRI & Investment Promotion, Uttar Pradesh

Bhupendra Chaudhary

Minister, Micro, Small & Medium
Enterprises, Uttar Pradesh

Brajesh Singh

Minister of State, Public Works Department, Uttar Pradesh

Hans Raj Vishwakarma

Minister of State, Micro, Small & Medium Enterprises, Uttar Pradesh

Surendra Singh Nagar

Member, Rajya Sabha

Dr. Mahesh Sharma

MP, Gautam Buddha Nagar

Amit Chaudhary

Administrator, District Panchayat,
Gautam Buddha Nagar

Shrichand Sharma

MLC

Narendra Singh Bhati

MLC

Pankaj Singh

MLA, Noida

Tejpal Singh Nagar

MLA, Dadri

Dhirendra Singh

MLA, Jewar

and other dignitaries

Date: 25th September, 2026 | **Time:** 11:00 AM | **Venue:** India Expo Centre & Mart, Greater Noida

Business Hours: 11:00 AM-3:00 PM | **Visiting Hours:** 3:00 PM-8:00 PM

Key Highlights

Global Marketplace for Trade,
Investment & Innovation

Knowledge Sessions - Collaboration, innovation & global knowledge exchange | **Business Platform** - Connecting exhibitors, entrepreneurs and exporters across sectors including IT & Electronics, EV, Agriculture, ODOP, ODOC, Startups, Education, Food Processing, Health & Family Welfare, AYUSH, Tourism, Textiles and Leather | **Exhibition** - Showcasing UP's products, enterprises, and emerging brands to a global audience | **Global Recognition** - Celebrating MSMEs, exporters & traditional artisans | **UP Heritage** - Crafts, cuisine, textiles & cultural richness | **Cultural Performances** - Folk traditions, talent & creativity | **Awards** - Honouring excellence, innovation and outstanding contributions

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New Delhi

Vikas Ki Gati Apaar
Double Engine Sarkar



AMITY UNIVERSITY - SPORTS MEET

"Sangathan-2026", the 27th Inter Amity Institutions Sports Meet, was inaugurated at Amity University Uttar Pradesh, Noida, with great enthusiasm. Students from Amity campuses across India and abroad will participate in around 18 sports, including hockey, football, cricket, tennis, badminton, basketball, volleyball, table tennis, chess, swimming, yoga and karate. The month-long event will culminate with Founder's Day, commemorating the birthday of Dr. Ashok K. Chauhan, Founder President, Amity Education Group. The inauguration featured the lighting and relay of the "Sangathan Mashaal", flag hoisting, March Past and the participants' oath. Dr. Atul Chauhan, Chancellor, Amity University, highlighted Sangathan's role in fostering friendship, unity, sportsmanship, discipline and teamwork. Other dignitaries emphasized the importance of sports in developing leadership, resilience, teamwork and holistic growth.



KIET UNIVERSITY - CONCLAVE

The Ghaziabad Management Association (GMA), in association with KIET School of Management, KIET Deemed to be University, organized a National HR Conclave on September 12, 2026, themed "The Workforce Renaissance: Shaping Resilient, Futuristic and Sustainable Organisations." The conclave brought together industry leaders, HR professionals, academicians and management experts to discuss emerging workforce trends. Sessions focused on Industry 5.0 and human-centric transformation, AI-driven digital transformation, labour codes and the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, and sustainability. Eminent speakers, including Mr. Atul Sobti and Dr. Indarjit Ghosh, shared valuable insights on the evolving role of HR and future workforce priorities.



HRIT UNIVERSITY - ACHIEVEMENT

HRIT University's NCC cadet Kartik Sharma has brought laurels to the institution by securing First Position Overall in the prestigious IGC Drone Competition 2026, held near Kanpur Air Force Station from 8-18 September. Representing 37 BN UP NCC and the Ghaziabad Group team, Kartik was the sole participant from HRIT University. The competition featured Written Test, Drone Assembly, Flying, Idea & Innovation, and Viva rounds. Kartik demonstrated exceptional technical knowledge and discipline, contributing actively to drone assembly, calibration, written examination and viva. The Ghaziabad Group team of 10 cadets secured First Position. HRIT University's commitment to emerging drone and UAV technologies.

CORPORATE BRIEFS

EDUCATION



GLBITM - ORIENTATION

GL Bajaj Institute of Technology & Management successfully conducted PARICHAY 2026, its 21st Orientation Programme for MBA Batch 2026-28, on September 16-17 at SHD Hall, Academic Block 1. Held under the theme "FIND YOUR SPARK," the programme introduced students to leadership, innovation, professional growth and digital transformation. Dr. Deepak Vohra, associated with I GAUGE, and Mr. C.K. Sabharwal, Former Managing Director, ISK Biosciences, shared valuable industry and global perspectives. A key highlight was the panel discussion, "Future Ready Managers: Leadership, Innovation and Digital Transformation," featuring industry experts. The two-day programme encouraged students to develop confidence, adaptability and leadership.



SUSHANT UNIVERSITY - INTERNATIONAL CONFERENCE

The School of Design, Sushant University, hosted ICDC 2026 - International Conference on Design Consciousness, themed "Social Design: Bridging Gaps, Building Futures." The conference brought together academicians, researchers, designers and industry professionals to explore inclusive, sustainable and socially responsible design. Held under the leadership of Dr. Rakesh Ranjan, Vice Chancellor, and Dr. Sanjiv Kumar Sharma, Pro Vice Chancellor, with Dr. Koshalpreet Kaur, Dean, School of Design, as Conference Chair, the event featured expert discussions spanning architecture, design, urban development and creative practice. Thirty research contributions were published in an ISBN-bearing volume by Integrity Education India, strengthening the University's commitment to research-led design education.



AKGEC - ANTI RAGGING CAMPAIGN

Ajay Kumar Garg Engineering College (AKGEC) organized an Anti-Ragging Campaign and Tree Plantation Drive on September 18, 2026, to promote awareness against ragging and encourage environmental responsibility. The "Kite Flying Anti-Ragging and Tree Plantation Drive" commenced at 2:00 pm at the college football ground in the presence of Director Dr. Hemant Ahuja and senior faculty members. Around 2,000 students and 300 faculty and staff participated enthusiastically, making the event a grand success. The college also planned a three-week Induction Programme for first-year students and a fresher party. Such initiatives aim to strengthen anti-ragging values.



AICE - FELICITATION CEREMONY

Amity Institute for Competitive Examinations (AICE) organised a Felicitation Ceremony to honour student achievers for outstanding performances in NEET, JEE Advanced, Olympiads and Maths Test Series. Chief Guest Dr. Himani Ahluwalia, Director, Lady Hardinge Medical College, encouraged students to pursue research, innovation and lifelong learning. Dr. Amita Chauhan, Chairperson, Amity Group of Schools, highlighted dedication, hard work and positive behaviour while Prof. (Dr.) Smriti Srivastava, Dean Academics, NSUT, stressed analytical thinking, innovation and practical knowledge. Dr. Ashok K. Chauhan, Founder President, Amity Education Group, emphasised perseverance, discipline, creativity and continuous learning. Padma Shri Prof. (Dr.) Y.S. Rajan and Dr. W. Selvamurthy also inspired students to pursue excellence. Alumni were felicitated for their achievements and contributions.



GALGOTIAS UNIVERSITY - ARCHERY CAMP

The Vietnam National Archery Team conducted a three-week training camp at Galgotias University from September 1-20, 2026, as part of its Asian Games preparations. The contingent included five archers and two coaches, adding an international dimension to the University's growing sporting ecosystem. Galgotias University has previously hosted India's National Coaching Camp for Men's and Women's Lacrosse Teams. Its students have also excelled internationally, winning five Gold Medals at the inaugural World Yogasana Championship 2026 in Ahmedabad. Dr. Dhruv Galgotia, CEO, welcomed the Vietnamese team and highlighted the University's commitment to high-performance sports, athlete development, international engagement and providing students opportunities to excel in academics and sports.



GGSIPU - MoU

Guru Gobind Singh Indraprastha University, New Delhi, and William Paterson University (WPU), USA, signed an MoU to strengthen academic, student mobility and research collaboration. Signed by WPU President Dr. Richard J. Helldobler and GGSIPU Registrar Dr. Kamal Pathak, the agreement includes UG 2+2 and Graduate 1+1 pathways, student and faculty exchanges, professional development, joint research and academic activities. GGSIPU Vice Chancellor Prof. Mahesh Verma highlighted opportunities in sustainability, climate change, biotechnology, management, pharmacy and law. The MoU will advance internationalisation, knowledge exchange, research and capacity building.

उ० प्र० पावर ट्रॉसमिशन कार्पोरेशन लि०, विद्युत पारेषण मण्डल आगरा जैम निविदा / ई निविदा सूचना दिनांक 24.09.2026 निविदा संख्या एवं कार्य का संक्षिप्त विवरण निविदा संख्या टी-46/वि.पा.म. (आ.) / 2026-27 / जैम बिड संख्या GEM/2026/B/8067877 विद्युत पारेषण खण्ड तृतीय आगरा पर (O&M मद के तहत) विभिन्न उपकेन्द्रों पर 150 वॉट एल.ई.डी. स्ट्रीट/फ्लड लाइट व 250 वॉट हाईमॉस्ट एल.ई.डी. फ्लड लाइट की आपूर्ति हेतु निविदा की अन्तिम तिथि 03.10.2026 समय 15.00 बजे। 2. निविदा संख्या टी-47/वि.पा.म. (आ.)/2026-27/ जैम बिड संख्या GEM/2026/B/ 8072601 विद्युत पारेषण खण्ड-द्वितीय आगरा के क्षेत्रान्तर्गत (O&M मद के तहत) 220 के.वी. उपकेन्द्र सिकन्दरा आगरा पर 245 के.वी. एवं 145 के.वी. आर्म आइसुलेटर एवं मेल-फ्रीमेल कॉन्टैक्टर की आपूर्ति हेतु निविदा की अन्तिम तिथि 08.10.2026 समय 15.00 बजे। 3. ई-निविदा संख्या टी-48/वि.पा.म. (आ.) / 2026-27: विद्युत पारेषण खण्ड-द्वितीय आगरा के क्षेत्रान्तर्गत (REC मद के तहत) 220 के.वी. उपकेन्द्र सिकन्दरा आगरा पर 245 के.वी. बस कप्लर "बे" का निर्माण सम्बन्धी कार्य हेतु निविदा प्रपत्र शुल्क रू० 1770.00 (जी.एस.टी. सहित) एवं धरोहर धनराशि रू० 40,000.00 मात्र निविदा की अन्तिम तिथि 21.10.2026 समय 12.00 बजे। विस्तृत जानकारी एवं प्रपत्र जैम पोर्टल की वेबसाइट www.gem.gov.in एवं ई-टेंडर की वेबसाइट www.etender.up.nic.in पर उपलब्ध है। अग्रेतर समस्त सूचनाएँ वेबसाइट पर ही प्रदर्शित की जायेगी। हस्ता./-अधीक्षक अभियन्ता, विद्युत पारेषण मण्डल, आगरा "राष्ट्र हित में बिजली बचाये" पत्रांक 2945/विपाम (आ.) / निविदा संख्या टी- 46 /GEM/2026 /B/8067877, निविदा संख्या टी- 47 /GEM/2026/B/8072601, निविदा संख्या टी- 48 /निविदा संख्या टी- 48 / वि.पा.म. (आ.)/2026-27 दिनांक: 24.09.2026

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NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER-Retender
ONLINE C-Type Re-Tender is invited from eligible contractors for Construction of Sale Building No. S-34 at Turbhe-Mandale, Mankhurd, Mumbai.
For detailed Tender Notice, Tender Documents, eligibility criteria, EMD, important date and other details, please visit the Maharashtra Government e-Tendering Portal (www.mahatenders.gov.in)
Sd/-
(Lahuraj Mali, IAS)
Managing Director
Shivshahi Punarvasan Prakalp Limited
DGIPR-2026-27/2997

SANGANER ENVIRO PROJECT DEVELOPMENT
Address : CETP Plant, Near Datar Shikhar, Datar II Road, Mahana Road, Matampura, Sangner, Jaipur-302029, Rajasthan.
PH: +91 8003092564, Email: sapdgp@gmail.com
Request for Expression of Interest Appointment of Operation & Management
Agency for Textile ZLD CETP in Sangner
Sanganer Enviro Project Development, an SPV has set up a 12.3 MLD CETP with ZLD for textile processing units located in Sangner, Rajasthan. The project is funded under IPO Scheme of Ministry of Textiles (MOT), Govt. of India (GoI) (scheme guidelines available at <http://ministryoftextiles.gov.in/schemes>)
The SPV desires to appoint an Operation & Management Agency (OMA) for operating 12.3 MLD ZLD CETP project. O&M Agency is to be appointed for the following inter alia scope of services:
i. Providing end-to-end operation team for the collection, treatment of textile effluent and recirculated the treated water as per design.
ii. To undertake day to day maintenance and upgradation of Plant
iii. Management of disposal of reject.
iv. To monitor efficient operation of the project and submit periodical performance reports as per the CTO and other terms and conditions.
v. To liaise with State Government to resolve State related problems
Service Providers having similar experience of Waste Water / textile effluent treatment / ZLD projects will be an added advantage. The EOIs are to be submitted through mail or hand delivery on or before DI. 28.9.2026 by 1600 hours at our office Sanganer Enviro Project Development, Sangner, Raj, India.
Praveen Shah, Director
Sanganer Enviro Project Development
Jaipur, Rajasthan (SEPD)

S. E. RAILWAY - TENDER
For and behalf of president of India invite Adra S.E.Railway following work.
Tender No. M/716/ Welding/ BKSC/Det. Est. 26, dated: 14.07.2026.
DRM (Mech)/ADA invites e-tender for the work Outsourcing for "Wagon body panel patching, Body bulge out repair, Door channel and floor channel repair, Cross bar repair, etc. of ROH due wagons at ROH depot, BKSC for a period of 01 year" vide E-Tender No. M-716-Welding-BKSC-2026, Closing date: 15.10.2026. Departmental Value-Rs. 1,48,47,481.72 (Rupees one crore forty eight lakhs forty seven thousand four hundred eighty one and seventy two paise) only including GST @ 18%. The closing date and time of e-tender is on 15.10.2026 at 15.00 hrs. and opening of tender will be done on 15.10.2026 after 15.00 hrs. Details of e-tender may please be seen at website www.ireps.gov.in. (PR -804)

NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY
Open Tender Notice No. : NER-BSB0SnT-OT-52-2026,
"Open Tenders" through Online (E-Tendering) are invited by Divisional Railway Manager (Signal & Telecom) / Varanasi/N.E. Railway for and behalf of the President of India for the following works:
SN 1:- Tender Notice No. and Description of Work: **NER-BSB0SnT-OT-52-2026:** Name of Work:- Replacement of coach guidance system at Deoria Sadar & Siwan Jn stations of Varanasi division. Detail:- Approx. Value Rs. ₹ 32827149.96, Earnest Money: Rs. ₹ 656600.00/- Cost of Tender Form: 0.00, Completion period: 270 Days, Tender Closing date & Time: 14.10.2026 upto 15.00 hrs.
1. Tender Online will be submitted up to 15:00 hrs on date 14.10.2026.
2. For full details and submission of bid kindly visit the Official website of Indian railways i.e. www.ireps.gov.in.
Divl. Rly. Manager (S&T) Varanasi
CPR0/Sig-119
Never travel on roof and foot boards.

TRANSMISSION CORPORATION OF ANDHRA PRADESH LIMITED
(A Government of Andhra Pradesh Under taking & an ISO 27001-2022 Certified Company)
e - PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE
The APTRANSCO invites bids online for Spec No. PMMTC3-e-46/2026, **Work:** "Supply, installation, testing and commissioning of 80 Nos Apple Mac Laptops for officers in APTRANSCO", Date & Time of availability of Tender: **25.09.2026 at 18:00 PM, Web:** <http://tender.apecprocurement.gov.in>
R.O.No.GMCC/APTRANSCO/157/26-27 Sd/- CHIEF ENGINEER , TELECOM & IT

STORES E-PROCUREMENT
E-tenders are invited by the undersigned for the following work:
1. E-Tender No.: DB265636, **Dated:** 21-09-2026; **Item Description:** Articulated Spherulastic Rubber Bearing (Silent Block) as per ESCORT Drawing No. SK-1532 for ESCORT Make AAR-H Tight Lock Coupler for LHB Coaches and Confirming to RDSO Specification No.-RDSO/2011/CG-03 (Rev.01) **MAKE :ESCORTS KUBOTA LIMITED-FARIDABAD (PAC Item).** Make-GMT/TVS; **PL No.:** 331302980017, **Consignee:** SSE/CLS/DBVVS, NFR (Assam), **Qty:** 192.00 Numbers; **Earnest Money:** ₹1,45,460/- **Closing of E-tender:** at 11:30 hrs. on 12-10-2026.
For details please visit <https://ireps.gov.in>.
Deputy Chief Material Manager/Dibrugarh
NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY
"Serving Customers with a smile"

The Andhra Pradesh Mineral Development Corporation Limited
Door No. 294/1D, 100 feet Road (Tadigadapa to Enikepadu Road), Kanuru, Vijayawada-521137, Andhra Pradesh, India
Tel: +91-866-2429999 Fax: +91-866-2429977
Email: contracts-ho@apmdc.in

SHORT TERM E-TENDER
Tender No: APMDC/HO/P&C/Excavation and removal of overburden and Barytes (ROM) ore -M/Pet/2026-27/11 Date: 25.09.2026
APMDC invites E-tender from reputed Agencies for "Selection Of Contractor For Excavation And Removal Of Overburden And Barytes (ROM) Ore At Mangampet Barytes Project, Mangampeta (V), Obulavaripalli (M), Tirupati District, Andhra Pradesh". For more information on the eligibility criteria, tender fees, timelines and other details, please visit e-procurement website of GoAP www.tender.apecprocurement.gov.in or APMDC website (www.apmdc.ap.gov.in). The Tender document is available for downloading from 25.09.2026 and the last date for bid submission is 12.10.2026 by 17:00 Hrs.
Sd/- Managing Director
Place: Vijayawada Date: 25.09.2026
The A. P. Mineral Development Corporation Limited
No: 5458PP/CL/ADVT/11/2021-22, Dt: 24/09/2026

RESERVE BANK OF INDIA
PUBLIC NOTICE
MSJ COLONISING AND LEASING COMPANY PRIVATE LIMITED having its registered office at Room No.101, First Floor, M.S.J House, 17/1, South Tukoganj, Indore, Madhya Pradesh, India, 452001 has by its letter dated June 05, 2026, voluntarily surrendered the certificate of registration (CoR) and requested the Reserve Bank of India to cancel the CoR issued to it under section 45-IA of the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934.
In exercise of powers conferred under Section 45-IA(6) of the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934 (the Act), the Reserve Bank of India, by its order dated September 16, 2026, has cancelled the CoR No. 03.00066 dated March 19, 2020, issued to **MSJ COLONISING AND LEASING COMPANY PRIVATE LIMITED** (CIN-U45201MP1984PTC002634), for carrying on the business of a Non-Banking Financial Institution as defined in Section 45-(a) of the Act. The company therefore cannot carry on the business of a Non-Banking Financial Institution under the Act. This is issued in public interest.
Place: Nagpur Regional Director

Paschim Gujarat Vij Company Ltd.
CIN: U40102GJ2003SGC042908
Regd. & Corporate Office, Laxminagar, Nana Mava main road, RAJKOT-360004, GUJARAT

E-Tender Notice :212
PGVCL invites request for bids for Site Survey, Designing, Engineering, Procurement, Supply, Loading, Transportation, Unloading, Insurance, Delivery at Site, Handling, Storage, Installation, Testing, Commissioning Including Documentation of All Items/Material required to complete works for Turnkey Based Contract For Conversion of Existing 11 kV HT Line and LT Line Network Including Consumer Service Lines Into Under Ground Cable Network With Ring Main System at Barwala Subdivision of Botad Circle Under PGVCL with GIS Mapping / Geo Urja Mapping (Developed by GUVNL) and Asset Tagging under SI Scheme (Package-69), This is put up on on-line (e-Tender) website <https://tender.nprocure.com>. Interested bidders are requested to submit the tender online. The Tender document for view and download is also available on our website www.pgvcl.com. In future, if any amendment/s will be required for this tender, same will be uploaded only on above websites.
"Use Solar Energy-Green Energy"
Date:- 24.09.2026 Ic Chief Engineer (Project and R & C)

HFCL LIMITED
CIN: L64200HR1987PLC148689
Regd. Office: Plot No. 38, Institutional Area, Sector 32, Gurugram - 122 001 (Haryana)
Phone No.: +91-124-4310000; Fax No.: +91-124-4310050
Website: www.hfcl.com; Email: secretarial@hfcl.com

NOTICE
Special Window for Re-lodgement of Physical Share Transfer Requests
Notice is hereby given that the Securities and Exchange Board of India ("SEBI") vide Circular no. SEBI/HO/MIRSD/MIRSD-PoD/PI/CIR/2025/97 dated July 02, 2025 ("SEBI Circular"), had introduced a Special Window for re-lodgement of transfer requests of physical shares. Pursuant to the SEBI Circular, the shareholders who had submitted transfer requests for physical shares before April 01, 2019 and whose requests were rejected or returned due to documentation/process deficiencies were provided with an opportunity to re-lodge such rejected transfer requests with valid documents from July 07, 2025 to January 06, 2026. In order to further facilitate the investors to get rightful access to their securities, the SEBI has decided to open another special window for transfer and dematerialisation ("demat") of physical securities which were sold/purchased prior to April 01, 2019. SEBI, now vide its Circular No. HO/38/13/11(2)2026-MIRSD-PoD/1/3750/2026 dated January 30, 2026, has extended this special window for a further period of one year, from **February 05, 2026 to February 04, 2027**.
Eligible shareholders who wish to avail this opportunity may submit the transfer request along with requisite documents to the Company's Registrar and Transfer Agent, whose address is mentioned below, within the abovementioned period (**February 05, 2026 to February 04, 2027**):
MCS Share Transfer Agent Ltd
Address: 179-180, DSIDC Shed, 3rd Floor, Okhla Industrial Area, Phase-I, New Delhi-110020.
Tel: 011-41406149-52
Email: admin@mcsregistrars.com
Website: www.mcsregistrars.com
The securities so transferred shall be mandatorily credited to the transferee only in demat mode and shall be under lock-in for a period of one year from the date of registration of transfer. Such securities shall not be transferred/lien-marked/pledged during the said lock-in period.
For HFCL Limited
Sd/-
(Manoj Baid)
President & Company Secretary
Place : New Delhi
Date : September 24, 2026

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I, Tehmina Riaz, W/o Naved Aslam, D/o Riaz Ul Haq Ansari, R/o -45/1, Street No.17, Main Road, Brahmampuri, Delhi-110053, have changed my name, Tehmina Naved to Tehmina Riaz for all purposes

0040880236-2

I, Mansha w/o Amit Marwah r/o C-34/2, Clock Tower, Hari Nagar, Delhi-110064 have changed my name to MANSHA MARWAH.

0040880121-1

I, KUMARI RASHMI RANI W/o Prem Lal Choudhary, 4/391, Street-No-12, Bhola Nath Nagar, Shahdara, Delhi-32 have changed my name to RASHMI RANI.

I, Sumitra Devi Garg wife of Tersam Garg resident of, 155 Tarun Enclave Pitam Pura Delhi-110034.I have changed my name from Sumitra Devi Garg to Sumitra Garg.

I, Piyush S/o Ashok Kumar R/o D-23, Amar Colony Kamruddin Nagar Nangloi Delhi-110041 Changed my Name to Piyush Sharma

0040880235-4

I, Sunita Saini, W/O- Samson Peter, D/O- Late Ram Prasad Saini R/O Flat No.1346, First Floor, Pocket GH-4, Sector-28, Rohini, Delhi-110042, after marriage have changed my name to Sunita Peter.

0040880237-1

I, No-9106485M, NK- Shakeel Ahmed, R/O- Zuhama, District- Kupwara-193224, In my service records the names and D o B of the Children's has been wrongly mentioned daughter as Rabiya Bano, 09-09-2011 instead of Rabiya Shakeel, 01-12-2014, Son's as Khalid Ahmed, 12-01-2013, Anzar Ahmed, 10-07-2016 instead of Khalid Shakeel, 01-10-2015, Anzar Shakeel, 04-08-2016. It needs corrections. Objections will be filed to Unit 1 JAKLI within seven days.

0020520738-1

I, Gurcharan Singh, S/o- Surjit Singh, R/O G-18/27, DLF Phase-1, Sector-26, Gurugram (Haryana)- 122002, have changed my name to, Gurcharan Singh Sethi for all Purposes.

Information is given to general public at large that the name of MD ZAID HUSSAIN (D.O.B.- 23.09.2026) S/o MD. KHAIRUL HUSSAIN AND MRS. NAHID FATIMA (as per Birth Certificate issued by Municipal Corporation of Delhi dated 25.04.2014) Registration No. MCDOLIR-0113-005818383 registered on 07.10.2013 has been wrongly mentioned as Zaid Hussain in his ADHAR Card. His actual name to be read as MD ZAID HUSSAIN for all future record.

I, Sachin Sharma S/o Suresh Chand Sharma R/o H.No.118, F/5, East Moti Bagh, Sarai Rohilla, North Delhi, Delhi-110007 have changed the name of my minor daughter from Gitika alias Gitika Sharma to Gitika Sharma for all purposes.

0040880110-1

I, AALAMGEER ANSARI S/O MD IRISH ANSARI R/O HNO.A-1105 3RD-FLOOR A-BLOCK JAHANGIRPURI DELHI-110033. HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO ALAMGIR ANSARI.

0040880236-4

I, Sidra Fatma, W/o Mohd Sajid, R/o 366, Gali Dhobian, Bazar Delhi Gate, Darya Ganj, New Delhi-110002, have changed my name from Sidrah to Sidra Fatma, for all purposes.

0040880116-1

I, SUMIT SHARMA, S/o RAMESH KUMAR, R/o B-7, Raja Vihar, Samay Pur Badli, Delhi-110042, declare that RAMESH KUMAR and RAMESH SHARMA are one and the same person, i.e, my father. I request all concerned to update my father's name in all my documents for future purposes.

0040880190-1

I, VAIBHAV S/o Subhash Jhamb R/o-A4/391, Paschim Vihar, New Delhi, Delhi-110063, have changed my name to VAIBHAV JHAMB, for all purposes

0040880230-7

I, DEEPA LAXMI AZAD, wife of SUSHIL AZAD, residing at 24-F SECTOR-8, JASOLA VIHAR, New Delhi-110025, have changed my name from DEEPA LAXMI AZAD to DEEPA LAXMI.

0040880235-6

I, Amit Kumar S/o Arjun Prasad Gupta R/o B-1/59-A, Top-Floor, Sewak-Park, Uttam-Nagar, Dwarka, Delhi-110059, have changed my name to Amit Kumar Gupta permanently.

0040880237-3

I, Nagesh Ishwarappa Hadapad S/o Ishwarappa R/o Udapudi, Beedaki, Belgaurn, Karnataka-591130, have changed my name to Nagesh I Hadapad.

0071062290-1

I, Alshifa, W/o- Nazim, R/o- H.No. K-71, New Seelampur, Delhi-110053, have changed my name and shall henceforth be known as Alshifa Shakeel, for all purposes, vide affidavit no. IN-D/049549251/626787, dated- 22.09.2026, sworn before Notary Abhinay Gupta, Delhi, wherein I, have added my father's name Shakeel as my surname.

0040880238-9

I, Khairuddin Ahmad S/o Shaikh Shakoor Ahmad R/O House No-C-278/5, F.F. flat no-102, Shaheen Bagh, Abul Fazal Enclave Part-II, Okhla, New Delhi-110025 inform that my name is wrongly mentioned as Mohd Khairuddin in my son namely Abdu Rahman passport instead of Khairuddin Ahmad. That both the names Khairuddin Ahmad and Mohd Khairuddin are names of one and same person.

0040880325-01

I, CHANDEKAR PINAL KUMAR S/O KAVADU BHAI R/o Quarter No. 1690, 2nd Floor, Type-4, Delhi Administration Flats, Gulabi Bagh, Delhi-110007 declare that in my Caste Certificate issued by Office of Sub Divisional Magistrate, Pahar Ganj: New Delhi my name mentioned as PINAL CHANDEKAR S/o KAVADU BHAI CHANDEKAR whereas, in my Aadhaar Card & Voter ID Card, my correct name is mentioned as CHANDEKAR PINAL KUMAR S/O KAVADU BHAI both version refer to one and same identity referring of myself with my father's name. In future my name must be recognized and accepted as CHANDEKAR PINAL KUMAR S/O KAVADU BHAI. I have sworn an affidavit to this effect on 22.09.2026.

0130069656-1

I, Hema W/o Mahesh Chander Joshi R/o C-432, Sector-1, Avantika, Rohini, Delhi-110085, have changed my name after marriage to Hema Joshi.

0040880230-9

I, SANGEETA D/O VED PARKASH R/O F-45 VIKAS PURI TILAK NAGAR DELHI-110018. HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SANGEETA KAUL.

0040880236-6

I, Neeraj S/o Mahender Kumar, R/o Plot No. 262-A, Khasraa No. 17/25, Gali No 4, Harit Vihar, Kamal Pur Majra Burari, Civil Lines, Delhi-110084, have changed my minor Son's name Nischay to Aryan aged 14 years.

0071062263-1

I, Madan Lal Gupta, S/o- Rattan Lal Garg, R/o-348 Double Storey New Rajinder Nagar Delhi-60, have changed my name to Madan Lal Garg

0040880238-2

I, PERVEZ KHAN S/o MOHD TAUFEEQ KHAN R/O 18 B-1 BLOCK A R/O TO FOHRI FARM NOOR NAGAR JAMIA NAGAR DELHI 110025 , have changed the name of my minor Son aged 14 Yrs from ARAFAT KHAN to MOHD ARAFAT KHAN permenately.

0071062312-1

I, Dimati Devi W/o Late Kunwar Singh, aged about 77 years, born on 20.01.1949, R/o Agar Laga Jingor, District Chamoli, Uttarakhand-246428, that my name is presently recoded as Dimati Devi in various identity, official, banking and other records, that I have changed my name from Dimati Devi to Demanti Devi for all future purposes.

0040880014-1

I, RADHIKA D GUPTA, W/O-ROHIT AGGARWAL, R/O-FLAT NO, GC-1404, ADITYA MEGA CITY VAIBHAV KHAND, INDIRAPURAM UTTAR PRADESH-201014, I have changed my name to RADHIKA AGGARWAL.

0040880235-8

I, Neeru Bathla w/o Mahesh Bathla, R/o, C40A/11, GF, Ardee city, Sector-52, Gurugram 122003, have changed my name to Neeru Gera Bathla for all further purposes.

0040880112-1

I, NIKITA SAIN W/o MAHESH SAIN R/O HOUSE NO-4, K-1 EXTN, 2ND FLOOR, MOHAN GARDEN, UTTAM NAGAR WEST DELHI, DELHI - 110059 have changed my name to NIKITA for all purposes.

0071062248-1

I, Sazadi Begum W/o Mohammad Asgar R/o Ashraf Ali Gangih Khalsa, Saharanpur, UP have changed my name to Shahnaz.

0071062300-1

I, SUMIT SHARMA, S/o RAMESH KUMAR, R/o B-7, Raja Vihar, Samay Pur Badli, Delhi-110042, declare that RAMESH KUMAR and RAMESH SHARMA are one and the same person, i.e, my father. I request all concerned to update my father's name in all my documents for future purposes.

0040880111-1

I, Vandana Talwar, D/o-Vinod Malik, R/o C-82 BriJ Vihar Ghaziabad, U.P-201011 hereby declare that my father's name was, earlier mentioned as, Vinod Kumar Malik and, is now corrected to Vinod Malik.

0040880230-2

I, FEROZ RAFI, S/O-Mohammad Rafi, R/O.E-802, Neelpadam-1, Sector-5, Vaishali Ghaziabad Uttar Pradesh-201010, have changed my name from, FEROZ RAFI to FIROZ RAFI, S/o- Mohd .Rafi for all future purposes.

0040880235-1

I, Ankit Ahuja s/o Anil Ahuja, R/o A-139, Sudershan Park, New Delhi-110015, have changed my name to Ankit Singh Ahuja.

0040880134-1

I, Deepak Chalhotra, S/o- Saudagar Singh, R/o A6-605, Consient Habitat, Near- Govt School, Sec-78, Greater faridabad Faridabad, Haryana-121004, Have Change My Name To Deepak Chalotra for all Purposes.

0040880238-4

I, Rajshri Alias Kumari Rajshree Parmar D/o Devraj Singh Parmar and W/o Ajit Sharan Singh R/o Ward No- 04, Kadam Para Chowk, Mahamaya Ward, Pratappur (NP), Surajpur, Chhattisgarh- 497223, have changed my name to Rajshree Singh.

0071062313-1

I, Ramesh Kumar Mohata, S/o Jagdish Prasad Mohata, R/o-A-20, SF, Rampuri, Chander Nagar, Ghaziabad, UP-201011, have changed the name of my minor daughter from Vriddhi Mohata to Vriddhi Mohta.

0040880236-1

I, Gajendra Singh, S/o- Atar Singh, R/o- Plot No.19, Kh.No.40/5, Gautam Colony, Narela, Delhi-110040, have changed the name of my minor son Darshit aged- 11-years and he shall hereafter be known as Darshit Kumar

0040880237-7

I, AMIT KUMAR S/O GOPAL BHAI R/o, House-No.418/3, Pocket-3, Madipur Colony, West-Delhi, Delhi-110063, have changed my name to AMIT KUMAR BHAKORIA.

0040880237-5

I, DHEERAJ KUMAR ALIAS DHEERAJ KUMAR KHANAGWAL S/o JEET RAM R/O P9-201, TOWER-P9, PRATEEK GRAND CITY PAEONIA, PRATEEK GRAND CITY PAEONIA, SIDDHARTH VIHAR, NEAR SANTOSH MEDICAL COLLEGE, SIDDHARTH VIHAR, NH-24, GHAZIABAD, VTC: SIDDARTH Vihar, PO: VIJAY Nagar, UTTAR PRADESH - 201009 have changed my name to DHEERAJ KUMAR KHANAGWAL

0071062305-1

I, Tarsem Lal Garg son of Mange Ram Garg, resident of.155 Tarun Enclave Pitam Pura Delhi-110034. I have changed my name from Tarsem Lal Garg to Tersam Garg.

0040880230-4

I, Shivam Garg, R/o V-36, Budh Vihar Phase-I, Delhi-110086, have changed my Minor Daughter name from Maira Garg to Myra Garg for all Purposes.

0040880238-6

I, Ashok Sharma S/o Rai Singh R/O D-23, Amar Colony Kamruddin Nagar Nangloi DELHI-110041 Changed my Name to Ashok kumar

0040880235-3

I, MOHD HUMAID S/O MOHAMMAD SADIQUE R/O FA-5 ABUL FAZAL ENCLAVE - 1 JAMIA NAGAR NEW FRIENDS COLONY SOUTH DELHI - 110025 have changed my name MOHAMMAD HUMAID for all future purpose

0071062319-1

I, INDERPREET SINGH WARWAL, S/O- SHINDER SINGH WARWAL, R/O KH NO.514 NEAR JIO TOWER JHANGOLA, P.O. PALLA DELHI-110036, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO INDERJEET SINGH.

0040880236-3

I, ILHAM ALAM, W/o. Mr. Quseem Ahmad Faizi, R/o. F-166, Second Floor, Shaheen Bagh, New Delhi-110025, hereby declare that I have changed the name of my baby from “Yahya Faizi” to “Yahya Quseem Faizi” for all purposes and records.

0040880113-1

I, MOHD SHAMOOM, S/O MOHD MUNTAJIB, R/O- H.NO.667, GALI-NAL BANDAN, HAMILTON ROAD, KASHMIRI GATE, DELHI-110006, I inform that my father name has been wrongly mentioned as muntajib in My 10th class mark-sheet, but correct My father name is Mohd Muntajib

0040880233-1

I, MAMTA W/O ESHA KUMAR R/O 17/59, 60, TRILOK PURI, DELHI-110091 have changed my name to NIRMAL.

0040880230-6

I, hitherto known as, Zaved Firoz Khan, s/o Firoz Uddin Khan, residing at Madina Mohalla Madhupur, Deoghhar, Jharkhand Presently at Delhi, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Zaid Khan

0040880235-5

I, DEEPAK KUMAR S/O INDER SINGH R/O NEAR POLICE STATION HUDDA SECTOR-01 PATAUDI GURGAON HARYANA have changed my name DEEPAK CHAUHAN for all future purpose

0071062225-1

I, Thankamoni T.P.D/o Kesava Panicker W/O-C.R.Mohanan Nair, R/o, Plot-9/10, Vrindhanvan Dham, Harihariv, Dwarka, Sector-16A, P.O.Kakrola, Delhi-110078, have changed my name to Thankamoni Mohanan permanently.

0040880237-2

I, Susheela Rani Mehta D/o Narayan Sardar and W/o Parmeshwar Mhto R/o Shivpur, Tikja Toli, Sampachhak, Patna, Mahendru, Bihar-800066, have changed my name to Sushila Devi

0071062287-1

I, Umesh Kumar, S/o- Ram Saran Dass Kochhar, R/o, A-1/401A, Second Floor, Sector - 6, Rohini, North West Delhi - 110085, have changed my name to Umesh Kochhar for all Purposes.

0040880238-8

I, Sachin Sharma S/o Suresh Chand Sharma R/O H.No.118, F/5, East Moti Bagh, Sarai Rohilla, North Delhi, Delhi-110007 have changed the name of my minor son from Ritvik to Hritvik Sharma for all purposes.

0040880110-2

I, SAHANA PARVEEN W/O ALAMGIR ANSARI R/O HNO.A-1105 3RD-FLOOR A-BLOCK JAHANGIRPURI DELHI-110033. HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SHAHANA.

0040880236-5

I, Ashok Arora S/o Late Krishan Lal Arora, R/o 330-331, 2nd Floor, Pocket-11B, Sector-23, Rohini, Delhi-110085, declare Ashok Kumar, Ashok Kumar Arora, and Ashok Arora are one person. For all purposes, my name is Ashok Arora, vide Affidavit dated 23/09/2026 before Notary Public, Delhi.

0130069670-1

I, Jai Gopal S/o Suresh Kumar Garg R/o 603-A, Tower-5, Panchsheel Wellington, Crossing Republik, Ghaziabad, UP-201016 declare that in my daughter's PUSHTI birth certificate my name is mentioned as Jai Gopal Garg. My correct name is Jai Gopal. Please amend accordingly.

0040880199-1

I, Sunil Sethi, S/o Narayan Saroop Sethi, R/o Tower-C, Flat No. 1304, ACE Aspire, Techzone-4, Greater Noida West, UP-201306, have changed my name to SUNIL KUMAR SETHI for all future purposes.

0071062251-1

I, Swati Garg, W/o-Tarun Kumar Agarwal, R/o- B2/258-Upper Ground Floor Paschim Vihar near Doon Public School West- Delhi, Delhi-110063, have Changed my name to Swati Agarwal, permanently

0040880230-8

I, ABHISHEK kunar jha S/O parmoo kumar jha R/O RZ-38/PH-1 Ranaji Enclave, Najafgarh, South West Delhi, Delhi-110043 have changed my name to Abhishek jha vide affidavit date 15.09.2026 delhi for all purposes.

0050298261-1

I, Gurminder Kaur W/o Gurdeep Singh R/o 19/13-A, Moti Nagar Delhi-15 have changed my name to Gurminder Kaur Khurana

0040880235-7

I, Mohammad Rashid S/o Mohd Asagar R/o Ashraf Ali, Gangoh Khalsa, Saharanpur, UP have changed my name to Mohd Rashid.

0071062296-1

I, hitherto known as MUNISH KUMAR Son of, RAI SINGH, doing Government Service as Section Officer, Grade-I (DSS), in the Directorate of Education, Govt. of N.C.T. of Delhi, Old Secretariat, Delhi-110054, residing at Plot No.1758, 3rd Floor, Outram Line, GTB Nagar, Kingsway Camp, Delhi-110009 have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as MANISH MAHAJAN.

0040880238-10

I, KIRAN BALA, W/O-ROHIT BHATIA 11/342 GALI NO 1 DAYANAND NAGAR BAHADURGARH JHAJJAR HARYANA 124507, CHANGED MY NAME TO KIRAN

0040880230-1

I, RAJNI DEVI, M/o-SACHIN KUMAR SHARMA, resident of RAOJI KA MOHALLA, WARD NO-10, NEEM KA THANA, DIST-SIKAR, RAJASTHAN-332713, Have changed my name from RAJNI DEVI to RATNI DEVI, vide affidavit, dated- 24/09/2026 at new Delhi

0040880236-10

I, Surjeet Kumar Mehto, S/o-Dev Prasad Mehto, R/o.E-139, Gali No-8, Swarop Nagar, Delhi-110042 have changed my name to Surjeet Kumar.

0040880236-7

I, NILESH GUPTA S/O PREM CHAND GUPTA R/O 3449-A, GALI NO-0, NARANG COLONY, TRI NAGAR, DELHI-110035 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO NILESH KUMAR GARG FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES.

0071062262-1

I, Chaman Gupta W/o Madan Lal Garg R/o 348 Double Storey New Rajinder Nagar Delhi-60, have changed my name to Chaman Garg

0040880238-3

I, NEHA GARG ALIAS NEHA SINGHAL D/o SAT PRAKASH GARG W/o MANISH SINGHAL R/o K-31/30 FLAT NO-4 MODEL TOWN 3 MOHAN PARK MODEL TOWN III DR. MUKHERJEE NAGAR DELHI-110009 have changed my name to NEHA SINGHAL for all purposes.

0071062316-1

I, SHAHIN, W/o Mustaqeem, R/o 2926, Kali Masjid, Sita Ram Bazar, Delhi-110006, have changed my name from BABY to SHAHIN, for all purposes.

0040880105-1

I, Madhavi Devi, W/o-Late Shri. Mohan Singh, retired from Assam Rifles, with Army.No.151403, R/o village- Gavana, Post Office Semalta, Tehsil and District- Rudraprayag in my husband service record my name and DOB wrongly written as MATWA DEVI and DOB- 15/07/1945 instead of correct name MADHVI DEVI and DOB is 01/01/1945, amendment accordingly.

0040880235-9

I, MAHESH SAIN S/o HANUMAN PRASAD R/O HOUSE NO-4, K-1 EXTN, 2ND FLOOR, MOHAN GARDEN, UTTAM NAGAR WEST DELHI, DELHI - 110059 have changed my name to MAHESH KUMAR for all purposes.

0071062245-1

I, Gajendra Singh, S/o- Atar Singh, R/o- Plot No.19, Kh.No.40/5, Gautam Colony, Narela, Delhi-110040, have changed the name of my minor daughter Gunjan aged-14-years and she shall hereafter be known as Gunjan Singh

0040880237-6

I, Nisha, daughter of Devraj, R/o C-366, Gole Market, New Delhi-110001, have changed my name from Nisha to Nisha Lohot. Henceforth, I shall be known as Nisha Lohot for all purposes and records.

0050298372-1

I, TAHIR ALI SIDDIQUI, S/o-Shakir Ali, R/o- 3631, Neta Jini Subhash Marg Darya Ganj Po, Darya Ganj Central Delhi-110002 have changed my name to TAHIR ALI

0040880230-3

I, Rehbar S/o Kesar Jamal R/O H.No.283, Opposite Jama Masjid, Khureji Khas, Krishna Nagar, Delhi-110051 Have changed my Name to Rehbar Jamal.

0040880235-2

I, Gagandeep Kaur Sarhadi, W/o-Gagandeep Singh, R/o C-28, 3rd Floor, C-Block, Gali no-4, Krishna Park, Delhi-110018, have changed my name to Gagandeep Kaur for all purposes.

0040880236-9

I, Jasveer Singh S/o Shri Bhav Singh R/o Radha City, Sahota, Sector-4, Mathura, PO: Mathura, Distt. Mathura U.P.-281001, have changed my name from Jasveer Singh to Jasvir Singh for all future purposes.

0040880126-1

I, Rajat S/o Mahavir Singh R/o Jahangirpur (265), Hajaraj (Haryana)-124104, Have Changed My Name To Rajat Kadian for All Purposes.

0040880238-5

I, PARVEEN GARG S/O DEV RAJ R/O FIRST FLOOR PLOT NUMBER 61, OPP LADIES POLICE STATION BLOCK B GANPATI SMART CITY SIRSA have changed my name PARVEEN KUMAR for all future purpose

0071062318-1

I, Evelyn Tandon W/o Amol Tandon R/o 301, Tower-B, Supertech Livingston, Crossing Republik, Ghaziabad, UP-201016 have changed my name from C. Lalbiakzuali to Evelyn Tandon for all future purposes.

0040880118-1

LOST & FOUND

I

MAHARASHTRA ENERGY DEVELOPMENT AGENCY (MEDA)
(A Government of Maharashtra Institute)
Aundh Road, Opposite Spicer College, Near Commissionerate of Animal Husbandry, Aundh,
Pune - 411 007 | Tel No.:020-35000450 | Website: www.mahaurja.com | Email: gmghc@mahaurja.com

INVITES FOR TENDER

MEDA invites Tender for Selection of Green Hydrogen Producers for Setting up Projects for Green Hydrogen Production Facilities (Anchor Units & Experimental Anchor Units) in the Maharashtra State as per Maharashtra Green Hydrogen Policy-2023. All these Anchor Unit & Experimental Anchor Units will be selected through a bid selection process.

For detailed information of Tender, Applicants are requested to visit <http://mahatenders.gov.in> website. The date of publication of Tender is 24/09/2026 & the last date of submission of tender offer is 23/11/2026 at 17:00 Hrs.

Director General, MEDA reserves the right to accept or reject anyone or all the tender without assigning any reasons thereof.

Sd/- Director General, MEDA

POOMPUHAR SHIPPING CORPORATION LIMITED
(A Government of Tamilnadu Enterprise)
592, Anna Salai, IV Floor, Nandanam, Chennai - 600 035, India
Telephone No. : 044 - 24330505 / 807, Fax : 91-44-24344593 / 24335706,
E-mail : psc@pshc.co.in, www.pshc.co.in, 044-24330505/11974PLC06696

E-TENDER INVITING NOTICE

Notice inviting E-tender for appointment of a consultant firm to conduct a feasibility & market study for identification, evaluation, and engagement of viable return cargo for PSC chartered vessels in east coast of India.

TENDER NO: PSC/OPNS/CONSULTANCY-RETURN CARGO/001/2026-27, DT:22.09.2026.

Bid submission start date : On 24.09.2026 at 18.00 hours
Bid submission end date : On 13.10.2026 at 12.00 hours
Technical Bid opening date : On 13.10.2026 at 14.00 hours

Venue: Poompuhar Shipping Corporation Ltd., 592, Anna Salai, IV Floor, Nandanam, Chennai - 600 035.
Online EMD through e-Tender portal - Rs. 20,000/- through the NIC Web Portal <https://tntenders.gov.in/nicep/app>

Tender document is available in e-tendering web portal <https://tntenders.gov.in/nicep/app> and www.tamiship.com at free of cost. Prospective bidders are advised to upload their bid on <https://tntenders.gov.in/nicep/app> and refer the web portal for all further communications. The conditions / requirement mentioned in the website shall be met out by the bidders. This advertisement is an invitation for bid only. The details given in the website are comprehensive.

DIPR/2942/TENDER/2026 **GENERAL MANAGER (FINANCE)**

OFFICE OF SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER
AGRA CIRCLE, P.W.D AGRA
Notice inviting E-Tender
Letter No. 5089/ 14M-AC/2026 **Dated:- 18-09-2026**

1. The Superintending Engineer, Agra Circle, P.W.D, Agra on behalf of Governor of Uttar Pradesh invites the Percentage rate bids from the eligible and approved Contractors registered with UP, PWD, Road work. The Bidder may submit bids for any or all of the works. Bidders are advised to note the minimum qualification criteria specified in Clause 4 of the Instructions to Bidders to qualify for the award of the contract.

2.

Sl. No	District	Name of Work	Estimated cost (Rs. in Lac)	Bid Security (Rs. in Lacs)	Cost of Document (Rs. in Rs.)	Time of Completion	Address of Executive Engineer executing the work	Address of Superintending Engineer	Address of Chief Engineer	Category of Contractor
1	1	Widening and strengthening work from ASR Marg to Samogar Ghat Ferry via Shyamano Banrauli Kataria Hingor Khediyan Road in Agra district (length 3.375 km)..	390.00	21.50	STC +TC+ GST = 2360.00	08-Month	Executive Engineer, CD-2, P.W.D., Agra	Superintending Engineer, Agra Circle, P.W.D., Agra	Chief Engineer, Agra Zone, P.W.D., Agra	Class A

3. Bid document with detailed terms and conditions will be available online on website <http://etender.up.nic.in> and Prahari (<http://wms.upppwd.gov.in/> Prahari) From 15-10-2026 to 20-10- 2026. Bids must be submitted online only at e-tendering portal of <http://etender.up.nic.in> and Prahari App with all documents as per GO No 14/2020/879(1)/23-7/2020/176(lko)/06 Dt 25-08-2020 on or before 12:00 pm Dt. 20-10-2026. Technical Bid received online will be opened on 20-10-2026 at 12:30 pm.

4. Government Order No.-86/2026/649/2026/23-7099/106/2025 Public Works Section-7 dated 23 May, 2026 will remain effective.

(G.K. Varshney)
Executive Engineer
CD-2, P.W.D.,
Agra

UPID-256908 Dt. 23/09/2026
www.upidatv.gov.in

(S.K. Harit)
Superintending Engineer
Agra Circle, P.W.D.,
Agra

समाहरणालय, गोपालगंज
(बिहार मद्यनिशेध और उत्पाद अधिनियम, 2016 (यथा संशोधित) के तहत अधिहरित वाहन की सार्वजनिक नीलामी)
—वाहन नीलामी की अतिअत्यकालीन सूचना:—

एतद् द्वारा सर्वसाधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि बिहार राज्य में भाराबन्दी के उपरान्त बिहार मद्यनिषेध एवं उत्पाद अधिनियम, 2016 (यथासंशोधित 2022) के अधीन दर्ज उत्पाद वाहनों का उक्त अधिनियम की धारा – 58(5) के अधीन अधिहरण के प चातु अधिहरित वाहनों को सार्वजनिक नीलामी द्वारा बिक्री करने के आदेश हेतु समाहर्ता को प्रदत्त मावित के आलोक में इस हेतु निमित्त गठित समिति द्वारा विभागीय पत्रांक-13 /विनश्टीकरण/ अधिहरण / नीलामी- SOP /12-02 /2025-809, दिनांक-03.02.2026 में दिये गये अधिहरण एवं नीलामी से संबंधित मातक संचालन प्रक्रिया (SOP) का पालन करते हुए दिनांक 27.08.2026 (पथम), 07.09.2026 (द्वितीय) एवं 15.09.2026 (तृतीय) को सार्वजनिक नीलामी किया गया, जिसमें से शेष बचे वाहनों की चतुर्थ सार्वजनिक नीलामी उपरोक्त विभागीय पत्रांक-13 /विनश्टीकरण/ अधिहरण / नीलामी- SOP /12-02 /2025-809, दिनांक-03.02.2026 कडिका-13 में दिए गए "तीन बार नीलामी के उपरान्त भी यदि किसी वाहन की बिक्री नहीं हो पाती है तो उस वाहन की नीलामी "As Is Where Is Basis" पर की जाए। "As Is Where Is Basis" पर प्रत्येक नीलामी में वाहनों के मूल्य को 10% कम करते हुए तब तक नीलामी की जाए" के आधार पर 'जो है, जहाँ है, जैसा है उसी स्वरूप में' जिला पंचायत संसाधन केन्द्र, गोपालगंज में निम्न प्रकार से की जायेगी:-

वाहन की सार्वजनिक नीलामी की तिथि		आवेदन प्राप्त करने की अंतिम तिथि	आवेदन प्राप्त करने का स्थान
सार्वजनिक नीलामी की चतुर्थ तिथि	29.10.2026 किसी कारणवश नीलामी नहीं होने की स्थिति में पुनः नीलामी दिनांक 30.10.2026 को किया जायेगा	27.10.2026	अधीशक मद्यनिषेध, कार्यालय गोपालगंज नव निर्माणश्रीन न्यू पुलिस लाईन के समीप फाहता रोड, बरडीला, गोपालगंज

नीलामी हेतु वाहन का विवरण:-

क्र०	अधिहरित उत्पाद बंधा संख्या	थाना का नाम	कण्ड संख्या	वाहन का स्थान (जहाँ पर वाहन रखा गया है)	वाहन का प्रकार	वाहन का निबंधन संख्या	वाहन का वैधिस संख्या	वाहन का ईजन संख्या	वाहन स्वामी का नाम व पता	निबंधन वर्ष	वाहन का न्युनतम मूल्य	अग्रघन की रशि
1	874/25	जादीपुर	167/23	जादीपुर	Motor Cycle	DL758Z3039	MBLA06ANFGH10317	JA06EJFH35847	बीट इम्फाट्टे, सग-गरिका, दिल्ली।	2015	15300	3060
2	868/24	उत्पाद थाना गोपालगंज	700/24	उत्पाद मालखला बंजरी	Scotey	DL55AG1317	ME4JC48CB8156094	JC44E126671	मातु पित्त-मोयल रात-नदीर रोड दिल्ली।	2011	9900	1980

नीलामी की विस्तृत जानकारी state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar से भी प्राप्त की जा सकती है।
PR- 012449 (Excise) 2026-27 **नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार।** **समाहर्ता-सह-जिला दण्डाधिकारी, गोपालगंज**

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE										
SR NO	NAME OF DEPARTMENT	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER				OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE DEPARTMENT	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL	
1	PWD B&R, SIRSA	SPECIAL REPAIR BY WAY OF WIDENING AND STRENGTHENING OF ROAD FROM AHMEDPUR DAREWALI TO KALUJANA (V2) (ROAD ID 11732) IPB IN KM 0.00 TO 0.250, 5.950 TO 6.200 AND PC IN KM 0.250 TO 5.950 IN SIRSA DISTT. (DABWALI CONSTITUENCY) (WORK PROGRAMME 2026-27) GROUP-1				16.09.2026 29.09.2026	321.54 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01666-220530 pwd-eeepd1-sirsa@hry.nic.in	
2	PWD B&R, SIRSA	RE-CONSTRUCTION OF ROAD FROM CONNECTING LINKS TO PWD ROAD AT CHAUTALA (VT) (ROAD ID 10758) CCB IN KM. 0.00 TO 0.375 AND 1.575 TO 2.94 IN SIRSA DISTT. (DAMAGED BY PHE DEPARTMENT)				16.09.2026 29.09.2026	163.03 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01666-220530 pwd-eeepd1-sirsa@hry.nic.in	
3	PWD B&R, FATEHABAD	SIR/WDG./STG. OF 05 NO. ROADS UNDER RATIA CONSTITUENCY IN FATEHABAD DISTT. (W. P. 2026-27) (GROUP-2)I. PDG. 30 MM THICK BITUMINOUS CONCRETE ON BYPASS AT RATIA FROM BUDHLADA RATIA ROAD TO TOHANA RATIA ROAD (ROAD ID 10188) 2. WDG. AND STG. AND IPB ON HANZAPUR TO DHANI SUNDER NAGAR ROAD (ROAD ID 5537) 3. STRENGTHENING WITH BM AND PC ON RATIA RORI ROAD TO NIMRI (ROAD ID 5503) 4. STG. WITH BM AND PC ON ALLAWALS TO DADUPUR (ROAD ID 5515) 5. STG. WITH BM AND PC ON NIMRI TO DADUPUR (ROAD ID 5517) (EXCLUDING GST) + 3 WORKS				22.09.2026 05.10.2026	1849.04 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01667-220120 pwd-eeepd-fatehabad@hry.nic.in	
4	PWD B&R, ROHTAK	PROVIDING STREET LIGHT, 500 KVA SUB STATION, HVAC SYSTEM AND LED LIGHT IN JUDICIAL COURT COMPLEX JHAJJAR IN DISTRICT JHAJJAR (PROVIDING HVAC SYSTEM ONLY)				21.09.2026 01.10.2026	111.54 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9034929655 pwd-eeedrohtak1@gmail.com	
5	PWD B&R, SIRSA	SPECIAL REPAIR FOR 4 NOS. ROADS BY WAY OF WIDENING AND STRENGTHENING OF ROAD FROM (I) ASIR TO PIPLI (V2) (ROAD ID 11730) PC IN KM. 0.00 TO 2.63 (II) DESU TO SEKHU ROAD (V2) (ROAD ID 5766) PC IN KM. 0.30 TO 0.90 (III) L/R GANGA TO MOONAWALI (ROAD ID 10472) 80MM THICK IPB IN KM 4.690 TO 5.390 (IV) KHUYIAN MALKANA TO DIWANKHERA KM 0.00 TO 0.10 AND KM 0.480 TO 0.900 (ROAD ID 2140) 80MM THICK IPB (DABWALI CONSTITUENCY) IN SIRSA DISTT. (WORK PROGRAMME 2026-27) GROUP-2				16.09.2026 29.09.2026	283.89 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01666-220530 pwd-eeepd1-sirsa@hry.nic.in	
6	PWD B&R, SIRSA	SPECIAL REPAIR BY WAY OF WIDENING AND STRENGTHENING OF 2 NOS. ROADS FROM (I) KARANGGARH TO PANJANA (V1) (ROAD ID 12208) 80MM THICK IPB IN KM 0.000 TO 0.400, 3.460 TO 3.560 AND 20MM THICK PC IN KM 0.400 TO 3.460 KM (II) GHORANWALI TO BHOONA (V3) (ROAD ID 11745) 80MM THICK IPB IN KM 0.265 TO 0.350 AND 20MM THICK PC IN KM 0.350 TO 2.900 IN SIRSA DISTT. (RANIA CONSTITUENCY) (WORK PROGRAMME 2026-27) GROUP-4				19.09.2026 29.09.2026	367.67 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01666-220530 pwd-eeepd1-sirsa@hry.nic.in	
7	PWD B&R, SIRSA	SPECIAL REPAIR BY WAY OF STRENGTHENING OF ROAD 2 NOS. ROADS (I) KHAIKARAN TO DHOTAR ROAD (VT) (ROAD ID 5658) 50 MM THICK BM AND 20 MM THICK PC IN KM. 0.995 TO 3.62, 4.45 TO 6.10, 6.50 TO 11.60 AND CCB IN KM 0.69 TO 0.74 (II) L/R TO PANNIWALA MOTTA (V1) (ROAD ID 5733) 50 MM THICK BM AND 20 MM THICK PC IN KM 0.00 TO 0.250 IN SIRSA DISTT. (RANIA CONSTITUENCY) (WORK PROGRAMME 2026-27) G-8				19.09.2026 29.09.2026	446.45 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01666-220530 pwd-eeepd1-sirsa@hry.nic.in	
8	PWD B&R, SIRSA	SPECIAL REPAIR BY WAY OF STRENGTHENING OF ROAD FROM CHAUTALA TO SABJANA UPTO RAJ BORDER (VT) (ROAD ID 1069) 30 MM THICK BC IN KM. 0.35 TO 3.156, 3.565 TO 4.01 AND RECONSTRUCTION (SHIFTING) IN KM. 3.156 TO 3.565 IN SIRSA DISTT. DABWALI CONSTITUENCY (WORK PROGRAMME 2026-27) GROUP-3				16.09.2026 29.09.2026	115.01 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01666-220530 pwd-eeepd1-sirsa@hry.nic.in	
9	PWD B&R, SIRSA	SPECIAL REPAIR VARIOUS 3 NOS. ROADS BY WAY OF WIDENING AND STRENGTHENING, RAISING FROM I) MALLEWALA TO BUPP BRIDGE (V3) (ROAD ID 5660) PC IN KM. 0.20 TO 4.65 AND IPB IN KM 0.00 TO 0.20 II) SAHUWALA TO KEHARWALI (VT) (ROAD ID 5697-98) 80MM THICK IPB IN KM 12.970 TO 13.570, 19.800 TO 20.650 III) DHS ROAD TO KARANWALI (VT) (ROAD ID 5687-5688) IN KM. 6.42 TO 6.90 IN SIRSA DISTT. KALANWALI CONSTITUENCY (WORK PROGRAMME 2026-27) GROUP-7				16.09.2026 29.09.2026	371.25 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01666-220530 pwd-eeepd1-sirsa@hry.nic.in	
10	PANCHAYATI RAJ,AMBALA	DPLAN INSTALLATION OF OPEN GYM AND SHED NEAR TELL POND AT VILL. PANJOKHRA SAHIB AND CONST. OF SHED NEAR R/WALL OF SURAJKUND POND AT VILL. GARNALA BLOCK AMBALA-II + 4 WORKS				22.09.2026 29.09.2026	63.56 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	0171-2551368 prexeeng.amb@hry.nic.in	
11	PANCHAYATI RAJ, GANAUR	CONSTRUCTION OF NALA (BABA SAMADH) TO RAJBIR S/O SHRI PRITHI) AT VILLAGE BAJANA KALAN BLOCK GANAUR SONIPAT NAME OF SCHEME VANGY				CLOSING DATE 05.10.2026	6.71 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	7015771521 sdoprganaur1@gmail.com	
12	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, CHARKHI DADRI	REQUIREMENT OF VARIOUS MATERIAL AT STORE UNDER JURISDICTION OF LWS (M) SUB DIVISION NO. 2, CHARKHI DADRI & 05 MORE WORKS				CLOSING DATE 05.10.2026	6 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01250-220058 xenlwsmech@gmail.com	
13	CIVIL SURGEON,SIRSA	REQUEST TO PUBLISH ADVERTISEMENT REGARDING E-TENDER OF ORTHO IMPLANT & INSTRUMENTS 2027, DISTRICT SIRSA				24.09.2026 07.10.2026	EMD 1 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9416255807 cpssirsa@gmail.com	
14	AGRICULTURE & FARMERS WELFARE, CHARKHI DADRI	RAMP INLET WORKS AT PONDS OF VILLAGE HANAWAS KALAN, BLOCK BADHRA, CHARKHI DADRI				22.09.2026 29.09.2026	7.24 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9466627716 ascodadri@gmail.com	
15	KALPANA CHAWLA GOVT MEDICAL COLLEGE KARNAL	E-TENDER FOR SUPPLY MEDICINE AND CONSUMABLE (DISPOSABLE) PATCH, COTTON BUDS, NYLON 10-0, DISPOSABLE NEEDLE 24 NO. ETC.) AT KCGMC, KARNAL				29.09.2026 13.10.2026	EMD 70000	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9896154463 director.kgchc-hry@gov.in	
16	KALPANA CHAWLA GOVT MEDICAL COLLEGE KARNAL	E-TENDER FOR SUPPLY MEDICINE AND CONSUMABLE (DISPOSABLE) PATCH, COTTON BUDS, NYLON 10-0, DISPOSABLE NEEDLE 24 NO. ETC.) AT KCGMC, KARNAL				28.09.2026 05.10.2026	EMD 10000	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9896154463 director.kgchc-hry@gov.in	
17	FOREST DEPARTMENT, HISAR	8 TENDER FLOATED BY HISAR FOREST DIVISION FOR RAISING OF PLANTS IN NURSERIES HISAR HANSI AND ADAMPUR RANGE UNDER JURISDICTION OF HISAR FOREST DIVISION				23.09.2026 29.09.2026	377.58 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9992222537 dfhisar.t@gmail.com	

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT www.etenders.hry.nic.in

NO.49608/HRY

NORTHERN RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE

Sr. DEE-TRS-GZB acting for and on behalf of President of India invites E-Tender against Tender No. 230-TRS-GZB-2026-27-16. The details are as under:

1.	Name of the work:	'Retro fitment of Air Conditioning in cabs with provision of thermal insulation of cabs in 3-phase Electric locomotives' at Electric Loco Shed, Ghaziabad.
2.	Approx. cost of work:	₹ 5,31,92,171.40
3.	Earnest Money to be deposited:	₹ 10,63,900.00
4.	Last Date & Time of Submission of tender bid of tender:	16-10-2026 (15.00 Hrs.)
5.	Date & Time of opening of tender document:	16-10-2026 (After 15.00 Hrs.)
6.	Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen:	www.ireps.gov.in

Note: (i) The tenderer/s must be registered on the Indian Railway E-Procurement System (IREPS) site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for participating in e-tender system.
(ii) For all terms and conditions please refer tender document.
(iii) No manual offers are acceptable.
(iv) Cost of Tender document and Earnest money will be acceptable through net banking or payment gateway only.

No. 230-TRS-GZB-2026-27-16 Dated: 21-09-2026 **3323/2026**

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER
RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, KATAKA
E-mail:- serw_ctc@yahoo.com

No. Tender Online RWC-17/26 Letter No:- 4925 **Date:- 13.9.26**

e-Procurement NOTICE

1. Name of the work : Construction of Road works.
2. Class of contractor : Special Class (of Odisha PWD) & relevant class of other licensing authorities.
d) Estimated cost more than Rs.5.00 Crore & upto Rs.20.00 Crore : A Class (of Odisha PWD) & relevant class of other licensing authorities.
e) Estimated cost more than Rs. 20.00 Lakh & upto Rs.3.00 Crore : B Class (of Odisha PWD) & relevant class of other licensing authorities.
3. Time for Completion : As specified in the Column-7 of the Annexure.
4. Detail Projects : As per Annexure attached
5. Other Details :

Procurement Officer	Bid Identification No.	Availability of tender On-line for bidding From To	Last Date & Time of seeking Tender Clarification	Date & Time of opening of tender Technical Bid Financial Bid		
Chief Construction Engineer, Rural Works Circle, Kataka	Tender Online RWC-17/26	26.09.2026 at 11.30 A.M.	14.10.2026 up to 05.00 P.M.	14.10.2026 at 02.00 P.M.	15.10.2026 at 11.30 A.M.	Will be intimated later

Further details can be seen from the website www.tendersodisha.gov.in

Sd/-
Chief Construction Engineer
Rural Works Circle, Kataka

GOVT. OF ODISHA
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER
RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, RAYAGADA
Email ID:- ccerwcrayagada@gmail.com

Letter No.3003 **Date: 22.09.2026**

NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING Through GePNIC e-Procurement Notice

1. Name of the work : Road works for the Year 2025-2026 & 2026-2027 (Total Ten (10) Nos of Works)
2. Class of contractor : "B" Class, "A" Class & "Spl" Class of (Odisha PWD) or relevant class of other licensing authority.
3. Estimated Cost : Varies from Rs. 122.07 Lakhs to Rs.648.07 Lakhs (Approximately)
4. Details projects : As per Annexure attached

Procurement Officer	Bid Identification No.	Availability of Tender on-line for bidding From To	Last Date & Time of seeking tender clarification	Date & Time of opening of tender Technical Bid Financial Bid		
Construction Chief Engineer, Rayagada Rural Works Circle,	NCB-15/ RWCRCGDA /2026-2027	Fr. 30.09.2026 at 11.00 A.M.	Do.15.10.2026 up to 5.00 P.M.	Do.14.10.2026 Up to 5.00 P.M.	Do.16.10.2026 at 11.00 A.M.	Will be intimated later

5. The details of works can be seen from the web site <https://www.tendersorissa.gov.in>
6. Any Corrigendum/Addendum will be displayed in the above e-tender web site.

Sd/-
Chief Construction Engineer,
Rural Works Circle, Rayagada

OIPR-25001/25196/1/26-27/0032

समाहरणालय, गोपालगंज
(बिहार मद्यनिशेध और उत्पाद अधिनियम, 2016 (यथा संशोधित) के तहत अधिहरित वाहन की सार्वजनिक नीलामी)
—वाहन नीलामी की अतिअत्यकालीन सूचना:—

एतद् द्वारा सर्वसाधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि बिहार राज्य में भाराबन्दी के उपरान्त बिहार मद्यनिषेध एवं उत्पाद अधिनियम, 2016 (यथासंशोधित 2022) के अधीन दर्ज उत्पाद वाहनों का उक्त अधिनियम की धारा – 58(5) के अधीन अधिहरण के प चातु अधिहरित वाहनों को सार्वजनिक नीलामी द्वारा बिक्री करने के आदेश हेतु समाहर्ता को प्रदत्त मावित के आलोक में इस हेतु निमित्त गठित समिति द्वारा विभागीय पत्रांक-13 /विनश्टीकरण/ अधिहरण / नीलामी- SOP /12-02 /2025-809, दिनांक-03.02.2026 में दिये गये अधिहरण एवं नीलामी से संबंधित मातक संचालन प्रक्रिया (SOP) का पालन करते हुए दिनांक 27.08.2026 (पथम), 07.09.2026 (द्वितीय) एवं 15.09.2026 (तृतीय) को सार्वजनिक नीलामी किया गया, जिसमें से शेष बचे वाहनों की चतुर्थ सार्वजनिक नीलामी उपरोक्त विभागीय पत्रांक-13 /विनश्टीकरण/ अधिहरण / नीलामी- SOP /12-02 /2025-809, दिनांक-03.02.2026 कडिका-13 में दिए गए "तीन बार नीलामी के उपरान्त भी यदि किसी वाहन की बिक्री नहीं हो पाती है तो उस वाहन की नीलामी "As Is Where Is Basis" पर की जाए। "As Is Where Is Basis" पर प्रत्येक नीलामी में वाहनों के मूल्य को 10% कम करते हुए तब तक नीलामी की जाए" के आधार पर 'जो है, जहाँ है, जैसा है उसी स्वरूप में' जिला पंचायत संसाधन केन्द्र, गोपालगंज में निम्न प्रकार से की जायेगी:-

वाहन की सार्वजनिक नीलामी की तिथि		आवेदन प्राप्त करने की अंतिम तिथि	आवेदन प्राप्त करने का स्थान
सार्वजनिक नीलामी की चतुर्थ तिथि	29.10.2026 किसी कारणवश नीलामी नहीं होने की स्थिति में पुनः नीलामी दिनांक 30.10.2026 को किया जायेगा	27.10.2026	अधीशक मद्यनिषेध, कार्यालय गोपालगंज नव निर्माणश्रीन न्यू पुलिस लाईन के समीप फाहता रोड, बरडीला, गोपालगंज

नीलामी हेतु वाहन का विवरण:-

क्र०	अधिहरित उत्पाद बंधा संख्या	थाना का नाम	कण्ड संख्या	वाहन का स्थान (जहाँ पर वाहन रखा गया है)	वाहन का प्रकार	वाहन का निबंधन संख्या	वाहन का वैधिस संख्या	वाहन का ईजन संख्या	वाहन स्वामी का नाम व पता	निबंधन वर्ष	वाहन का न्युनतम मूल्य	अग्रघन की रशि
1	874/25	जादीपुर	167/23	जादीपुर	Motor Cycle	DL758Z3039	MBLA06ANFGH10317	JA06EJFH35847	बीट इम्फाट्टे, सग-गरिका, दिल्ली।	2015	15300	3060
2	868/24	उत्पाद थाना गोपालगंज	700/24	उत्पाद मालखला बंजरी	Scotey	DL55AG1317	ME4JC48CB8156094	JC44E126671	मातु पित्त-मोयल रात-नदीर रोड दिल्ली।	2011	9900	1980

नीलामी की विस्तृत जानकारी state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar से भी प्राप्त की जा सकती है।
PR- 012449 (Excise) 2026-27 **नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार।** **समाहर्ता-सह-जिला दण्डाधिकारी, गोपालगंज**

OFFICE OF THE ADDL. CHIEF ENGINEER PWD
ZONE-II JODHPUR (HQ-BARMER)

No. _____ Date :- _____

Notice Inviting Bid No. 06/2026-27
NIB-PWD2627A2833

Bid for Civil Works (Road and Building) are invited from interested bidders upto Date 13.10.2026, 06.00 PM other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal (<http://www.eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in> and <http://www.sppp.rajjasthan.gov.in>) of the state. The approximate value procurement is Rs. 1679.29 Lac. (02 Works)

UBN No. _____
1. PW26267WLOB12720
2. PW26267WLOB12721

Sd/-
Addl. Chief Engineer
PWD Zone-II Jodhpur
(HQ-Barmar)

DIPR/C/16322/2026

नियम 92 (1) (क) (ii)
ई-निविदा आमत्रण सूचना का प्रारूप

मध्यप्रदेश शासन,
नगर पालिक निगम, खालियार

दिनांक : 23/09/2026

जानसंक्रं RO क्रमांक 643

//निविदा सूचना//

दिनांक : 23/09/2026

निम्नलिखित कार्य हेतु केन्द्रीय प्रणाली में पंजीकृत टेन्डरों से ऑन लाईन निविदायें आमंत्रित की जाती हैं। निविदा का विस्तृत विवरण वेबसाइट <http://gmc.mptenders.gov.in> पर देखा जा सकता है।

क्र.	टेन्डर क्र.	कार्य का नाम	कर्य की लागत	निविदा प्ररक का मूल्य एवं ई.एम.डी.	निविदा की अंतिम तिथि
1	2026_UAD_536737_1	वाई 29 कर्मचारी आवास कॉलोनी की विभिन्न गलियों में सी.सी. रोड एवं नाली कार्य	1,40,24,961/-	12500/- 70125/-	16.10.26

नोट: निविद सम्बंधित किसी भी प्रकार के संशोधन का प्रकाशन ऑन लाईन <http://gmc.mptenders.gov.in> की वेबसाईट पर ही किया जायेगा, प्रकृष से सम्भाव्य पत्रों में प्रकाशन नहीं किया जायेगा।

कार्यपालन वंजी, नगर निगम, खालियार

राजस्थान धरोहर प्राधिकरण

मूल्य पर्यटन कक्षा, हजरात नगर (हनुमानगढ़ जिले के जलोढ) कक्षा कक्षा, अजमेर-302001

ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या 34/2026-27

निम्नलिखित कार्यो के लिए केन्द्र / राज्य सरकार के अभियंत्रिकी विभागों द्वारा पंजीकृत एवं अनुमोदी संवेदकों से निर्धारित प्रपत्र में ई-टेंडरिंग प्रक्रिया हेतु ऑनलाइन निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती है।

क्र.सं.	कार्य का विवरण	अनुमानित लागत (₹.)	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि
1	Construction of Jashnathi Panorama at Katriyasar Dist. Bikaner (Raj.) UBN is: HPP2627WSOB00057	290.88 Lakh	15 Months
2	Construction of Tejaji Maharaj Panorama, Sursura Dist. Ajmer (Raj.) UBN is: HPP2627WSOB00058	282.63 Lakh	15 Months
3	Construction of Raiwasa Dham Panorama Dist. Sikar (Raj.) UBN is: HPP2627WSOB00059	279.13 Lakh	15 Months
4	Construction of Adivasi Panorama at Dausa (Raj.) UBN is: HPP2627WSOB00060	318.83 Lakh	15 Months
5	Development work for Tribal Destination at Mangarh Dham district Banswara (Rajasthan) UBN is: HPP2627WSOB00061	349.41 Lakh	15 Months
6	Providing and Fixing of Gun Metal Statue of Govind Guru at Tribal Destination, Mangarh Dham, Banswara (Rajasthan) UBN is: HPP2627WLOB00062	643.00 Lakh	12 Months
7	Construction of Guest House at village Poonchari ka lautha, District Deeg, Rajasthan under CSR activity funded by Hindustan Zinc Limited. UBN is: HPP2627WLOB00063	1852.53 Lakh	15 Months

निविदा से संबंधित समस्त विवरण वेबसाइट <http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in> एवं <http://sppp.raj.nic.in> पर देखा जा सकता है। इच्छुक निविदादाताओं को अपने डिजिटल हस्ताक्षर के माध्यम से वेबसाइट <http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in> पर रजिस्टर करवाना आवश्यक है।

रतन, हजरात/सी/26/10701

मुख्य कार्यकारी अधिकारी

NOTICE INVITING TENDER
(For e-Procurement of Multiple Works)

The office of National Dairy Development Board, Anand in the capacity of Pure Agent of Service Recipient invites bids from eligible bidders for below listed works at Dibrugarh and Dhemaji, Assam:

Civil, Structural, Water supply, Sanitary, Roadwork, Internal Electrification, & Miscellaneous works for	SI	Name of Location	Estd. value (in Rs.)	EMD/Bid Security (in Rs.)	Tender Fees (in Rs.)	Pre-bid date and time	Last date & time of bid submission	Date & time of bidopening
1	Establishing 1 LLPD Dairy Plant at Lahowal in Dibrugarh, Assam	29,55,50,638/-	59,12,000/-	20,000/-	06-10-2026, 11:00 Hours	15-10-2026, 18:00 Hours	16-10-2026, 15:30 Hours	
2	Establishing 50 TLPD Dairy Plant at Karmipathar Revenue Village under Dhemaji Revenue Circle, Assam	26,05,23,772/-	52,11,000/-	20,000/-	06-10-2026, 17:00 Hours	15-10-2026, 18:00 Hours	16-10-2026, 15:30 Hours	

The Tender documents can be downloaded from www.assamtenders.gov.in. A pre-bid meeting will be held as mentioned above. The pre-bid meeting shall be organised virtually through online platform. The bid will be opened online on the e-Procurement portal as per the schedule mentioned above. Any corrigendum/modification etc. will be posted only on this website.

The Tender Issuing Authority (TIA) reserves the right to accept or reject any bid/tender, and to cancel/annul the bidding processand reject all bids at any time prior to contract award.

Name of the TIA: National Dairy Development Board, acting as a Pure Agent of the Service Recipients (i.e. North East Dairy and Foods Limited (NEDFL), who are in turn, is acting on behalf of AHVD, Government of Assam)

Dy. General Manager
National Dairy Development Board, Anand - 388001
On behalf of AH&V Department, Govt. of Assam.

DIPR/CF/IXP/1693/25 SEP 26

कर्मचारी भविष्य निधि संगठन
EMPLOYEES' PROVIDENT FUND ORGANISATION
(श्रम एवं रोजगार मंत्रालय, भारत सरकार)
(Min. of Labor & Employment, Govt. of India)
क्षेत्रीय कार्यालय, कानपुर / Regional Office, Kanpur,
भविष्य निधि भवन, सर्वोदय नगर कानपुर 208005
Bhavishya Nidhi Bhawan, Sarvodaya Nagar, Kanpur - 208005
दूरभाष: 0512-2217464, फैक्स: 0512-2295307, ई-मेल: ro.kanpur@epfindia.gov.in

पत्रांक-106/क.भ.नसं./क्षे. का. कानपुर/प्रेस विज्ञप्ति/2025-26/-

दिनांक-24.09.2026

प्रेस विज्ञप्ति

निधि आपके निकट 2.0 प्रोग्राम का आयोजन

विदित है कि कर्मचारी भविष्य निधि संगठन द्वारा निजी, संगठित, असंगठित / क्षेत्रों में कार्यरत श्रमिकों / कर्मचारियों एवं पेंशनरो की समस्याओं के निराकरण करने के लिए प्रत्येक माह की 27 तारीख को (अवकाश की स्थिति में अगले कार्य दिवसों में) निधि आपके निकट 2.0 को डिस्टिक्ट आउटरीच प्रोग्राम के रूप में शुरू किया गया है। इस हेतु दिनांक 28 सितम्बर, 2026 को क्षेत्रीय कार्यालय कानपुर के परिक्षेत्र में आने वाले सभी 15 जिलों (औरैया, बांदा, चित्रकूट, इटावा, फर्रुखाबाद, फतेहपुर, हमीरपुर, जालौन, झाँसी, कन्नौज, कानपुर देहात, कानपुर नगर, ललितपुर, महोबा एवं उन्नाव) में क्षेत्रीय कार्यालय कानपुर की 15 टीमें निधि आपके निकट 2.0 का आयोजन करेंगी, जहां पर उन क्षेत्रों में निवास करने वाले कर्मचारी भविष्य निधि संगठन के सदस्यों, पेंशनरों, नियोक्ताओं की समस्याओं का निराकरण करने का प्रयास करेंगी। इस आयोजन में प्रधान मंत्री विकसित भारत रोजगार योजना (PMVBRY), उपभोक्ता फोरम प्रकरण, 'विश्वास 2026' योजना एवं कर्मचारी नामांकन अभियान (EEC), 2026 की विस्तृत जानकारी भी दी जाएगी एवं APP के माध्यम से स्वयं जीवन प्रमाण करना भी बताया जायेगा। जिलेवार "निधि आपके निकट 2.0" प्रोग्राम के स्थल निम्न प्रकार है:-

जिला	आयोजन स्थल के नाम	नोडल अधिकारी का नाम	मोबाइल न.
औरैया	शेमफोर्ड म्यूचुअलिस्टिक के 12 स्कूल, भगोतीपुर, एनएच-2, औरैया	श्री संयंत्र कुमार निगम	9839027917
बांदा	तथागत ज्ञानस्थली सीनियर सेकेंडरी स्कूल, बांदा	श्री रवेत कमल यादव	9643754550
चित्रकूट	उत्तर प्रदेश वन निगम, प्रभागीय लॉगिंग ग्रंथक कार्यालय, लॉगिंग प्रभाग, कवी, चित्रकूट	कु. नन्दिनी राय	7309233628
इटावा	थियोसॉफिकल इंटर कॉलेज, एस.डी. फील्ड, राजा गंज, चोगुजी नगर, इटावा	श्रीमती वन्दना पाण्डेय	8009425395
फर्रुखाबाद	गायत्री इंटरनेशनल स्कूल, मिशन हॉस्पिटल के सामने, चौरसी नेकपुर कलां, आवास विकास कॉलोनी, फर्रुखाबाद	श्री अजुल चौहान	7896077511
फतेहपुर	ब्रिलियंट ओरिएंटल स्कूल, पक्का तालाब, फतेहपुर	श्री संतोष कुमार गुप्ता	6392294076
हमीरपुर	सीडीओ कार्यालय, विकास भवन, हमीरपुर	श्री नितीश राय	8512878760
जालौन	सनातन धर्म उच्चतर माध्यमिक विद्यालय, सनातन परिसर, झाँसी रोड, उरई	श्री अक्षय कुमार मिश्रा	7400339351
झाँसी	भारत हेवी इलेक्ट्रिकल लिमिटेड (भेल), झाँसी	श्री प्रखर पुरवार	9617521403
कन्नौज	जे.पी. एजुकेशन अकादमी, इंद्रनागर, तिवां रोड, गुरसहायगंज, कन्नौज	श्री सर्वेश्वर सिंह	9651466795
कानपुर देहात	सुमित बंसल स्कूल, रनिया, कानपुर देहात	श्री आलोक दीक्षित	8840007940
कानपुर नगर	केलाश मोटर्स, 84/105, जोटी रोड, कानपुर नगर	श्रीमती रेनु नेवाहा	9935318776
ललितपुर	ललितपुर पावर जनरेशन कंपनी लिमिटेड, ललितपुर	श्री अजय कुशवाहा	9161929448
महोबा	श्रम कार्यालय, नया कलेक्ट्रेट, पुलिस लाइन, महोबा	श्री चन्द्रशेखर सिंह	6386066022
उन्नाव	जिला शिक्षा एवं प्रशिक्षण संस्थान (DIET), मोती नगर, लेक टाउन, उन्नाव	श्री हार्दुल गुप्ता	787202011

अतः कर्मचारी भविष्य निधि संगठन के सभी सदस्यों, पेंशनरो, नियोक्ताओं से अनुरोध है कि वह अपने जिले में आयोजित होने वाली निधि आपके निकट 2.0 प्रोग्राम में उपस्थित होकर अपनी समस्याओं का निराकरण कराएं एवं किसी व्यक्ति के नियोक्ता/कंपनी/डेकेदार/विभाग के द्वारा यदि पी. एफ. अधिनियम का लाभ नहीं दिया जा रहा है तो वह उसकी शिकायत भी कर सकता है।

हस्ता./-
(प्रतीश सिंह)
क्षेत्रीय भविष्य निधि आयुक्त- II

Kalyan Singh Super Speciality Cancer Institute
C.G. City, Sultanpur Road, Lucknow-(226002)
Website: <https://cancerinstitute.edu.in>, Email: procurementservicesksssci@gmail.com

Hospital Laundry Services at KSSSCI

It is a hereby informed that bid No. GEM/2026/B/8071938 Dated: 24.09.2026 has been uploaded on GeM Portal under Hospital Laundry Services at KSSSCI. All interested service providers/ bidders are required to submit their bids on GeM Portal in accordance with the terms and conditions of the GeM bid documents. The Director reserves the right to accept or reject any or all bids at any stage without assigning any reason thereof.

Note: 1. EMD Submitted through Account Payee, FDR, Banker's Cheque, Bank Guarantee will be accepted Physically and held valid for this Bid. However, UTR No. and a scanned copy must be uploaded with this GeM Bid. 2. Site visit is mandatory. The Tender documents are available on the website of the Institute www.cancerinstitute.edu.in

Advt No:- KSSSCI/Tender-18/2026-27 DIRECTOR

Urban Improvement Trust Dausa-Bandikui
Pool Building Collectorate Campus, Dausa 303303 Telephone: 01427294292
e.mail: ultdausbandikui@rajasthan.gov.in

No. :- UIT Dausa-Bandikui/CC road/2026/RajKaj 24649914 Dated :- 23/09/2026

NOTICE INVITING BID
NIB No. :- EE/13/2026-27

Online Bids are invited up to 6:00 PM of 08-10-2026 for C.C. road and Drain work From N.H. 21 Highway Surajpura Road to pandit Deendayal Upadhyia residential scheme Dausa for UIT Dausa-Bandikui. The last date for Applying Bid and making online payment NEFT/RTGS/SSO is up-to 6:00 PM of 08-10-2026. The estimated cost of NIB is Rs. 310.30 Lacs. Details may be seen in the Bidding Document at our office or the State Public Procurement Portal website www.sppp.rajjasthan.gov.in, www.eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in/ (UBN No. TDU2627WSOB00013) (NIB Code : TDU2627A0013) XEN
Raj Samwad/C/26/10703 UIT, Dausa-Bandikui

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE
APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused 1. Neha, W/o: Jahid @ Hakla, 2. Jahid @ Hakla, S/o: Iqbal, R/o: 394, Gali No-15, West Kamal Vihar, Burari, Delhi have committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No.: 456/2026, U/s: 21/29 NDPS ACT, P.S. Burari, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said 1. Neha, 2. Jahid @ Hakla cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said 1. Neha, 2. Jahid @ Hakla have absconded (or are concealing themselves to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused 1. Neha, 2. Jahid @ Hakla of P.S. Burari, Delhi are required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 03.11.2026.

By Order
Sh. Kuldeep Narayan
Special Judge NDPS, Central Distt., Room No. 222, DP/13501/N/2026
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

SALUTE THE SOLDIER

BORDER SECURITY FORCE



SUB INSPECTOR
C B MALL
21 BN BSF
01.07.1948 –
25.09.1998



CONSTABLE
RAJNIKANT
SARKAR
21 BN BSF
11.10.1965 –
25.09.1998

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Subordinate officer Sub Inspector C B Mall and Constable Rajnikant Sarkar on their Balidan Diwas. On this day, they sustained fatal injuries in an IED blast triggered by militants in Srinagar area (J&K) and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.



HC
JOSE THARIYAN
136 BN BSF
25.05.1968 –
25.09.2002



CT
BHUPEN BHUYAN
136 BN BSF
28.02.1979 –
25.09.2002

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawans Head Constable Jose Thariyan, Constables Bhupen Bhuyan and P Chattanatha Pillai on their Balidan Diwas. On this day, they sustained fatal bullet injuries in a fierce encounter with militants in Rajouri area (J&K) and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.



CT
P CHATTANATHA
PILLAI
136 BN BSF
25.05.1969 –
25.09.2002

Director General and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Dangmei Stephen of 184 Bn CRPF, who made the supreme sacrifice on 25 September 2010 after sustaining grievous injuries during a fierce encounter with Maoists at West Medinipur district, West Bengal on 25 September 2010. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

NORTHERN RAILWAY
Tender Notice

Invitation of Tenders through E-procurement system

Sr.DMM, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001, for and on behalf of the president of India invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items.

Sr. No.	Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing time
01	93266328	Scrap Baling Machine	04 Unit	22.10.2026

Note: 1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e., www.ireps.gov.in for details.
2. No manual offer will be entertained.
Sr.DMM/NS/LP/93266328/2026 Date: 24.09.2026 3315/2026
Serving Customers With A Smile

UP Rajya Vidyut Utpadan Nigam Ltd.
HARDUAGANJ THERMAL POWER STATION KASIMPUR (ALIGARH)

E-GEM Tender Notice

Tender Notice and scope of work

SE, O&MC-IV, DTPS, Kasimpur

1. GeM E-Bid No - GEM/2026/B/8042989, Checking of live, damaged and dead power and control cable, shifting of live cable and removal of dead cable at Cable galleries of Unit 1 (51T/52T LT S/G) to Reserve S/G, CTPS, HTPP, Kasimpur, Aligarh. Estimated Cost: Rs. 1852000.00 (GST Extra), EMD- 20000.00, GEM TenderID: GEM/2026/B/8042989

Last Date of uploading Date: 08.10.2026

Note- For information regarding Addendum/corrigendum/Rejection of Bids kindly regularly visit website <https://gem.nic.in>

Letter no. 46 / अपीओमि(मुने) / विज्ञापन / कैम्प-1(46) / 26 Date: 24.09.2026

"Save Electricity for Nation"

Deputy Commissioner Office, Latehar
(District Sports Office)
Collectorate office, Latehar- 829206
Email: Website: www.latehar.nic.in
Request for Proposal (RFP)

Tender Reference No: 122 Date:21/09/2026

The District Sports-cum-District Tourism Officer, Latehar, invites Request for Proposal (RFP) for Rate Contract from eligible companies, OEMs, or their authorized distributors for the Supply, Installation, Commissioning and Establishment of an Astrophysics Park at Latehar, Jharkhand, for scientific education, experiential learning, and awareness of astronomy and space science among Students and Tourists.

Information	Details
1 Name of the work	The District Sports -cum-District Tourism Officer, Latehar, invites Request for Proposal (RFP) for Rate Contract from eligible companies, OEMs, or their authorized distributors for the Supply, Installation, Commissioning and Establishment of an Astrophysics Park at Latehar, Jharkhand, for scientific education, experiential learning, and awareness of astronomy and space science among Students and Tourists
2 Date of Publication of Bid	21/09/2026
3 Tender fee	Rs. 5000.00 (Rupees Five thousand only (Non - refundable) online at https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in
4 Earnest Money to be Deposited (EMD)	5,00,000(Five Lakh only) online at https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in
5 Last date and time of Submission of Bid	07/10/2026 – 05 PM
6 Technical Bid Opening	08/10/2026 – 11 AM
7 Pre-Bid Meeting.	26/09/2026 at 11:00AM at District Tourisms office Latehar
8 Financial Bid Opening	After Technical Evaluation
9 Bid submission Place	Online - https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in/
10 Bid Opening Place	District Tourisms Office, Latehar
11 Contact Number	Email Id: dso-lth@jharkhandmail.gov.in Cost-Based Selection (CBS) Method. Stage 1: The eligibility criteria documents, Bid Fee EMD submitted by the bidders will be evaluated in the first stage. The bidders meeting the technical evaluation criteria only will be shortlisted for further financial bid valuation. Stage 2: Out of the technically eligible bidders, the agency submitting the lowest financial bid will be awarded the project.

"Note-All bidders are directed to paginate every page of the documents submitted in the Technical Bid, and provide an index clearly mentioning the details of each page."
District Sports-cum-District Tourism Officer Latehar

WEST CENTRAL RAILWAY

Material Management Department

Sr.DMM/WCR/Bhopal on behalf of the President of India invites the following advertised tender through e-Procurement system. No manual/ postal offers shall be entertained. Tender can be accessed under the link www.ireps.gov.in for the details and for submission of tender. Tender No. :- 98285887A. Short Description: Fire Extinguisher, DCP Type 6KG MAP 90, Tender Qty.: 612 Set, Opening Date: 07-OCT-26, EMD Value (in Rs.): Rs. 1,22,390/- Sd/ Senior Divisional Materials Manager West Central Railway, Bhopal

सहच नगर अभियान एक कदम स्वच्छता की ओर

"IMPORTANT"

Whilst care is taken prior to acceptance of advertising copy, it is not possible to verify its contents. The Indian Express (P) Limited cannot be held responsible for such contents, nor for any loss or damage incurred as a result of transactions with companies, or entering into any agreements with advertisers or Publications. We therefore recommend that readers make necessary inquiries before sending any monies or entering into any agreements with advertisers or otherwise acting on an advertisement in any manner whatsoever.

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमण्डल, गिरिडीह

शुद्धि पत्र

PR No-387884 से प्रकाशित निविदा सूचना संख्या- RDD/SD/GIRIDIH/05/2026-27 में आंशिक संशोधन किया जाता है, जो निम्नवत् है:-

क्र० सं०	विवरण	पूर्व निर्धारित तिथि	संशोधित तिथि
1	वेबसाइट पर निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि	दि०-26.08.2026	25.09.2026
2	ई०-निविदा प्राप्ति की अंतिम तिथि	दि०-10.09.2026	09.10.2026
3	निविदा खोलने की तिथि	दि०-12.09.2026	12.10.2026

अन्य शर्तें यथावत् रहेंगे। कार्यपालक अभियन्ता ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमण्डल, गिरिडीह

PR 390343 Rural Work Department(26-27).D

बैंक ऑफ़ इंडिया
Bank of India

Zonal Office: 128/24, Om Laxmi Tower, H-Block, Kidwai Nagar, Kanpur Area - 208011

CUSTOMER ADVISORY

Please be advised that the United Forum of Bank Unions (UFBU) has proposed a three-day strike from 28th September 2026 to 30th September 2026. While Bank of India will make all possible efforts to provide essential banking services during the strike period, customers are requested to:

- Complete important banking transactions in advance of the strike dates
- Use ATMs/ADWMs for cash requirements (Nil Charges for use of other Bank ATMs during the Strike period)
- Use Customer Service Points (CSPs)
- Prefer Internet Banking, BOI Mobile Banking, UPI and other digital channels

The Branches shall remain open and will be functioning on 27.09.2026 (Sunday) for convenience of Customers. We sincerely regret any inconvenience caused and thank you for your understanding and cooperation.

Bank of India

UJVN LIMITED

H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR20015GGC025866 Website: www.ujvnl.com

Letter No: 861 E-Tender Notice Date: 24/09/2026

Office of the Executive Engineer (Civil), Katapathar Barrage, UJVN Ltd., Dakpathar (Dehradun), invites online bids from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:
E-Tender No: 03/EE(Civil)/KB/2026-27
Name of work/ Supply/Services: Sub surface exploration works and Geological Investigations of Katapathar Barrage in District -Dehradun, Uttarakhand.
Estimated cost: Rs. 96,58,937.00 (GST Extra)
Date of availability of bid document on website: From 17:00 hrs of 25.09.2026
Last date for submission of bids on website: Up to 17.00 Hrs of 16.10.2026
For fuller & further details, kindly visit e-procurement portal "https://uktenders.gov.in" Executive Engineer (Civil),
"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

UJVN Limited

H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephone : 0135-2763808, Fax No : 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR20015GGC025866, Website: www.ujvnl.com

RO No. 859 Tender Notice Dated : 24/09/2026

The office of Executive Engineer (Maintenance), Maneri Bhali Stage-II, Chinyalisaur (Uttarkashi) invites sealed tenders from interested parties. Brief summary of tenders is given below:
Tender No: NIT- 45/EE (M)/MB-II/2026-27, NIT- 46/EE (M)/MB-II/2026-27, NIT-47/EE (M)/MB-II/2026-27, NIT-48/EE (M)/MB-II/2026-27 & NIT-49/EE (M)/MB-II/2026-27
Name of work / Supply/Services: 1- Repairing of MIV and Spiral Gearing Drain Lines at Dharasu Power House, MB-II.
2- Epoxy painting of penstocks at Dharasu Power House, MB-II.
3- Repair and Overhauling of One No E.O.T Cranes of Capacity 15 Ton at Dharasu Power House, MB-II, Uttarkashi.
4- Calibration of various measuring and Testing Instruments at Dharasu Power House, MB-II, Uttarkashi
5- Repairing of 110 kW Vertical Type Dewatering Pump at Dharasu Power House, MB-II .
Estimated cost: Rs. 12, 35,264/- (GST Extra), Rs. 23.84,494/- Only (GST extra), Rs. 6, 95,000/- (GST Extra), Rs. 2,08,050/- (GST Extra), Rs. 7,02,500/- Only (GST extra)
Date of availability of bid document on website: - 24.09.2026
Last date for submission of tender: - 15.10.2026 up to 16:00 Hrs.
For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website" www.ujvnl.com Executive Engineer (Maintenance)
"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

उत्तर प्रदेश राज्य औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण
ए-1/4, लखनऊ, कानपुर

ई-निविदा सूचना

एलएडआर सुचित किया जाता है, कि विभिन्न औद्योगिक क्षेत्रों के अनुरागत विकास/अनुसंधान/संशोधन कार्य हेतु सस्कारी विभागों/सार्वजनिक उपकरणों/निगमों/प्राधिकरणों/परिषदों/नगर निगमों में पंजीकृत फर्मों/डेकेदारों से ई-निविदायें आमंत्रित की जाती हैं, जिसको अपनाने करने की समयसीमा निम्नवत् है:-

1. क्रम सं० 01 से 06 पर अंकित निविदा दिनांक 25.09.2026 को पूर्वाह्न 11:00 बजे से दिनांक 05.10.2026 को अपराह्न 5:00 बजे तक अपनोंड की जा सकती हैं, जिन्हें दिनांक 05.10.2026 को अपराह्न 5:30 बजे खोला जायेगा (अन्यथा चिन्तित)।

निविदादाताओं द्वारा केवल शास्त्राचार की मूल प्रतियों निविदा खोलने की तिथि से दो कार्यदिनस के अन्दर कार्यालय में जमा की जा सकती। ई-निविदा के माध्यम से आमंत्रित की जाने वाली निविदाओं का विवरण निम्नवत् है:-

क्रमांक	कार्य का नाम	अंदाजित लागत (₹.)
1	Construction of Truck Lay Bay at I.A. Loha Mandi Distt. Ghaziabad.	231.85
2	Development and Beautification of Neta Ji Subhash Chandra Bose Park Including Construction of Rain Water Harvesting (1 No.) Submersible Pump (1 No.) Stage & Footpath with 02 Year Maintenance at I.A. Sector-22 Meerut Road, Distt. Ghaziabad.	121.44
3	Construction of Boundary Wall, Footpath, Nesting Huts, (2 Nos) & Horticulture Works with 2 Year Maintenance of Park at I.A. Loha Mandi Distt. Ghaziabad.	176.65
4	Construction of Boundary Wall and Entrance Gate for Park Road No. 14 and 32 at I.A. Bulandshahar Road Site-1, Distt. Ghaziabad.	203.33
5	Resurfacing & Widening of Existing Balance Roads at I.A. Armit Steel Compound SSGT Road Distt. Ghaziabad.	265.99
6	Annual Repair and Maintenance of Miscellaneous civil works at I.A. SSGT Road and Armit Steel Compound Distt. Ghaziabad.	132.00

नोट:- निविदादाता अपनी निविदाओं में समस्त कर सहित दरें अंकित करें। जीएसटीएचडी अलग से देय होगा। निविदा सम्बंधी विस्तृत जानकारी प्राधिकरण की website: <https://beta.upsidamarketplace.com> पर स्थित ई-निविदा एवं सुविधाओं की website: <http://etender.up.nic.in> पर देखी जा सकती है। अन्य जानकारी हेतु कार्यालय के संचित प्रत्यक्ष (सिगिल-मुद्र) के श्री प्रवीण कुमार सलीनिय मोबाइल नं० 9871996103 पर सम्पर्क किया जा सकता है।

महासचिव, उत्तरप्रदेशऔद्योगिक विकास, कानपुर

INDEL MONEY

Corporate office: Indel Money Limited, 11/11 Floor Indel House, Changampuzha Nagar, South Kalamassery, Ernakulam - 682033, Ph: 0484-2933999 E: customercare@indelmoney.com

GOLD AUCTION NOTICE

The pledges in specific and the public in general are hereby notified that public auction of the gold ornaments pledged in the below accounts is proposed to be conducted at the following branches on 26-10-2026 at 11:00 am We are auctioning the gold ornaments of the defaulted customers who have failed to make the payment of his/her loan amount despite being notified through various communication. Unauctioned items shall be auctioned on any other days without further notice of changes in venue or date and the same shall be displayed at concerned branches without any further notice.

BADARPUR - 40104790001513, 479/01535, 479/01619, 40104800001527, 480/01544, 480/01546, 480/01592, 40104950001585, 495/01597, 40105130003274, 513/03280, 513/0328

● MEDAL TALLY

Po	Country	G	S	B	T
1	China	80	30	20	130
2	Japan	20	34	37	91
3	S Korea	10	12	28	50
4	Kaz'stan	8	8	9	25
5	Uzb'stan	6	12	8	26
15	India	1	7	9	17

DAY 6 CAPSULE

Haul: 2 Silver, 3 Bronze
WUSHU

● Naorem Roshibina Devi completed a hat-trick of medals in the Asian Games. With a win over Indonesia's Thania Kusumaningtyas in the semis, she won a bronze in women's 60 kg sanda.

ROWING

● The men's sculling pair of Satnam Singh and Salman Khan won a bronze medal, with a timing of 6:13.25 in the final race.

SHOOTING

● Having already bagged medals in their respective team events, Anantjeet Singh Naruka and Parinaaz Dhaliwal paired up in mixed skeet to secure a bronze medal for India.

ATHLETICS

● Seema Kumari became the first Indian since 2010 to win an Asian Games medal in women's 10000m. She finished with a timing of 32:50.05.

● The mixed 4x400 metre relay team defended their silver medal from the last edition with a timing of 3:14.46.

● TODAY'S PICKS

DAY 7

Shooting: Men's 50m 3P Team Final (7:15 AM), Men's 50m 3P Individual Final (subject to qualification) (10:30 AM)

● The rifle shooters will be back in action and look to salvage some pride with Aishwarya and Rudrankksh taking the field.

Shooting: 10m Air Pistol Mixed Team Final (8:30 AM)

● The mixed team of Suruchi and Kamaljeet will look to salvage some pride with Aishwarya and Rudrankksh taking the field.

Athletics: Men's 100m semis (4 PM) and Final (6:50 PM)

● Two of India's fastest men, Animesh Kujur and Gurindervir Singh will look to qualify for the finals.

Athletics: Men's 10000m Final (5 PM)

● Commonwealth Games medallist Gulveer Singh will feature into the 10000m and will look to upgrade his medal from last time.

Table Tennis: Mixed Doubles QF (6:30 AM)

● Yashaswini-Harmeet and Diya-Manush will be in action. If they qualify for semis, it will be a historic medal.

Kabaddi: Semifinals (10 AM onwards)

● Both men's and women's kabaddi teams will be in action in the semi-final against Nepal and Thailand respectively.

Weightlifting: Women's 61kg (1:30 PM)

● After CWG heartbreak, Nirupama Devi will have the chance to redeem herself.



Seema won India's first Asian Games medal in women's 10000m since 2010. PTI

16-year drought ends as Seema goes the distance

25-year-old outlasts a quality field in a slow race to end a 15-year wait for a women's 10,000m medal

Mihir Vasavda & Nitin Sharma
Nagoya/Chandigarh, September 24

SEEMA'S MOTHER thinks she is in India.

She has no idea her daughter is in Japan, or that on Thursday night Seema was standing on the start line of the biggest race of her career, alongside Olympic champion Winfred Yavi. "I didn't tell her because she is old and gets very tense," Seema said after winning bronze in the women's 10,000m. "So she still thinks I am in India. Maybe she will find out now."

There was little time to think about home once the gun went. The first 400m took 83 seconds. Then came the surges and slowdowns, the kind of stop-start rhythm that can turn a 10,000m into a test of patience as much as endurance. The field went through 1,000m in 3:18 and 5,000m in 16:52, still a remarkably slow pace for runners of this calibre. From the stands, Seema's coach Scott Simmons realised the race wouldn't be fast, also because Yavi had two more events to run and Tanaka another race to come.

On the track, Seema had seen the same thing. She led for only a couple of laps before realising nobody wanted to take responsibility for the race. "I came to know that no one will lead the race," she said. "Because the best runners will wait for the final stretch. So I also changed my strategy." Simmons adds: "You just have to be fit to begin with, so then you can handle whatever happens."

Seema stopped chasing every move and stayed with the pack. It was less about running at a steady pace than surviving



Seema's mother Kesari Devi and brother watching the race. EXPRESS

everyone else's changes. "Players do that so that we get tired and no one can finish the race," Seema said. "So we have to work out with that strategy. So we did that. That was more beneficial."

By 8,000m, the group had begun to shrink. Seema was fifth with three laps left, and moved up a notch. She went past Ruth Jebet, the Bahraini great, and Daisy Jepkemei of Kazakhstan. Three women were left in the medal fight, and Seema was one of them. For a moment, she thought she could win it.

Then Yavi and Tanaka, backed by the sparse crowd, found another gear. "I felt that I couldn't win the race," Seema

said. "I also pushed. But I couldn't push as much as they did."

She did not need to win it. She stayed with them as long as she could, then held on to third as the two leaders pulled away.

Her time was 32:50.05, nearly 48 seconds slower than the personal best she had set in March. Yavi kicked into an incredible pace in the final lap to take gold in 32:39.18. But this race was never really about the clock. It was about reading the race, surviving its swings and being there when the medals were decided. Seema was.

She became India's first women's 10,000m medallist at the Asian Games since 2010. Simmons, she suspects, will be happier than she is. For three years, he has trained her at Colorado Springs.

"He has always told me, 'Seema, you are the best. You are the fighter,'" she said. "So today I thought that I will fight very well. And I did it till the end."

The location has another significance. Los Angeles will host the 2028 Olympics, giving Seema a daily reminder of where she wants to be. "We train with Olympic champions. So our mindset is also the same. To compete." Maybe now, finally, Seema's mother Kesari Devi will know she was in Japan all along.

“Before my husband died in 2012 due to a snakebite, he sold a goat to get Seema shoes.. Joote kharidne ke paise nahi hote the hamare pass aur aaj dekho Seema ne India ke liye medal jita hai”

KESARI DEVI,
SEEMA'S MOTHER

Devi was watching the tele-

cast on the TV in their home — half of which has mud walls and the rest made from cement — in Retta village in Himachal Pradesh. Three of her brothers work for a daily wage. Her father, who once sold a goat to buy Seema running shoes, died of a snakebite in 2012.

"Seema was fond of running and would practice with her elder brother Surinder in the village. My husband used to work as a labourer, apart from managing the livestock. Before he died in 2012 due to a snakebite, he sold a goat to get Seema shoes. Post his death, when she was to appear for the SAI (Sports Authority of India) trials in Dharamshala in 2015, her brothers sold another goat to get her new shoes. Joote kharidne ke paise nahi hote the hamare pass aur aaj dekho Seema ne India ke liye medal jita hai Japan main (We did not have money to get her shoes, but today my daughter has won the medal for India in Japan)," an emotional Kesari Devi told *The Indian Express*.

Youngest of six siblings, Seema's talent of running was spotted by PT teacher Hansraj in 2010 at the Government Senior Secondary School at Bhatka, which is a 45-minute uphill walk from her village. "While another brother Tej Singh and I work as labourers, my younger brother Surinder Kumar manages livestock," 51-year-old Raj Kumar, the eldest of the six siblings, said.

Seema would begin formal training under coach Kehar Singh Patial at Dharmshala. Within six months, she would win the gold in 2000m in the junior Under-16 championships in Ranchi.

"When I first saw Seema in the talent hunt, I was impressed by her stamina and endurance level to compete in longer distance races. When we carried out the physical tests, her speed was also good for long distance and we worked on her running style as well body mechanics and strength," said Patial said. Seema made progress at the national level over the past few years.



Vithya Ramraj (second from right) celebrates with the team. PTI

Vithya sets track on fire to anchor mixed relay silver



Mihir Vasavda
Nagoya, September 24

INDIA HAD a silver medal to protect, and Vithya Ramraj had 400 metres to do it.

When the baton reached her on the final leg of the mixed 4x400m relay at the Asian Games on Thursday, her three teammates had done their part. Manu TS had given India the start, Poovamma MR had kept them in the race, and Vishal Thennarasu had closed the gap. Now, Vithya was looking at the finish line, with Vietnam between her and silver and Bahrain already disappearing ahead.

She had been watching all of it from the sidelines, rehearsing her own race in her head. "I was very nervous. When the gun fires, my heart beats fast, tup tup tup," she says. "But after watching my teammates, I get confidence."

Manu had given India its best possible start, bringing the team through the opening lap in second. Poovamma, the senior-most member of the quartet, was next, and Vithya was not worried when the veteran runner appeared to lose ground early. "Poovamma didi, she knows everything. She is so ma-

ture," Vithya says. "She may be slow in the first half, but I was confident because in each race, she has a strong finish. I knew she would bring us closer."

Poovamma did. By the time she handed the baton over to Vishal, India were in the third spot. Bahrain and Vietnam were marching ahead, but from her vantage point, Vithya didn't seem perturbed. "Vishal is a tall boy. Pakka he will cover the gap... I was confident."

He did that, too, bringing India back into the medal fight before handing the baton to Vithya in third. That was when the nerves became real. "The three before me gave it all and that put pressure on me," she said. "I just wanted that because of me, they don't lose the medal."

Her coach, Nehpal Singh, was sitting straight in front of her. Vithya made eye contact with him and went back through the instructions they had rehearsed. "First 100m, go; then maintain; do not think about whoever is going fast or slow; be strong at the finish," she remembers.

The first part of the lap was about restraint. The last part was always going to demand something more. Leaders UAE were out after dropping the baton and Salwa Naser had opened a gap for Bahrain that was beyond reach, but Vietnam's Thi Ngoc Nguyen remained in front of Vithya. She kept chasing, waiting for the moment when she could make her move without running out of track — or energy. Then came the thought she had been saving for exactly this moment. "I just told myself, 'Vithya, just one push. After this, you will get one leave. So just one push.'"

She gave it her all. The gap began to disappear. With the finish line closing in, Vithya moved past Vietnam and dragged India from third to second, crossing in 3:14.46, just 0.08 seconds ahead. Bahrain won gold. "I didn't want India to lose the medal because of me," she laughs. The baton reached Vithya with India in third. She handed it back to her teammates with a silver medal.

“I just told myself, ‘Vithya, just one push. After this, you will get one leave. So just one push. I just wanted that because of me, they don’t lose the medal’”

VITHYA RAMRAJ
AFTER INDIA WON THE SILVER MEDAL IN MIXED 4X400 METRES RELAY

Gulveer returns to Asiad as a podium favourite

Shuvaditya Bose
New Delhi, September 24

GULVEER SINGH straightaway fires a warning. "I won't be afraid like last time." On Friday, the Army runner will line up for the men's 10,000m at Aichi-Nagoya — a category where India had not won an Asian Games medal since 1998, until two Indians ended the drought in 2023 at Hangzhou. Kartik Kumar took silver. The runner who took bronze, however, had begun his competitive athletics career only in 2019.

As he prepares for the challenge in Japan, Gulveer reminisced memories. "*Tab main jab wahaan gaya tha, bahar ke khiladiyon ko dekh ke thoda darr to laga tha. Par ab wo darr nahin hai* (When I had gone to Hangzhou, I was a tad afraid of the other runners. But now, I don't have that fear)," he tells *The Indian Express*. "Now I know that I also belong to the same level as them. They are not unbeatable, and I am not an underdog either. We are all equals. That, I would say, is the biggest change in me between Hangzhou to Aichi-Nagoya."

The years between have passed at a sprinter's tempo. At the Commonwealth Games in July, he became the first Indian to medal in his categories — silver in 10,000m, bronze in 5,000m.

"The field was really difficult in the Commonwealth Games. The Kenyan pair were strong, and there were other great runners. Our focus was on the work that we put in. My coach said a simple thing 'Forget where they come from, they are humans, and so are you'."

That coach is Scott Simmons, with whom Gulveer trains in Colorado Springs. "He deserves the credit for whatever I have achieved so far in my career. I just follow his instructions. Not that I always understand his plans, but all I know for certain is that whatever he does works best for me. Whenever I try to use my own brain, I get into trouble."

At the Asian Games, Gulveer will have to compete in three events in the span of five days — 1,500m, 5,000m and 10,000m. It will be difficult, he acknowledges, but he has been here before.

Coach aside, the runner also credits his sponsor, ASICS. "Because we spent hours running, having comfortable footwear becomes important."

The relocation to Colorado Springs has exacted a toll. For all the sporting accolades the decision might have facilitated, it has curbed his family time.

"I try not to show my emotions to anyone. I put on a happy face. But truth be told, I miss my family a lot. *Majboori hai, kya hi kar sakte hain* (nothing can be done). But my family has always supported me in my journey."

Gulveer arrives in Japan as a podium favourite, carrying two Commonwealth Games medals. But he is cautious not to give room to complacency. "I don't think about which field is easier and which is difficult. I prepare for every race with the same intensity. When I was a kid, my parents told me '*Kisikogareebha ameer mat samajhna, sabko in-saan samajhna*' (Don't think of people as poor or rich, think of them as humans). At the end of the day, I will be up against humans. I know that I have to be at my best."

{ SHOOTING CONTRASTS }

Two years after near-miss, Naruka gets his medal

Nitin Sharma
Chandigarh, September 24

TWO YEARS ago, Anantjeet Singh Naruka stood a whisker away from a mixed team bronze at the Paris Olympics, partnering Maheshwari Chauhan. On Thursday, at the Aichi Prefectural Shooting Range, he closed that gap, this time alongside Parinaaz Dhaliwal, winning India's first-ever mixed team medal in skeet shooting.

It came a day after Dhaliwal, Raiza Dhillon and Chauhan had already made history of their own, winning India's first women's team bronze. Neither Naruka nor Dhaliwal had man-



Anantjeet Singh Naruka and Parinaaz Dhaliwal won bronze. PTI

aged an individual medal in Japan; he'd finished fourth, missing the podium by the narrowest of margins, while she'd placed seventh.

If anything, that shared

near-miss became fuel. "I think not winning an individual medal worked as a push for both of us, and we were motivated that we are not going without a medal in the mixed

skeet event," Dhaliwal told *The Indian Express* from Japan. "We had a bad start in the qualification since the range here is a bit tricky with the angles of the target coming a bit odd. We went with the idea that we have to fight till the very end in qualification, and that's what we did, and then won the bronze medal in the final."

They'd shot a combined 138 in qualification, edging Egypt for the fourth and final spot behind Qatar, Korea and China. In the final, against a field that included Paris Olympics bronze medallists Lyu Jianlin and Jiang Yiting of China, Hangzhou bronze medallists Rashid Saleh Al-Athba (also

Wednesday's individual champion) and Reem Ghanem Al-Sharshani of Qatar, and Korea's Lee Jongjun and Jang Kook-hee, India opened with a score of 21, Naruka missing one of his 12 targets, Dhaliwal missing two. Qatar missed four that round, China led with 23, Korea sat at 22. A medal, by that point, already looked secure.

The second round tightened things to a single shot. Naruka missed once more, Dhaliwal hit all 12, and India finished level with Korea on 44 points. But qualification scores decide the tie, and Korea had gone in ranked higher. Silver went to Korea. India settled for bronze, China taking gold.

Indian pistol shooters draw a blank; wait for gold continues

Pritish Raj
New Delhi, September 24

AT THE 2023 Asian Games, India's 10m air pistol shooters won four medals. At the ongoing 2026 edition, no Indian pistol shooter has managed to defend a single one of them.

The men's shooters failed to reach the final in both individual and team events. Among the women, only Manu Bhaker made the final, finishing fifth. India lost the women's individual gold and silver from 2023, the men's team gold, and the women's team silver, missing

out on team medals in both events altogether.

Events such as 50m 3P and sports pistol are still to come, so the full picture isn't in yet. But losing four medals, including a gold, in the disciplines already decided is hard to explain away.

India's first shooting gold at the 2023 Asian Games came on the second day of that edition. This time, the contingent is yet to win a gold, and the results raise a question the federation will have to sit with: whether fielding new faces at a high-profile event is worth the risk.

For the men's pistol team,

NRAI picked the inexperienced trio of Aakash Bhardwaj, Kedarling Uchaganve and Kamaljeet, while World Champion Samrat Rana and Olympic medallist Sarabjot Singh stayed home. The selection came through a trial system that had worked before, at the 2024 Olympics, where Indian shooters won three medals. But a trial score doesn't always carry the weight of a big occasion. Kamaljeet is primarily a 50m pistol shooter; his ISSF profiles shows only one prior 10m air pistol appearance. Kedarling and Aakash have similarly thin records at major events.

CHess OLYMPIAD

Men fritter away advantage with draw against Azerbaijan

Mayank Chaudhary
New Delhi, September 24

WHEN THE Svane brothers, Frederik and Rasmus, delivered the biggest shock of the 2026 Chess Olympiad by guiding Germany past an apparently invincible Uzbekistan, the door swung wide open for defending champions India to storm straight back into the race for Open section gold.

Instead, the Indian men have only themselves to blame. Their title defence grew considerably more fraught after they failed to extract maximum match points against a gritty Azerbaijan in the eighth round. All four Indians were forced to share the spoils as the tense clash ended in a deflating 2.0–2.0 stalemate in Samarkand.

Captain Srinath Narayanan finally rang in the changes, benching Nihal Sarin and bringing in Vidit Gujrathi on Board 4. Vidit immediately stopped the bleeding. Handling the black pieces against Rauf Mamedov, the seasoned grandmaster steered the encounter into quiet, controlled waters, signing a pragmatic 30-move threefold repetition draw. Minutes later, another threefold repetition unfolded on Board 2, where Arjun Erigaisi neutralised Aydin Suleymanli with the black pieces.

That left R Praggnanandhaa and D Gukesh, the heroes of India's vital victories in Rounds 5 and 7, to supply the decisive breakthroughs with the white pieces. Wary of the seasoned Shakhriyar Mamedyarov's counterpunching reputation, Pragg appeared to underestimate his middlegame prospects, and instead of fighting for a win, he opted to offer a draw that Mamedyarov accepted with open arms.

Gukesh, the reigning World Champion, held a noticeable advantage against Mahammad Muradli. Yet the edge proved agonisingly fragile. Muradli displayed immense resourcefulness in a complex rook-and-knight versus rook-and-bishop endgame, gradually defusing the danger to secure the split point and leave India frustrated.

The women's team similarly squandered a golden opportunity, stumbling to a 2.0–2.0 draw against Kazakhstan.

R Vaishali's prolonged lean patch remains the squad's primary concern. The Candidates winner fell to her second defeat of the tournament, cleanly outmanoeuvred by the in-form Alua Nurman. With draws on the other two boards for Koneru Humpy and Divya Deshmukh, India were suddenly staring directly into the abyss of an outright defeat.

It took another rescue act from teenage debutant Savitha Shri B to salvage the evening. Pressing relentlessly against Elnaz Kaliakhmet until the Kazakh's defensive ramparts finally cracked, Savitha converted an equalised position into a brilliant full point.

● RISNG CHESS STAR

Behind Olympiad hero Savitha's success, a father's gamble

Amit Kamath
Mumbai, September 24

FOR ALMOST five hours on Thursday, as things rapidly went from bad to worse for both the Indian teams at the Chess Olympiad, two games held a flicker of hope for the defending champions. In the open section, world champion Gukesh was in a winning position against Azerbaijan's Mahammad Muradli.

If he converted it, it would give the Indians a win in the tie since three of the other games had ended in draws. In the women's section, there was Savitha Shri, a 19-year-old international master, who had found herself burdened with saving India's flickering hopes to contend for gold medal because Vaishali had lost her clash with Kazakhstan's IM Alua Nurman.

The win slipped out of Gukesh's grasp like sand. India's open team were held to a draw by Azerbaijan. But Savitha persevered in a game where a chance to push for a win was negligible. Then, somehow, she

Iranian rower trained through a war to win Asian Games gold

Mihir Vasavda
Nagoya, September 24

KIMIA ZAREI was preparing for the Asian Games when the sound of bombs became part of her training routine.

She would get ready to work out at home, hear an explosion nearby and look out of the window to see smoke rising. Then she would return to her ergometer and carry on rowing.

For 45 days, that was how Zarei and the rest of Iran's rowing team prepared for the Asian Games, separately, inside their homes, in cities spread across a country at war. "The only thing that we could do was take one ergometer and take it home," said Zarei, who paired with Zeinab Norouzi to win gold in the women's lightweight double

sculls. "Every day, try to row, try to have training sessions on ergo, and connect with our coach, get the training schedule, and row on ergo."

The war had begun six months before the Games, catching the athletes unprepared. On its first day, the federation cancelled its training camp and sent the rowers back to their homes. "We faced a lot of difficulties after the war began, but we wanted to show that we are strong. We have given every rower an ergometer so they could continue training at home," said Iran's rowing federation chief Mohsen Shadi Naghadeh.

Zarei returned to Hamadan. Her teammates went back to their own cities.

The conflict began in Feb-

ruary, following large-scale attacks by the United States and Israel, and disrupted sporting preparations across Iran. For the rowers, there was little choice but to find a way to train around it. "All the cities in Iran were affected by the war," Zarei said. "In the first month of the war, it was really hard, harder than before."

There were interruptions. Sometimes they had to leave home when the bombing intensified. Sometimes they had to stop what they were doing and move somewhere else. But the training continued. "It was both of them," Zarei said, when asked whether, in those first weeks, she was trying to save her life or trying to row.

The rowing team was not alone in trying to salvage an



Kimia Zarei trained indoors on a ergometer once war broke out.

Asian Games preparation thrown into chaos. Iran's women's kabaddi team also had its camp disrupted by the war and had to move between cities before travelling to Sonepat in India in August, where

the players trained twice a day and played practice matches to regain the rhythm lost during the conflict.

For Zarei, those first 45 days were spent almost entirely indoors. She estimates she covered about 20 kilometres a day on the ergometer, alone in her room, following a training schedule sent by her coach. "I was preparing to start training, and then I heard the bombing sounds," she said. "It was so close to our home. When you looked out of the window, you could see the smoke."

Eventually, the team was able to return to camp and resume rowing on water. Zarei trained in Urmia, where Iran's rowing federation had access to a two-kilometre course. The uncertainty of those 45 days

did not disappear when she returned to the water. Another memory was waiting for her.

Hangzhou heartbreak

At the Hangzhou Asian Games three years ago, she had finished fourth, the only member of Iran's rowing team to leave without a medal. "It was really a hard moment," she said. That fourth-place finish continues to rankle her, and so do the three years that followed: the training, the effort to stay positive, the belief that she could do better. "Three years of hard work, being motivated, trying to stay positive, trying to believe in myself and believing in God," she said. "Today, I've got first place."

As she crossed the finish line in Nagoya, the emotion of

those three years, and of those weeks in Iran, came out. Zarei splashed the water and broke down. Throughout the war, she had kept returning to the same thought. "The only thing was thinking about the medal, thinking about my people, thinking about my family and my future," she said. "Because this medal really matters for Iranian people, especially Iranian girls." Then the tears. "I cried," she said. "It was a moment that I really cannot explain in words."

For 45 days, Zarei had trained without a boat, without teammates beside her, with the sound of bombing in her ears. "I told myself, I will do my best. I will have training every day. Please help me to get the best result."

SECOND BUT SECOND TO NONE

From late call to podium

Roshibina Devi becomes first Indian to win three Wushu medals by bagging silver in the 60kg sanda

Nitin Sharma
Chandigarh, September 24

EARLIER THIS month, Roshibina Devi Naorem sat at her home in Kwasiphai village near Bishnupur, Manipur, talking to her father about missing a chance to make history. She had just lost to Divyanshi Choudhary in the semi-finals of the final trials, and with that loss went her shot at a third consecutive Asian Games medal. Her father remembers the mood in the house. "Roshibina as well the whole family was a bit depressed that she was not selected, but then I told her to not think about not getting selected and to move on," says Damu Singh Naorem.

Three days before the Indian wushu team left for Japan, Choudhary got injured. Roshibina got the call instead. "She was not able to practice a lot, but wushu has been her life since the last 13 years, and that's what she lives for," her father says. "She will cherish this silver medal the most."

On Thursday, on barely any preparation, the 25-year-old DSP with Manipur Police became the first Indian wushu player to win three consecutive Asian Games medals, taking silver in the women's 60kg sanda event after a 0-2 loss to China's Zhang Xiaoyu in the final. "There were disturbances as I did not get much time to prepare," Roshibina said in Japan.

"But then I ignored those distractions as well, and all I was thinking when I sat in the flight to Japan was to win the



Having already won Asiad medals in Jakarta and Hangzhou, Roshibina Devi completed the hat-trick. PTI

medal. My aim was to make the comeback after the loss, and this silver medal proves that."

She was twelve, in the fifth standard, when she first saw a wushu competition in her village and decided she wanted to try it. Her parents, small-time farmers, told her she was too young and needed to focus on her studies. She found her own way around that. "She would take a vest and fill it up with rice husk and practice wushu with other village kids," her father recalls. A woman in the village eventually told her to apply to the SAI Centre in Imphal. Selection there meant her food and training were finally taken care of. "I would

also often visit her, taking home food and vegetables for her," he says.

She trained under coach Maibam Premkumar Singh, won junior national medals soon after, and took bronze at the 2016 World Juniors in Bulgaria. A year later, chief national coach Kuldeep Handoo moved her into the senior team, and her first Asian Games medal, bronze, followed in 2018, a win over Pakistan's Mubasjra Akhtar preceding a semi-final loss to China's Cai Yingying. In Hangzhou, she went further still, beating Kazakhstan's Aiman Karshyg on points and Vietnam's Thi The Nguyen 2-0 in the semis before falling 0-2 to China's Wu Xiao-

wei in the final.

Handoo has watched her build herself for years around the one thing her body gave her. "As a junior too, she had a stout physique. And she was never afraid of getting punched while she attacked too," he says. "Since her height was short, we laid emphasis on her utilising her close range kicks and punches. Post the 2018 Asian Games bronze, we worked on her throwing and punches a lot. In 2024, she had suffered a knee injury and it took a long time to recover."

Medal for Manipur

The Hangzhou silver had arrived months after ethnic violence broke out in Manipur,

and Roshibina dedicated that medal to the state's people at the time.

What she didn't know, while she trained through it, was how much her family had absorbed on her behalf. "Prior to 2023, I had to sell part of our land to support her training. When she won the Asian Games silver, we used some of the prize money and our money to get that portion back," her father says.

"During the unrest in 2023, while Roshibina was in the SAI training centre, we struggled in selling our farm produce with the unrest and all the things happening around. But we did not talk about the issue with her." Her grandfather died during that same period. She wasn't told that either. "We wanted her to concentrate fully on her game," he says.

In Japan, before the final, she had beaten Bangladesh's Shika Khatun, Macau's Chu Man Sin, and 2023 world champion Nguyen Thi Thu Thuy of Vietnam, before getting past Indonesia's Thania Kusumaningtyas in the semis. National coach Amit Pal saw a fighter who had barely had time to become one for this tournament.

"Roshibina had very little time to prepare, but the way she performed here is commendable," he says. "We left on September 15, and the key was to put her in a good positive mindset prior to the matches. The win against the Vietnamese was vital, and she will take a lot of positives from it."

Handoo believes the door to beating China's best isn't closed, just not yet open again. "Yes, she lost against the Chinese, but she has it in her to score a win against Chinese players. She did that in her junior days and needs to be injury free in coming years to repeat," he says.

She almost wasn't in Japan at all. Three days and one phone call changed that math entirely.



Rohit Sharma trained in Thiruvananthapuram on Thursday.

Storms crossed, Rohit and Virat gear up for second wind

Sandip G
Thiruvananthapuram, September 24

THE SULLEN sun over the Greenfield Stadium had sunk when Virat Kohli sashayed down the practice pitch and dispatched a net bowler's stingless half-volley over his head. The ball crashed onto water bottles piled on the edge of the boundary ropes, sparking a chorus of excitement from the impatient onlookers. After the nets wrapped up, the bowler frantically searched for the ball, which he eventually found, and slipped it into his bag.

Only half the eye was transfixed on Kohli; the rest was dutifully on Rohit Sharma, who batted with the second batch after a brief rain interruption.

Sharma's freshly unwrapped willow unsheathed a straight drive so perfect in concept, balance, flourish, and placement that it narrowly eluded a wheelbarrow placed near the edge of the boundary line. A cover drive clanked onto the base of a pole. The nets here hug the centre pitch, which gives the illusion of a real game.

That the build-up to the World Cup next year would be an extended farewell stretch for the biggest surviving superstars of the format.

Their sightings are rare and precious. Kohli stays in London, flies home largely to fulfil IPL and ODI commitments. Similarly aligned are Sharma's career engagements, even though his public appearances are more frequent. Recently, he started anchoring an entertainment show in Hindi and sprinkled his earthy humour. They would never escape from the public eye. But this is what the crowd wants — them in their original sanctuary, batting with joy and filling watchers with joy, enjoying and letting those around them enjoy too.

In some ways, Kohli and Sharma embody not only two of the greatest 50-over cricketers, but the last lingering vestiges of the ODI-romance; relics of a time when the format was king, before cricket lost itself in the exponential leap of its youngest progeny and plunged the elder sibling into mid-life crisis.

Tickets were sold out in less than half an hour, the administrators claim, and the truth behind it was as plain as sunlight. The overpowering allure of the Kohli-Sharma tango.

Even at 37 and 39, they still furnish reasons to enjoy their game. They turn even a routine nets session into an event worthy of gate fees. Sharma's spot was briefly hitting a roadblock, but he de-stung the critics with a hundred at Lord's.

That the build-up to the World Cup next year would be an extended farewell stretch for the biggest surviving superstars of the format.

Kohli seldom ever has offered a toehold for doubters to sharpen their swords on him. If anything, since being a single-format proposition, he has racked up hundreds for fun, composing three in his last 10 outings. In five of those, he posted half-centuries including a 93 as well. The city would remember his last date with it — when he shellacked an unbeaten 166 against Sri Lanka.

Without ado

Both battled without ado. Kohli was Sharma-like in his early rifling. He stepped out frequently, and once savagely biffed Kuldeep Yadav over mid-wicket. The best was yet to be — a straight-driven six off Naman Dhir. The tempo never dropped, even though he mis-cued a few lifter from Prasidh Krishna, bending his back and revving up pace.

When Sharma's turn came, he batted without fuss, instructing Krishna to bang short at him, preparing perhaps for the slippery bounce or West Indies quick Shamar Joseph.

Fascinating subplots intertwine the central theme of the stalwarts' autumnal bloom.

Mohammed Siraj would hope to rekindle his rhythm at a venue that sparks pleasant memories; Kuldeep Yadav seeks a renaissance in a format he has featured most often for his country, and where he is unsuspiciously masterful; Nitish Reddy aspires to build on his surge against Afghanistan, emerging as both an alternative and competition to Hardik Pandya; Rituraj Gaikwad, Dhruv Jurel and Yashasvi Jaiswal could be plotting blockbuster outings that could keep their names dance on the selectors' lips; Prasidh and Aaquib Nabi know that the country's fast bowling stock is as volatile as the stock market; a nudge away from boom or bust. As the series unfolds, the corollaries could potentially flesh out into narratives of standalone value.

But in India's first training session ahead of the West Indies series, the gaze remained firmly on two greats of the format shining brightly under the twilight skies, raging stoically against the dying lights.